

*Our Singleness of Purpose
— The Cornerstone of A.A.*

**THE FIFTY-FOURTH ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

*2004
Final Report*

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Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses.

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54th GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

“Our Singleness of Purpose — The Cornerstone of A.A.”

“The journey we take this week will not always be easy — and at times, it may not even seem very spiritual. But during this upcoming week, as we conduct the business of Alcoholics Anonymous, we will experience how God, as we understand him, speaks to us through the group conscience.”

So said Mark Greider (Colorado), delegate chairperson of the 54th General Service Conference, at the opening program Sunday afternoon, April 18 — a quote that captures the essence of A.A.’s week-long business meeting.

Who goes to the Conference? The 134 Conference members are delegates from the 93 service areas of the U.S. and Canada, 21 trustees (14 alcoholic and 7 nonalcoholic) of the General Service Board, plus directors of the A.A. World Services and Grapevine Boards, and G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members.

Held at the Crowne Plaza Manhattan, the 54th Conference was chaired by Greg Muth, G.S.O.’s general manager; Elaine McDowell, (nonalcoholic) chair of the General Service Board; George Vaillant, Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee; and Mark Greider, delegate chairperson. Bill Archer, G.S.O. staff member, was Conference secretary. The keynote address, on the Conference theme, Our Singleness of Purpose — the Cornerstone of A.A., was given by Ric Downey, Western Canada regional trustee.

Sunday evening is a time of fellowship and seeing old friends, and many past trustees, former delegates, and friends of A.A. arrived at the hotel ballroom for the opening dinner. An open A.A. meeting followed the dinner, chaired by Earl Fink (Montana).

The meeting was led by Clarke Brown (Western Missouri); speakers were Don Anderson (Hawaii), Marie Hamilton (NW Ontario), Robin Bromley (Grapevine executive editor), Paul Cleary (A.A.W.S. director), and Arnold Ross (general service trustee).

Beginning Monday morning, the G.S.C. Serenity Group met 7:30-8:30 a.m. Paul Mijares (SE Texas) was the chairperson, Jeanine Rios (Central California) served as secretary/treasurer; the daily topic was taken from readings from A.A. literature.

Spaced throughout the week new delegates (Panel 54) presented their Area Highlights. Wednesday morning began with Conference members gathering in 10 sections for a workshop that addressed how Singleness of Purpose is important to the individual, group, district, area and G.S.O. and Grapevine offices.

Throughout the week there were three “What’s On Your Mind?” sharing sessions, where delegates had the opportunity to ask questions, express opinions on topics and present concerns of their areas on issues that did not appear on the committee agendas.

One of the reasons that Conference week seems to run like a clock is the G.S.O. team behind the scenes. Yee Tully, the staff assistant on the Conference assignment, frequently on the dais, called by Bill Archer, “my faithful companion,” was also referred to as “Tonto.” (For those of you too young to remember, Tonto was the Lone Ranger’s “faithful companion.”) When she introduced herself to first-year delegates, Yee mentioned that she was “the voice on the phone” — hounding them for their payment,

area highlights, presentations, etc.

Throughout the week, other G.S.O. staff assistants were in and out of the Workroom, where Frank Segui, finance assistant, worked steadily. Smoothly choreographing all this activity, as he has for many years, was John Kirwin, G.S.O.'s events consultant.

New York Intergroup hosted a hospitality suite for early arrivals Saturday afternoon. Throughout the week A.A. and Al-Anon members planned a variety of activities for the family and friends of delegates. Among the trips were a Circle Line cruise around Manhattan island, tours of NBC studios, Lincoln Center and backstage at Madison Square Garden. Many also sought out local A.A. and Al-Anon meetings.

Those who had a few spare moments perused the exhibits in the Atrium, where Conference-approved literature, service material and various translations were displayed.

There was also a display of A.A. memorabilia assembled by G.S.O.'s Archives, and a slide presentation featured highlights of the new Grapevine Digital Archives.

Tuesday afternoon there was a trip to the G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. Here Conference members, and the family and friends who had accompanied them to New York, could tour the various offices, inquire about their groups' records and contributions and enjoy the amazing treasures in the Archives. At the Grapevine office they were able to go into the Digital Archives in more depth, retrieving G.V. issues back to the first in 1944.

This being the 60th Anniversary of the A.A. Grapevine, there was a celebratory cake during lunch on Tuesday.

Wednesday afternoon the Conference elected two regional trustees. Tom Kraemer of Saskatchewan becomes the new Western Canada regional trustee, replacing Ric Downey; Chuck Barta of Iowa will replace Ted Stoa as the new West Central regional trustee.

At the Delegates Only Meeting Tuesday evening Jimmy Jack Bailey of Kansas was elected delegate chairperson for the 55th Conference; alternate chairperson will be Randy Magnus of Saskatchewan.

Presentations throughout the week addressed the Conference theme, Finances, and A.A.'s worldwide growth. With the 2005 International Convention, celebrating A.A.'s 70th Anniversary, just 14 months away, Rick Walker, standing in for Doug Richardson, G.S.O. staff member coordinating the event, gave a rundown of the program and activities of that exciting June 30 - July 3, 2005 weekend in Toronto. A two-minute film of Toronto followed the presentation. Then the Riverside Drive Players (G.S.O. staff) presented a revival of their International Convention skit based on some bizarre yet real life situations and experiences of past Conventions.

Archivist Judit Santon gave an update on G.S.O.'s Archive's Audio Preservation project, which was begun in 2000. There was rapt attention when the presentation concluded with the playing of three recordings from the Archive's vast collection, which included the voices of co-founders Bill W. and Dr. Bob, as well as Lois W. and Ann S., and Dr. Bob's son, Smitty. There were also comments on an early fund raising, which Bill referred to as "life among the anonimi."

The work of the Conference goes on 365 days a year — in the groups, in the districts and areas, at the General Service Office and in the constant work of committees, from the local areas to the trustees' committees. However, it is during Conference week that it all comes together.

The agendas of the 13 Conference committees consist of items forwarded by the trustees' committees as well as additional topics submitted by individual A.A. members, general service workers, or areas. After thoughtful deliberation on agenda items each committee reports its recommendation to the entire

Conference for discussion, approval, or rejection. Beginning Wednesday evening, the delegate chairperson of each Conference committee presented the committee's recommendations. Conference members were then free to go to the floor mikes to ask questions, disagree, make suggestions or changes, and share the concerns of their area on any given issue.

It is in this long, careful and arduous process — which stretched well into Thursday evening and continued through most of Friday — that the group conscience of A.A. in the U.S. and Canada emerges, resulting in the Conference Advisory Action.

Friday afternoon, following Elaine McDowell's closing remarks, the Conference officially closed with the Serenity Prayer in English, French and Spanish.

Friday evening was free time for the hard-working Conference members — to see a Broadway show, go to a ballgame, buy a lottery ticket or just take an after-dinner nap. Many, of course, went to an A.A. meeting.

Saturday morning, members of A.A.'s 54th Conference came together for the last time at the closing brunch — a bittersweet time of farewells, sharing memories, taking photos. Rotating Class B trustees Ric Downey and Ted Stoa and Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee George Vaillant shared the joys, trials, and memories of their years of service on the General Service Board.

Saturday afternoon, delegates and guests boarded mini-vans for a visit to Stepping Stones, the home of Bill Wilson and Lois in Bedford Hills, New York.

The work was over, and members of the 54th General Service Conference had experienced "... how God, as we understand him, speaks to us through the group conscience."

Greetings from Delegate Chair

It is an honor to welcome you all to the 54th General Service Conference. I look forward to serving with all of you as we embark on this very moving and spiritual journey. The journey we take this week will not always be easy — and at times it may not even seem very spiritual. But during this upcoming week, as we conduct the business of Alcoholics Anonymous, we will experience how God, as we understand him, speaks to us through the group conscience. I remember that last year, as I sat in the audience listening to the opening remarks, I had no idea what to expect. I was scared and I was pretty sure I was not qualified to be here. I was also concerned that, somehow, I was going to damage Alcoholics Anonymous. In other words, it was all about me. As the week progressed, however, I discovered, as I have discovered so many times before in A.A., that it was not about me. It is about us. It is about God. It is about the principles our early members passed on to us. When I join together with you, my life gets better. Together we can accomplish those things that I could never accomplish on my own. So I am confident that together, with God's help, we can use the principles of this program to find the best solutions for the items that our Fellowship has asked us to consider this week.

When I walked into my first meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous I really did not know what to expect. Then the meeting started and the chairperson asked if there was anyone attending for their first, second, or third meeting since their last drink. I raised my hand. They then went around the room and talked about what it was like, what happened, and what it was like now. They talked about going to the bar to have one drink, and then closing the place — and they did not understand why. They talked about watching a normal drinker take one sip from a drink and then put it down and walk away — and they did not understand how or why. They talked about how, once they started

drinking, they did not know where, when or how the drunk would end. As soon as I heard these things, I knew I was in the right place. I had experienced all of these things. Then they told me they had found a way to live where drinking was no longer required. And that if I wanted it, all I had to do was ask. The only difference between the people in that meeting and me was that they looked a whole lot happier than I felt. They had a

light in their eyes that had long since ceased to exist in my eyes. They offered me a life where I no longer needed to drink. They offered me hope. I knew I wanted what they had.

And that brings me to the theme of this Conference: *Our Singleness of Purpose, the Cornerstone of A.A.* There is no doubt in my mind that our singleness of purpose is the cornerstone of A.A. It is why I kept coming back. It is why I was willing to do the Steps. When I walked into my first meeting, it seemed as if you knew me. You understood the terror, bewilderment, frustration and despair that ruled my life as a result of alcoholism — because you had been there. You shared your experience, strength and hope about alcoholism, and I identified with you. You did not talk about the other “issues” in your lives. You talked about alcoholism and how to recover from it. You knew that if you talked about those other things, I might not identify with you. And that if I did not identify with you, if I could not find a common bond in the problem, I might not stick around for the solution. So you kept it simple. You told me how you drank, and I related. You told me it was possible to stop drinking and get my life back, and I wanted that. And, because I knew you drank just like me, and you told me you had found a way to stop, you gave me hope. And for that I am forever in your debt.

Our Conference theme also applies to the work we will be doing this week. Our Fellowship has entrusted us with the important task of coming to an informed group conscience so that, with God’s help, we can find the best solutions to some of the issues that face our Fellowship today. This will not be an easy task. Fortunately, those who have gone before us have given us a “process” to accomplish this. And as this week commences, I would ask you to trust the process. Trust the committee process. Trust the Conference process. Trust the group conscience process. At some point during the week you may find yourself in the position where your conscience, based on what you have heard in your committee or on the Conference floor, requires you to vote in a manner contrary to how your area would want you to vote. That is okay. Our purpose here is to find the best solutions for the entire Fellowship, not our individual areas. As I mentioned earlier, the Conference is not about me. It is also not about my group, my district, or my area. It is about us. It is about our entire Fellowship. The groups and districts in our areas have delegated to us both the authority and the responsibility to make these decisions. And sometimes that means we will have to leave here and report to our areas why we voted contrary to their wishes.

I also want to take a moment to talk about trust. During this week we are all members of the Conference. We are not delegates, trustees, directors or staff members — we are Conference

members. There is no “us and them.” There is only “us.” We each get here by different paths. We each have our own experiences that guide our thinking —

but our purpose is the same. We are all here because we want the hand of A.A. to be there for the drunk who has not yet found sobriety. So as we deliberate the issues in front of us, trust that

the intentions of your fellow Conference members are like your own. And trust that God will use the

varied experiences we each bring to the Conference to lead us to the answers that will best serve our Fellowship.

During this week we will see wonderful examples of our principles in action. We may also see, as one of the past delegates from my area likes to say, some “hideous warnings.” My service sponsor is fond of telling me that *how* we do things in A.A. is much more important than *what* we do. So I would encourage you, each day, to ask the God of your understanding to help you to be a channel of love, to open your mind so that you can hear him or her speak through the voices of the other Conference members, and to help guide your thoughts and actions so that we can make the decisions that will be most effective in helping us carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. Because that is what this is all about. That is our single purpose. We may be in a nice hotel in New York City, but our responsibilities lie with the drunk on the streets of Omaha or in a bar in Calgary, or in prison in San Quentin — the drunk who wants to get sober, but who, like me, thought there was no hope.

Someone once told me that A.A. is not a business that has a spiritual aspect. It is a Spiritual entity that has to conduct some business. I think if we keep that in mind throughout the upcoming week, we will be well on our way to carrying out our duties and serving our fellow alcoholics. I thank you for giving me this opportunity to serve our Fellowship. And I thank Alcoholics Anonymous for saving my life.

Mark Greider, Colorado

Keynote

I’m Ric Downey and I am an alcoholic. What a privilege to be asked to give the Keynote Address at our 54th General Service Conference. I want to thank Bill for the loving invitation. Our Conference theme this year is *Our Singleness of Purpose — The Cornerstone of A.A.* To be completely honest, speaking on this topic makes me a bit nervous. The topic seems to spark lively debate and I’m still a bit of a people pleaser. I want you all to agree, and experience with this topic tells me some of you won’t. But fools rush in.

In a February 1958 Grapevine article, Bill W. wrote, “Many early A.A.s had the almost comical notion that they were pure alcoholics — guzzlers only, no other serious problems at all. When alcoholic ex-cons and drug users first turned up, there was much pious indignation. ‘What will people think?’ chanted the pure alcoholics. Happily, this foolishness has long since



evaporated." The article was "Problems Other Than Alcohol" and nine years later the Conference asked the A.A. Grapevine for permission to produce it as a pamphlet. It is still in circulation. I believe that though slightly dated it stands the test of time and is one of our more definitive pieces on singleness of purpose. One of the few things I would dispute is that the foolishness evaporated. If it evaporated in 1958, it condensed shortly thereafter. Hard as it is to believe, I have heard that pious indignation may still exist in some circles. I need to tell you that I am not one of those pure alcoholics. I have a bushel basket full of "and a's" and could use up a good portion of my allotted time if I chose to include all of them when introducing myself. I remember going to a meeting early in my sobriety and a person who was asked to share introduced himself as an alcoholic and an addict. Introducing yourself that way was unusual in my circle at that time, but I filed it away for future consideration. Later that week at my home group, I was introducing myself and proudly said, "My name is Ric and I'm an alcoholic and an addict." I really was different and had achieved my unique status. A rather gruff voice, which I recognized as my sponsor's, said rather loudly, "Not in this meeting you're not." I'm omitting an adjective. Following the meeting, we had a rather lengthy loving discussion during which I was given my first lessons in the Traditions. I wasn't totally convinced that I was one of many, but I decided to behave until I found the real truth. The truth I learned is that A.A. is for people who have a problem with alcohol. Nowhere do we say it is for people whose only problem is alcohol. I'm just not sure what we have to offer you if you don't have an alcohol problem. I know that some will say that the Twelve Steps are a blueprint for living. I don't dispute that for a second, but the Steps I am talking about are the Twelve Steps of Alcoholics Anonymous. They are written by alcoholics for alcoholics.

A.A.W.S. has granted permission to a few hundred different fellowships or programs, and each has adapted them to their particular problem. This not only attests to their effectiveness but also shows the need to focus on the particular problem being dealt with. We deal with one problem — alcoholism.

I have a sponsee who hasn't had a drink for many years. Quite a few more than me. A few years ago he started smoking pot. We have had some discussions about that and the topics usually center on sobriety dates and celebrating anniversaries. He asked me what pot smoking had to do with A.A. and, I answered, absolutely nothing. His next question was, then why should I change my date? I replied you don't have to, it is your decision. The "but" is, if you want me to be your sponsor you do. It's not an A.A. thing. With you and me, it's a sponsorship thing. I told him I was sure he could find someone who would be willing to be his sponsor, recognize his old date and present him with a cake or chip each year. That person just isn't me.

Over the last four years, I have attended a meeting in New York when I was able. At the beginning of the meeting they read Bill's statement from "Problems Other Than Alcohol." "Sobriety, freedom from alcohol, through the teaching and practice of the Twelve Steps is the sole purpose of an A.A. group." They continue by saying if anyone has a problem with something other than alcohol please see the secretary at half time or after the meeting and we will give you the phone number of the appropriate fellowship. Interesting idea! Direct them to the appropriate fellowship. We can do that.

I have a friend who comes to A.A. and introduces himself as an alcoholic when asked to share. He told me one day that he is really only an addict. I asked him if he could drink with the impunity that is mentioned in our literature. His instant answer was, no way. He said, "If I started drinking, I would start using

drugs." I asked if it was possible that alcohol made his life unmanageable.

I remember reading a Grapevine letter in which someone said they wouldn't go to an A.A. meeting and introduce themselves as an alcoholic and a welder. They said the fact that they were a welder had as much meaning in an Alcoholics Anonymous meeting as someone being an addict. Just some food for thought.

Singleness of purpose isn't a drugs-versus-alcohol thing. It isn't about how we introduce ourselves at meetings. Addicts are visible to us and the first to come to mind when we talk about singleness of purpose. There are many others with a host of problems who would join us should we open the doors. I am not minimizing any of the other problems. I am just saying this is about focus — our focus as members of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Bill W. often said that one of A.A.'s greatest strengths is its single-minded focus on one thing and one thing only. By limiting our primary purpose to carrying the message to alcoholics and avoiding all other activities, A.A. is able to do one thing supremely well. The atmosphere of identification is preserved by that purity of focus, and alcoholics get help.

We are often confronted, or dare I say slapped in the face, with the Third Tradition (short form). People who have neither abused alcohol nor even drank to excess tell us they should be part of A.A. because they have a desire to stop drinking. People quote the line in the Twelve and Twelve that says, "You are an A.A. member if you say so," not noting that the line before it states that it is talking to "every serious drinker." The first few lines of the long form of the Third Tradition state: "Our membership ought to include all who suffer from alcoholism. Hence we may refuse none who wish to recover." There appear to be some requirements there that go a little beyond "desire to stop drinking."

In November of 1985, the World Service Board of Trustees of Narcotics Anonymous put out a bulletin titled "Some Thoughts Regarding Our Relationship to Alcoholics Anonymous." We later reprinted it in the A.A. Grapevine and I'd like to share a few lines from it. The NA bulletin states: "From very early on, A.A. was confronted by a perplexing problem: 'What do we do with drug addicts? We want to keep the focus on alcohol so the alcoholic hears the message, but these addicts come in here talking about drugs, inadvertently weakening our atmosphere of identification.' The Steps were written, the Big Book was written — what were they supposed to do, rewrite it all? Allow the atmosphere of identification to get blurry so that no one got a clear sense of belonging. When they finally studied the problem carefully and took a stand in their literature, the solution they outlined possessed their characteristic common sense and wisdom. They pledged their support in a spirit of 'cooperation not affiliation.' This farsighted solution to a difficult concern paved the way for the development of the Narcotics Anonymous Fellowship."

And how does NA feel about their members identifying themselves as alcoholic/addicts? From the same NA bulletin: "The A.A. perspective with its alcohol-oriented language and the NA approach with its clear need to shift the focus away from specific drugs, don't mix well. When we try to mix them, we find that we have the same problems A.A. had with us all along! When our members identify as 'addicts and alcoholics' or talk about 'sobriety' and living 'clean and sober,' the clarity of the NA message is blurred."

"The focus of A.A. is on the alcoholic and we ought to respect our own primary purpose and identify ourselves at NA meetings as addicts, and share in a way that keeps our message clear."

Up to this point I have omitted talking about the second half of the theme "The Cornerstone of A.A.," but I think that is a given. Of course I couldn't do one of these presentations without consulting the dictionary at least once, so I had to look up cornerstone. The definition I found that I thought was apropos was "a

basic element." Singleness of purpose is the basic element that is the foundation of everything we do.

Over this past year I have been at a number of workshops and events where our theme was discussed. It is something our Fellowship wants to talk about and I have heard many lively discussions. I am looking forward to our workshop this week and hearing more.

My story is this. Everything I liked, I did to excess. I could qualify in many of the programs we have lent our Twelve Steps to. What happens when I practice the Twelve Steps of Alcoholics Anonymous is that my life becomes manageable. When I introduce myself, I say I'm Ric and I am an alcoholic. For me it says it all.

I was at a service conference in Minnesota earlier this year and one of the presenters said something that struck a note with me. He said he hoped that if Bill and Dr. Bob were looking down on us today, they would recognize Alcoholics Anonymous. Me too.

Ric Downey, trustee

Workshop — How is Singleness of Purpose Important to the Individual, Group, District, Area, G.S.O. and Grapevine Office?

Wednesday morning Conference members divided into groups for workshop discussions based on the Conference theme "How is Singleness of Purpose Important to the Individual, Group, District, Area, G.S.O. and Grapevine Office?" Following are the questions and a summary of responses from those discussions.

1. Is there a philosophical difference between our "Primary Purpose" and "Singleness of Purpose?"

There is a philosophical difference between our Primary Purpose and Singleness of Purpose. Our Primary Purpose is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. It is an action goal for each of us, it is our responsibility, it is what we do, and it involves spirituality and love. The message can be carried through sponsorship and working with others and is in line with the Twelve Steps. It is for our group life. The Primary Purpose helps us to focus on alcoholism.

Our Singleness of Purpose is an essential message of Alcoholics Anonymous. The message is how to stay sober and how to recover from alcoholism. It is about the solution to the problem, and how we deal with alcoholism to help others, ourselves, and groups achieve sobriety. We confront the question of alcoholism and look for underlying reasons to improve one's life. We promote unity and focus, which can result in healthy living behaviors. Singleness of Purpose does not mean we exclude members — it is how we define ourselves as a Fellowship, it is in line with the Twelve Traditions, and it is what we communicate to the outside world. It is the Fellowship's responsibility and how we stay focused on alcoholism.

In a general sense there is no philosophical difference between our Primary Purpose and our Singleness of Purpose. Our Singleness of Purpose is to follow our Primary Purpose to stay sober and help other alcoholics achieve sobriety. Our Primary Purpose is to focus on our Singleness of Purpose. They are used interchangeably in our text. However, there are interpretive differences. For example, the primary purpose of a group is to show a vast range of tolerance, acceptance, and guiding attitude toward "outside" issues. Groups carry the primary message to newcomers. An individual shows singleness of purpose when they speak about leaving other problems and issues at the door of an A.A. meeting or group. There needs to be a way for members seeking spiritual growth to talk about other problems, but alcoholism is our primary/single purpose, and common thread.

Along with our Primary Purpose we also recognize that there

are secondary purposes, such as practicing the principles in all our affairs. We reach out via committees to educate and inform audiences of who we are, what we are, and what we offer. For example, the professional community needs to know how to help their clients and patients. These additional purposes are a direct result of our general service structure.

2. How does "Singleness of Purpose" relate to our Third and Fifth Traditions?

Tradition Three: (Short form) "The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking." (Long form) "Our membership ought to include all who suffer from alcoholism. Hence we may refuse none who wish to recover. Nor ought A.A. membership ever depend upon money or conformity. Any two or three alcoholics gathered together for sobriety may call themselves an A.A. group, provided that, as a group, they have no other affiliation."

Tradition Five: (Short form) "Each group has but one primary purpose — to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers." (Long form) "Each Alcoholics Anonymous group ought to be a spiritual entity having but one primary purpose — that of carrying its message to the alcoholic who still suffers."

Singleness of Purpose and the Third Tradition are spiritual tools to connect us to our Primary Purpose. Singleness of Purpose tells us that alcohol is our common problem, and the Third Tradition tells us if we have a drinking problem we are in the right place. Singleness of Purpose gives us a common ground that serves as a starting point in recovery. It helps us to admit we are alcoholics. It relates to our Third Tradition, "the only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking."

We implement Singleness of Purpose with our code of love and tolerance. We show concern for the welfare of each other through expressions of love and tolerance, gentleness and allowing an individual time to find out if he/she belongs in A.A. The Third Tradition helps us love and welcome into the program everyone who has a drinking problem. It allows us to stay in A.A. while we begin to understand why we are here and to learn that there is another way out. It avoids the distraction of naming who should or shouldn't belong, stresses the desire to stop drinking, and opens the door to the suffering to be welcomed.

It is our responsibility to offer help in the form of our personal strength, hope, and experience, with how we live one day at a time without drinking. It is a great gift to tell our stories. The Fifth Tradition is how we carry the message. Groups carry the message of sobriety in a way that appeals to its members — through identification, naming the problem, and learning that alcoholism is a part of the whole of life. When we listen we hear what our problem really is and what we can do about it. Tradition Five provides a means of avoiding rigidity and orthodoxy for A.A. as a whole; it allows us to stay and find the focus we need to carry the message to other alcoholics.

Singleness of Purpose applies to Traditions Three and Five, both of which define our Fellowship's Singleness of Purpose. Tradition Three is who and what we are, and Tradition Five is what we do. Both Traditions help us to address the alcohol problem, remain humble, and protect our unity. Traditions Three and Five are bridged through sponsorship, by guiding members through their fears and problems, especially if they might lead to a drink. We talk to a person after the meeting and make a habit of including people by practicing patience and tolerance.

The short form of Tradition Three speaks of the desire to stop drinking and the long form references the recovery from alcoholism. Dual purpose meetings imply a requirement other than alcoholism, which challenges Tradition Three. We have been moving away from the Traditions by allowing the treatment centers to do our work. We need the Traditions to stop drinking.

3. What can we do to clearly communicate our "Singleness of Purpose" without becoming too rigid?

We can welcome newcomers in a warm and accepting manner, talk to them one-on-one, and offer them unconditional love and tolerance. We can recognize that it takes time for newcomers to learn to listen. Focusing on Step One helps us to communicate Singleness of Purpose with newcomers.

We can do our own inventories (personal, group, district, area, general service conference, etc.), work the Steps, sponsor others, and lead by example when speaking and sponsoring. We can also spend more time listening.

We can also talk to our trusted servants one-on-one, develop dialogue, and talk with individuals before and after the meeting in a loving way. Oldtimers are used to talking to people after the meetings. We can talk about how we apply these principles and how that has changed our lives, share our experience with alcoholism so others can identify, share the program, not the Fellowship. Be loving, kind, firm, but not extreme in any way. Try not to come across as rigid, rather try to come across as clear. Realize that there is a fine line between caution and rigidity, and tell members the truth rather than what they want to hear. In some cases we have become too tolerant. Don't dwell on the problem; rather focus on the solution. Clarify what A.A. is and is not, and how A.A. cooperates, but does not affiliate. Explain not only what our singleness of purpose is, but why it is important. Rigidity in individuals and/or groups is based on fear, including fear of change.

Our groups are responsible for offering and providing our message through the inclusiveness of all who wish to recover. Introductions at meetings tell us who we are and what we are. Be specific in the meeting format how the group wants to approach Singleness of Purpose. The group should have a policy and an informed group conscious. Read the blue card at meetings, as it clearly states our purpose; read the Responsibility statement; rotate officers; have Traditions meetings; study the Traditions; share the long form of Tradition Three; have a literature display at meetings; be alert to the need for closed meetings; don't be confrontational in the group. Continue to show up and make A.A. meetings attractive.

Provide members with our literature, such as pamphlets, workbooks, newsletters, and manuals. Don't just give them a pamphlet to read, rather sit down and read it with them.

Provide and attend workshops and sharing sessions. Present skits and plays that display realistic behaviors in a humorous light, of individuals and meetings or groups, that may not necessarily be clear in the beginning of sobriety. Sponsor professionals.

Remind members, especially those that have been around for a while, to keep the focus on alcoholism. We should remember that most of us wanted to be unique by virtue of our multiple identifications. Open A.A. meetings don't mean that we can talk about anything. Refer people with other problems to other Twelve Step programs. Refer drug addicts to Narcotics Anonymous (N.A.) in a loving way. Many members of N.A. found their way through A.A. Learn by reading "The Importance of Identification" (from the 1988 Conference), written by a member of N.A. Read "Problems Other than Alcohol," but read the entire pamphlet, not just the excerpt. Encourage members to find outside help with a problem. Encourage members to focus on recovery from alcoholism, and everything else will fall into place. Our drinking problem is the thing that gives us our commonality and point of reference.

4. What measures can be used to clarify what A.A. is and is not and how A.A.

cooperates, but does not affiliate with: the Media; Treatment Centers; and Court Programs?

Communication is the simplest and most important key, keeping to the A.A. message as presented in A.A. literature and Guidelines. The General Service Office has a wealth of information to share on our responsibility to educate our membership and on how we can protect ourselves. Service committees have brochures that address how the member can be a successful guest or visitor when given these opportunities. Use the Grapevine, the literature information sheet, and the A.A. fact sheet with the contact and introduction letters, and videos. Provide A.A. members with more information and encourage them to do service work.

Learn from professionals the best way to meet with them, and invite representatives from the media, treatment centers and court programs to open A.A. meetings and gatherings. Send speakers and go personally to visit the media, treatment centers and court programs. Hold workshops, public information meetings, and one-on-one sessions. Share information at mini-conferences, sponsor luncheons and share days where professionals are invited to experience A.A.'s message first hand. Encourage active committees by sponsoring them at the district and area levels. Work to coordinate area and district efforts so they are not repeated. Pick committee chairs with care. Cooperate by working together.

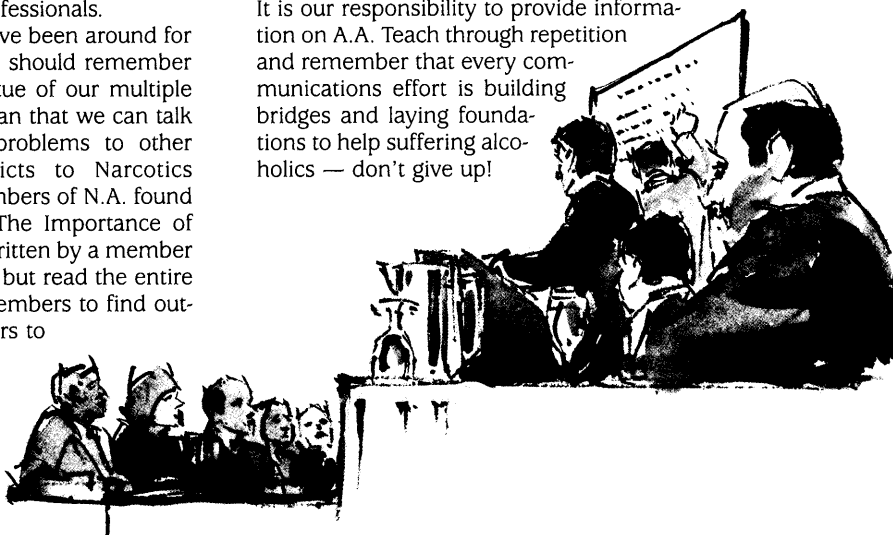
Media — while we have sent public information literature many times, the literature often never leaves the executive editor's desk. What is needed is constant follow-up with local public information committees. Keep public information work strictly with the alcoholic.

Treatment Centers — should be required to receive information since most treatment centers use A.A. as a treatment tool. Have constant follow-up by local treatment facility committees and talk with individuals at the treatment centers.

Court programs — emphasize that A.A. does not take attendance or vouch for meeting attendance, but that signatures are acquired on intervention basis. Assist courts with acquiring speakers from meetings rather than having persons sent to A.A. groups.

When we meet with professionals bring laughter, but above all continue to show up and demonstrate that continued effort and reaching out are part of our legacy of service, unity and recovery. Show them how willingness and spiritual needs are turned into action; display the unity statement — blue card — in large print, review and follow the Traditions. When we are informing a group we may need to limit what nonalcoholics share.

It is our responsibility to provide information on A.A. Teach through repetition and remember that every communications effort is building bridges and laying foundations to help suffering alcoholics — don't give up!



Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 2004 Conference.

FLOOR ACTIONS

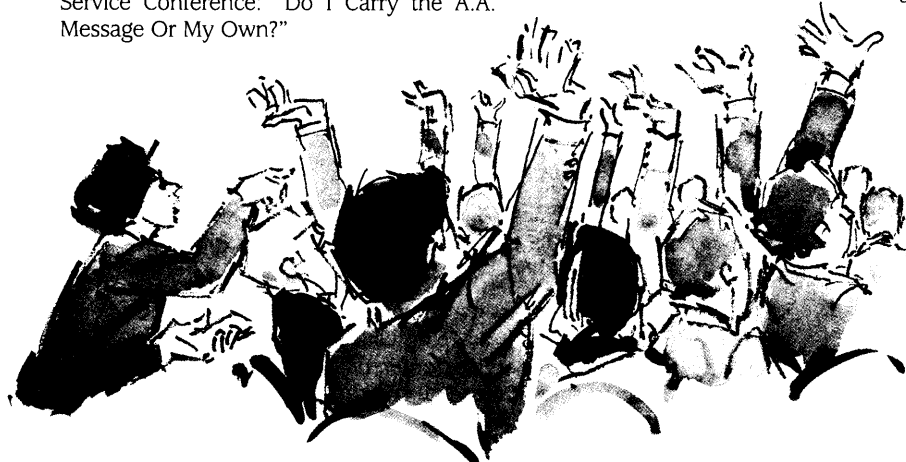
It was recommended that:

- 1 The punctuation in "Dr. Bob's Nightmare" in the Fourth Edition be restored as it appears in the Third Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*.
- 2 Centralized distribution and tracking of the two newest public service announcements "Reach Out" and "We Know What It's Like" be continued over the next year at a cost not to exceed \$30,000.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 3 The theme for the 2005 General Service Conference be: "Basics of Our Home Group—Recovery, Unity and Service."
- 4 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2005 General Service Conference:
 - a) Recovery:
 - 1) "How It Works" in Our Home Group
 - 2) Carrying the Message Through Practicing the Principles in Our Daily Lives
 - b) Unity:
 - 1) "Love and Tolerance of Others is Our Code" (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 84)
 - 2) The Basket—Where Money and Spirituality Mix
 - 3) The Spiritual Principle of Our Twelfth Tradition
 - c) Service:
 - 1) Concept One—Final Responsibility and Ultimate Authority
 - 2) Concept Five—Minority Opinion—Are We Listening?
 - 3) Leadership—Responsibility for A.A.'s Future—Concept Nine
- 5 The following be the workshop topic for the 2005 General Service Conference: "Do I Carry the A.A. Message Or My Own?"



¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

ARCHIVES¹

No recommendations.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

No recommendations.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

- 6 The trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities consider including the statement on A.A.'s Singleness of Purpose, which follows, in the pamphlet "A Message to Correctional Professionals":

"Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend *open* A.A. meetings, but only those with a *drinking* problem may attend *closed* meetings."

FINANCE

No recommendations.

GRAPEVINE

It was recommended that:

- 7 To allow the widest distribution of the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña to all purchasers, while guarding against affiliation with any outside enterprise, a) subscriptions to the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña magazines be issued only by the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., or by A.A. trusted servants directly; and b) the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., adopt standardized sales practices and pricing structures for all purchasers.

Note: This recommendation is to clarify the 1993 Advisory Action stating that "the Grapevine Corporate Board not actively pursue the placement of Grapevine materials for resale in commercial (non-A.A.) outlets."

- 8 The pamphlet "The A.A. Grapevine: Our Meeting in Print" be revised to include the proposed references to La Viña and La Viña representatives where the Grapevine magazine and its representatives are mentioned.
- 9 The A.A. Grapevine Workbook be designated as service material and be reviewed on an annual basis by the Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

It was recommended that:

- 10 An anonymity-protected photograph of the flag ceremony be taken at the 2005 International Convention.

- 11 The General Service Conference support the General Service Board Policy as amended on November 2, 2003, which reads:

"Whenever a discount or subsidy is that which would be offered to any other organization of similar size requiring a purchased service or product of similar character and magnitude, for example, convention rates at hotels, it may be accepted. Whenever a discount or subsidy is partly or in total offered because we are Alcoholics Anonymous, it must be declined."

Note: The original Board policy text contained the letters "i.e." which were replaced with the words "for example." The General Service Board amended the policy because "for example" more accurately reflected the intention of the 1989 trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums. The 1999 General Service Conference supported the Board's 1989 policy through an Advisory Action.

The committee noted the Additional Consideration of the 1999 Conference Committee on Finance which reads:

"The committee unanimously recognizes that the acceptance of discounts or subsidies in the form of cash causes discomfort to some members of our Fellowship. The committee suggests that any future negotiations regarding International Convention discounts or subsidies be carried out with this in mind."

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

- 12 The Publications Department rewrite the pamphlet "Too Young?" with changes to layout and style as determined by Publications, targeting the ages of 11-17, and present the revised draft pamphlet to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee following review by the trustees' Literature Committee.
- 13 The Publications Department update and shorten existing stories, wherever appropriate, in the pamphlet "Young People and A.A.," and that the trustees' Literature Committee add new younger age stories solicited from the Fellowship to reflect current experience, and present the revised draft pamphlet or a progress report to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee.
- 14 A draft Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, be developed by the trustees' Literature Committee and that a progress report be brought back to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee, in keeping with the trustees' recommendations on contents, process and story solicitation, as follows:
- I Contents
- a) The Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book to be similar in page count to the English Fourth Edition Big Book.
- b) The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, the Preface, the Forewords, "The Doctor's Opinion," "Dr. Bob's Nightmare," and the Appendices will undergo a complete review to assure accuracy of translation and consistency of style and tone throughout the text. As in translations of all languages, the Publications Department strives to reflect the best possible translation of Bill W.'s writings and does not require Conference approval.
- c) Personal Stories:
- Retain selected stories from current Spanish-language Second Edition.
 - Select stories from A.A.'s La Viña magazine.
 - Select new stories from Spanish-speaking membership.
 - Stories to be designated to three main sections similar to the English Fourth Edition Big Book.
- II Story Solicitation
- a) Within the United States and Canada and internationally to Spanish-speaking countries.
- III Story Selection Process
- a) To be under the direction of the trustees' Literature subcommittee on the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book.
- b) Story selection subcommittee:
- All bilingual—Spanish and English
 - Spanish editors
 - Spanish-speaking staff members
 - Chair to appoint some subcommittee members from the Fellowship
- c) Basic Selection Criteria:
- To use the same criteria as the English Fourth Edition Big Book based on Bill W.'s recommendations.
 - Each story must, as Bill W. recommended, reach out to the newcomer who is still looking for the A.A. solution.
 - Each story must be a standard A.A. story that tells what it was like, what happened, and what it is like today.
- 15 The text on page 11 under the heading "May a newcomer have more than one sponsor?" in the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" be removed and replaced with the following text:
- "Many feel it is best for a newcomer to have only one sponsor. Choosing one sponsor helps to avoid the precarious practice of a newcomer going from sponsor to sponsor seeking the advice he or she wants to hear.
- "However, some newcomers benefit from more than one sponsor. Here the newcomer shares in a wide range of experience and hears a great variety of ways to use the A.A. program. In addition, this is a means of averting the crisis mentioned in the preceding question — it is unlikely that two or more sponsors would be unavailable at the same time."
- and, the sentence "Again, the answer is yes." be removed from the paragraph under the heading "May a newcomer change sponsors?" on page 11.
- 16 The trustees' Literature Committee broaden the section titled "Service Sponsorship" on page 28 in the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" to reflect current shared experience and present a revised draft to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

- 17 The 57th General Service Conference be held April 22-28, 2007, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.
- 18 The use of personal computers at General Service Conferences be approved in keeping with the "Guidelines for PC Users at the General Service Conference" as contained in a report from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.

Note: The Conference coordinator will continue to notify Conference members annually of the availability of up to 24 spaces complete with power outlets for the use of personal computers at the General Service Conference. If the number of requests for the use of personal computers exceeds 24, the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions will review the Guidelines.

- 19 The request for an additional delegate area from Area 15, South Florida, Bahamas, U.S. Virgin Islands, British Virgin Islands and Antigua be denied. The committee suggested that the area reconsider this request and explore alternatives at the area level to address the challenges of the general service structure in Area 15.
- 20 The current practice for viewing or examining all materials other than service material submitted for Conference approval be continued, adhering to the principle of the "right of decision" throughout the Conference process.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

- 21 The tag line on all radio P.S.A.s be changed from "Look us up in the phone book" or "Phone or check your newspaper," to the tag line, "Look us up. Check your phone book, newspaper or aa.org."
- 22 After reviewing the report from the General Service Board on oversight of G.S.O's A.A. Web site:
 - a) The A.A.W.S. Board should continue to manage the Web site through its Services Committee.
 - b) Any correspondence, requests for changes or requests for reports on the Web site would continue to be responded to by the A.A.W.S. Board.
 - c) The A.A.W.S. Board would be responsible for preparing a quarterly report to the trustees' Public Information Committee for their review. The report would include the following information:
 - Changes to the Web site.
 - Updates on Web site activity.
 - A summary of requests or correspondence from the Fellowship regarding the Web site and a summary of actions taken by

the A.A.W.S. Board in response to those requests or correspondence.

- d) The A.A.W.S. Board would prepare an annual report for the trustees' P.I. Committee summarizing all Web site quarterly report information. The report, along with any additional comments from the trustees' Committee, would be forwarded to the Conference P.I. Committee for their consideration.
- e) The Conference Public Information Committee agenda would include a permanent agenda item, "Consider report from the trustees' P.I. Committee regarding G.S.O's A.A. Web site."

As with the placing of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book on the Web site, the A.A.W.S. Board may consult the General Service Conference, trustees' P.I. Committee, the Conference P.I. Committee and any other trustees' committee or Conference committee, as appropriate, if *major* changes were to be made to the G.S.O's A.A. Web site.

- 23 The 2004 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis as was done in the 2001 A.A. Membership Survey.

REPORT AND CHARTER

No recommendations.

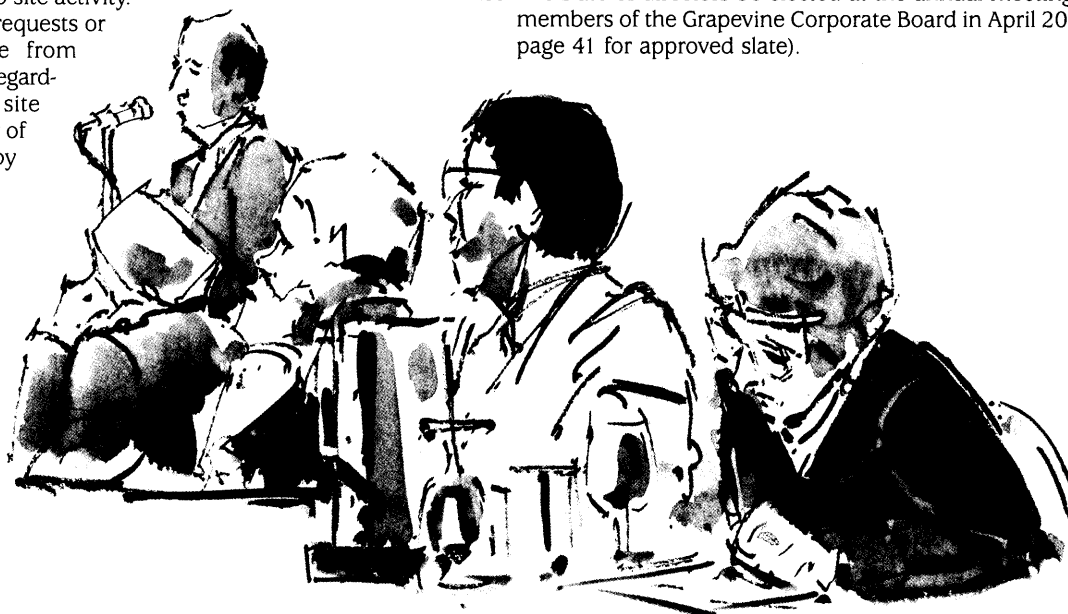
TREATMENT FACILITIES

No recommendations.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

- 24 The slate of trustees and officers be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April 2004 (see page 41 for approved slate).
- 25 The slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. World Services Corporate Board in April 2004 (see page 41 for approved slate).
- 26 The slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the Grapevine Corporate Board in April 2004 (see page 41 for approved slate).



Presentations and Reports

REPORT: FINANCE

Monday afternoon the Finance report, followed by a sharing session, was given by Vince Keefe, treasurer of the General Service Board and, chairman of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. For more details please see the finance section of this Report, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary report.

Good afternoon. My name is Vince Keefe. I am a grateful Class A trustee and treasurer of the General Service Board. I consider it a privilege to deliver the finance report today.

My report is composed of three parts: First, I would like to review the financial results for 2003, along with the budgets for 2004; second, I would like to comment on several trends that have developed in recent years; and third, I would like to pose the question "Are we focusing on the right question?"

The complete report of our independent auditor, Owen J. Flanagan and Company, is in the finance section of the *Final Conference Report*. Our audit partner, Kevin Sunkel, is in attendance this afternoon and is available to answer any questions that may arise from this talk. Also available today are Don Meurer, chief financial officer of the General Service Office, and Eugene O'Brien, controller of the A.A. Grapevine. We all recognize and appreciate the dedication and outstanding service these three talented individuals perform for the Fellowship.

As some of you know, last year I entitled my presentation "Not to Decide, Is to Decide." This year my theme is "Are We Focusing on the Right Question?"

Grapevine magazine income of \$1,691,467 declined from the previous year. Subscriptions also declined, from 115,753 in 2002 to 112,614 in 2003. Even though subscription income declined, the gross profit increased over 2002. This increase is primarily due to the postage pass-through previously enacted, plus an increase in sales of other literature items. Costs and expenses were \$1,626,148. After accounting for interest income, the result is an operating profit of \$5,366. The 2004 budget anticipates about the same level of subscription income, along with increases in the sales of other literature items. Profit is expected to increase to \$105,104.

In 2003, the General Service Board General Fund received group contributions of \$5,100,000, approximately equal to 2002. The cost of services performed by the General Service Office, on behalf of the General Service Board, amounted to \$7,088,000, leaving a shortfall in contributions of \$1,998,000. Next, there is a breakdown of these services, along with the cost of each component by group. The publishing activities generated net sales of \$10,467,700 and a profit from literature sales of \$1,341,566.

The combined result shows that the publishing income offset most of the shortfall in the cost of services when compared with contributions. The management team did an outstanding job of planning the budget and following through to stay within the plan.

The 2004 budget for the General Service Office anticipates group contributions of \$5,175,000, which is approximately

equal to 2003. Net literature sales are anticipated to increase slightly to \$10,666,700. This level of income is expected to leave a deficit for the year 2004 of \$618,241. This is after including additional revenue from the expected price restoration of the Big Book. Although the Big Book price restoration is set for July 1, 2004, the full impact will not be felt until late in 2004 because of the normal ordering patterns of groups and intergroups.

The General Service Board continued to fund La Viña, the Spanish-language project approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. The average monthly subscriptions increased in 2003 to 9,222, which is an increase of 2.5%. The overall loss for this project in 2003 was \$111,638. The General Service Board has invested \$779,757, since the inception of this project. Capital projects equaled \$557,457 with \$119,932 for the Grapevine Archiving project and \$437,525 for the computer upgrade project.

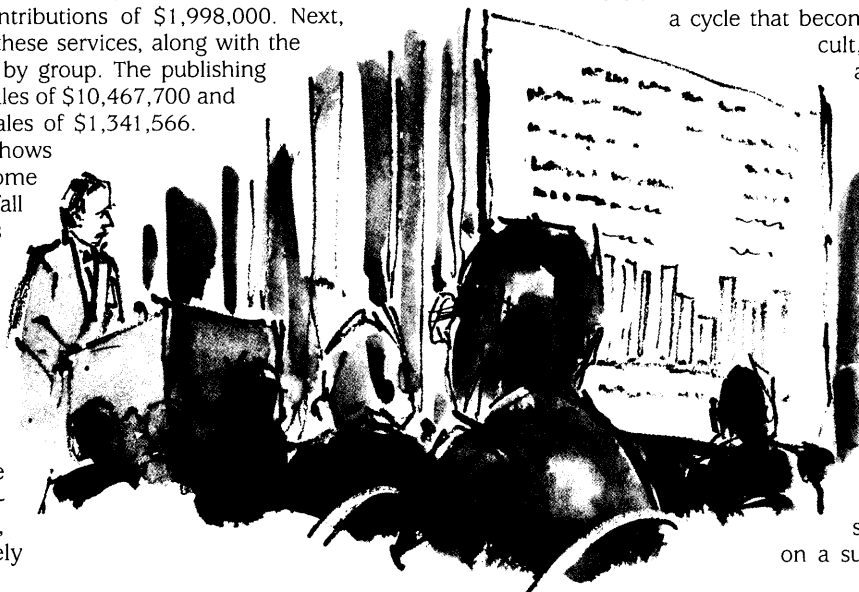
The Reserve Fund ended 2003 with a balance of \$9,730,931, equal to approximately 9.7 months of operating expenses. Looked at another way, the Reserve Fund balance equals approximately \$7.57 per member, or \$169 per group. This may be a better analysis from the member's perspective.

Now I would like to point to a few of the trends that have developed in recent years. Let's look at the five-year trend of group contributions. It is interesting to note that contributions stopped growing at about the same time that we reduced the price of the Big Book to lower the prudent Reserve. It seems possible to me that the Fellowship may have changed the basic way they view the need for group contributions. Has the message of an excessive Reserve Fund been interpreted as a declining need for contributions? If so, what will happen as operating expenses continue to increase due to inflation? My concern is that we could be forced into a cycle of needing to continually increase literature prices as a way to balance the operating budgets. What do you, as delegates, think about this trend? What actions if any should we be taking?

Grapevine magazine subscriptions continue to decline. Because of this, the Grapevine is becoming more and more dependent on developing additional income from other literature items to balance the operating budget. What do we make of this trend? Why have subscriptions declined to around 112,500 when we have over 1.2 million members in the U.S. and Canada? Each year that we continue to depend on new literature revenue, we not only need more items to sell, we also need to continue to sell more and more of the developed items. This could be

a cycle that becomes more and more difficult, if not impossible, to achieve. And more importantly, do we start to lose focus on the primary purpose of the Grapevine magazine? Is the Grapevine "fading away" right before our eyes? Have we become complacent?

The corporate boards have a very good system for keeping our costs, revenues, and the Reserve Fund in balance. It strikes me that the Reserve Fund is similar to the ballast tank on a submarine. When the cap-



tain needs to submerge the submarine the order is given to pump water into the ballast, displacing the air, and down goes the sub. On the other hand, when submerged and water is pumped out of the ballast tank, the sub rises. Our Reserve Fund planning is very similar and just as effective.

As you know, a number of years ago the Reserve Fund balance had grown to the point where it was the equivalent to 11.6 months of operating expenses. This is the high end of the generally accepted range of 9 to 12 months. We needed to do something to keep the Reserve Fund from increasing any further. The course of action chosen was to reduce the price of the Big Book by \$1.00 coincident with the publication of the Fourth Edition. This decision worked exactly as planned, as our Reserve Fund at December 31, 2003 can now cover only about 9.7 months of operating expenses.

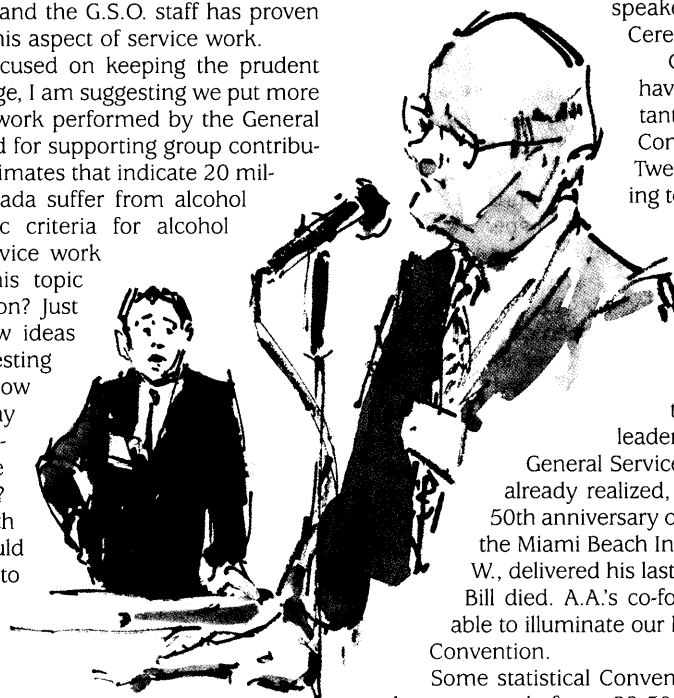
In 2004 we see a different situation developing. As we look out over the next few years, it is clear that the Reserve Fund balance is now dropping and will soon fall below the acceptable range. Now we need to take opposite steps to reduce the annual deficits. As a result, the A.A.W.S. Board has recommended that we restore the price of the Big Book and reduce the deficits, therefore halting the decline in the Reserve Fund balance. The General Service Board approved this action at the January 2004 meeting.

We certainly have an efficient method of keeping the Reserve Fund within an acceptable range. While our processes are efficient and keep finances in balance, I wonder if we are focused on the wrong objective. After all, is our objective to balance the finances or is our objective to "reach out to the still-suffering alcoholic?" Would we reach more suffering alcoholics if we focused more on the service work and less on the prudent Reserve Fund?

We all recognize that the one-on-one Twelfth Step work performed at the group level is the most important way the Fellowship reaches out to the alcoholic who asks for help. And then there is all the work done at the local, district, and area level that far exceeds the volume of work that is done at the G.S.O. I do not suggest we diminish this work in any way, including the financial contributions that the groups make supporting this work. The G.S.O. is simply an additional way that this very important work can be accomplished, and the G.S.O. staff has proven to be very good at carrying out this aspect of service work.

Instead of being primarily focused on keeping the prudent Reserve within an acceptable range, I am suggesting we put more focus on the amount of service work performed by the General Service Office, as well as the need for supporting group contributions. I have read professional estimates that indicate 20 million people in the U.S. and Canada suffer from alcohol dependency or meet diagnostic criteria for alcohol abuse disorder. Would more service work increase our reach? What if this topic were a Fellowship-wide discussion? Just imagine the viewpoints and new ideas that could surface. Lots of interesting discussions could take place. How do we do it better? How do we pay the cost? What does the membership really want? What if? Are we focusing on the right question? Perhaps the members of the 54th General Service Conference could best contribute by finding ways to launch this discussion.

*Vincent E. Keefe, treasurer,
General Service Board*



2005 INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

Monday afternoon Rick Walker, filling in for Convention coordinator Doug Richardson, gave Conference members a progress report on plans for A.A.'s 70th Birthday Party. The session was chaired by Pacific regional trustee Phyllis Halliday. Following the Presentation there was a two-minute film of Toronto and G.S.O. staff members presented a skit based on experiences from past International Conventions.

In a little less than 15 months, we will meet to celebrate A.A.'s 70th Birthday at our International Convention in Toronto, Ontario, Canada. June 30—July 3, 2005 are the dates—so mark your calendar! Plans are well under way to make this a joyous and memorable event.

Toronto, in the Huron language, means "meeting place," and what could be a more appropriate name for a location where A.A. members will gather to celebrate sobriety? And a "meeting place" it will be, with lots of meetings and more meetings, along with panels and workshops, plus marathons and, of course, those extraordinary Big Meetings in the SkyDome Stadium—all packed into four joyous days.

The festivities will begin Thursday evening with a "Party in the Park," right behind the South Building of the Metro Toronto Convention Center. The fun will overflow onto the plaza of the CN Tower, a Toronto landmark, and music will fill the summer night from the three or four dances that are planned. At midnight on Thursday, our marathon meetings get under way and run continuously until Sunday morning.

Friday night in the SkyDome will mark the Opening Ceremonies, which include the exciting Parade of Flags of those countries represented at the Convention, followed by the three-speaker Big A.A. Meeting. The wonderful Oldtimers Stadium Meeting will take place on Saturday night, and the good news in 2005 is that this year we are giving the oldtimers, whose names are selected from the hat, a little bit more time to share their experience, strength and hope. And for the finale, on Sunday morning, we will have our customary three-speaker Big Meeting with the Closing Ceremonies.

Our International A.A. Conventions have often been focal points for important moments in A.A. history. At the first Convention, in Cleveland in 1950, our Twelve Traditions were confirmed, helping to ensure the future of our Fellowship.

At the same time, the members assembled there had the sad privilege of hearing Dr. Bob speak before an A.A. audience for the last time. At the 1955 Convention in St. Louis, Missouri, at 4 o'clock in the afternoon, Bill W. declared that A.A. had "come of age," and the

leadership of A.A. was turned over to the General Service Conference. And, as you may have already realized, Sunday, July 3, 2005, will mark the 50th anniversary of that milestone moment. In 1970, at the Miami Beach International, our ailing co-founder, Bill W., delivered his last, powerful message; six months later Bill died. A.A.'s co-founders, Bob and Bill W., were each able to illuminate our lives one last time at an International Convention.

Some statistical Convention highlights include seeing attendance catapult from 22,500 at the 1980 Convention in New

Orleans, to 45,600 at our 50th Birthday celebration in 1985 in Montreal. The 1995 Convention in San Diego was spectacular, with our largest attendance ever of 54,000 paid attendees. At our last gathering, in Minneapolis in 2000, the convention center sold 75,000 cups of coffee, half a ton of soft ice cream and one ton of French fries. Caffeine, sugar and grease—someone, someday may research the diet of a sober alcoholic.

Beside the significant historical facts and numbers, we know that every member who attends an International Convention takes away their own cherished and memorable experiences. All of us who are able to go to Toronto will, I'm pretty sure, have these experiences. Many of us will travel to Toronto with old friends, sponsors or home group members, having those on-the-road meetings that form such an important part of our Fellowship sharing. At the Convention, new, lifelong friendships will be made. Twelfth Step work will take place—perhaps just seeing our joy and our numbers will plant a seed for someone's future sobriety. Those A.A. "coincidences" will occur—a friend you loved and lost track of will show up sober. Someone on your Eighth Step list will appear and provide you with the opportunity to make amends; perhaps you'll be on their Eighth Step list, as well. We'll hear a speaker talk at a topic meeting or an oldtimer share at the Saturday night Big Meeting and something they say will open up a new and positive perspective we hadn't considered. In the wee hours of the morning, while we fellowship over ice cream and coffee with someone, our life may be led down an entirely new or different path. International Conventions offer the occasion for rich and varied experiences, some dramatic and historical, others quiet and serene. Whenever I have listened to someone talk who has attended an International Convention, they speak of it as a highlight of their sobriety, and the emotion universally expressed has been one of gratitude—gratitude for sobriety in A.A. and for having had the opportunity to celebrate that sobriety with tens of thousands of other A.A. members in one place.

For this presentation, I did some research on past International Conventions. I talked with past G.S.O. Convention coordinators and staff, and found dozens of anecdotes recorded in the A.A. Grapevine and Box 4-5-9. There were some fun times and interesting moments that have been shared over the years. I'll share some with you now. As you may be aware, when planning these International Conventions, we try very hard to emphasize to hotels and convention centers in the cities chosen as Convention sites the magnitude of our event, yet the message doesn't always get across. At one Convention disaster struck when all the major facilities in the city ran out of coffee—we drank them dry. But worse was yet to happen—during another Convention in another city, they ran out of toilet paper.

These International Conventions are also opportunities to let the newcomer and the world know we are not a glum lot.

From the beginning of these events, the A.A. spirit experienced at our International Conventions has been cause for comment from local non-A.A.s. In 1950, a cab driver in Cleveland stated that we were the nicest convention they had ever had. Another cabbie commented, "If one of you fellows asked to be taken to a gin mill, we wouldn't do it...that's all!" In the interests of protecting one member's sobriety, a restaurant in Seattle refused to serve a glass of wine the A.A. member had ordered for his Al-Anon wife. A lady taxi driver in Seattle commented, "You people have something special. You make me feel good. I'm usually dragged out by these summer conventions, but this time I'm looking forward to each run. Even when one of you gets cranky, the others talk him out of it. I've never seen anything like it. I wish I could send my kids."

In Miami in 1970—where the registration fee, by the way, was \$6.00—a woman noted, "People, people everywhere, but not a

drop to drink!" In New Orleans, in 1980, the fire department was called out three times because the smoke level in the convention hall was dangerously high (ah, for the days of ashtrays at meetings). Also, at that same Convention, rumors had spread that there was an A.A. nudists' workshop taking place and some serious inquiries were made as to where it was being held. The individual writing about this rumor suggested that, if true, a group should be formed and called "The Naked Truth Group." A woman who attended the International Convention in Montreal in 1985 innocently checked into a local motel; when she checked out in the morning, she discovered she had been charged for her room by the hour—it was "one of those" places.

I recently heard from a couple of oldtimers who called G.S.O. asking for information about the 2005 Convention, and they each shared how they had met Bill W. in Toronto at the 1965 International Convention. One man, in fact, was a volunteer who was assigned as Bill's "hand guard." What's a "hand guard?," you ask? So many people wanted to shake Bill's hand that it got painfully sore, so this fellow's job was to keep folks from shaking our co-founder's hand. He didn't explain how he accomplished that. Perhaps it should have been a job for an Al-Anon member.

And now we are coming up to the 2005 Convention. The theme for this, our 12th International A.A. Convention, is "I Am Responsible." It was at the 1965 celebration of A.A.'s 30th Anniversary, whose theme was "Responsibility," that over 10,000 attendees for the first time declared in unison, "When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that I am responsible." This theme gives all members of our "we" Fellowship the opportunity to reflect on our individual responsibilities to the still-suffering alcoholic, to the newcomer, to each other and to A.A. as a whole.

Speaking of individual responsibility, with about 15 months remaining before the Convention, there is still a decent amount of time for those who wish to attend this event, and who may have legal challenges related to past felonies or drunk driving convictions, to investigate the procedures for getting clearance to enter Canada and to process the paper work necessary to get such clearance. The Canadian government provides information on this matter, which can be obtained from numerous Canadian Consulate offices in the United States or from embassies here and abroad, or on the Internet.

In late August we will be mailing out the Convention Registration Forms to all Conference members, to the G.S.R.s of all groups listed with us, to all U.S./Canada and international Intergroups and Central Offices and to all international G.S.O.s. Once registration forms and fees have been received, Housing Forms will be mailed. Members will also be able to register online, pay the fee online and fill out the Housing Form online starting September 7, 2004. The lottery for the Housing process will commence on November 15, 2004, when the Toronto Housing Bureau will begin randomly processing the forms.

A major part of organizing this event is working with the Volunteer Host Committee. An able and excited Host Core Committee is in place, and we anticipate upward of 4,000 volun-

Don Mollins (New Brunswick/PEI) was told by his Conference buddy "you are in for the ride of your life" – but neither would have guessed that it would be in an ambulance! When Don suffered a medical emergency New York A.A. Walter Goldberger (79th St. Workshop Group) showed up at the hospital, went on a second ambulance ride to another hospital, stayed with Don all day, and talked with his wife by phone. A shining example of how A.A. works.

teers to be welcoming members to Toronto from all over the world.

So, one day at a time, we are working toward an international celebration of A.A.'s 70th Birthday, which we know will be a powerful example of sharing, gratitude and joy and will encompass the language of the heart. In going over those wonderful articles in the A.A. Grapevine about past International Conventions, I came across a letter to the editor from a member who had attended the 1955 Convention in St. Louis and evidently had been asked to report on his experiences there. In his letter, he described hearing all those wonderful people who were part of our early history: Bill, of course, the Rev. Sam Shoemaker, Father Ed Dowling, Dr. Harry Tiebout and Dr. Jack Norris, among them. He was very moved by the Convention experience; in fact, he signed his letter "Altered Ego." He added a P.S. to the letter and then added a P.P.S. This is "Altered Ego's" P.P.S.: "And please insert under 'highlights' your reporter's own big moment when he heard Dr. Bob's son repeat in a quiet remembrance, his father's unforgettable admonition to A.A.s wherever they may be . . . and whenever: 'Keep it simple, remember it started around a kitchen table.'" For all the special surroundings of our 2005 International get-together—a world-class city, a splendid convention center and the spectacular SkyDome Stadium, let's keep Dr. Bob's image in our minds—that it started at a kitchen table with one alcoholic sharing with another. We know that the basic foundation of all the benefits we possess and all the sober joy and gratitude that we have and will witness in Toronto in 2005 is our primary purpose—for each of us to stay sober and to help another alcoholic achieve sobriety . . . and for that I am responsible.

Doug Richardson, G.S.O. staff

A.A. ARCHIVES: WHAT'S NEW?

Monday evening's Presentation was chaired by Ric Downey, Western Canada regional trustee. Following the archivist's presentation Conference members were treated to recordings of early A.A.s and family members.

Update on the Audio Preservation Project

We have been reporting to you in the last couple of years on the ongoing audio preservation work at the Archives. This year was time to take stock of the project and look at where we started and where we are today.

The audio preservation project was initiated in 2000 in response to growing concerns in professional archival circles regarding the quickly deteriorating audio collections at various organizations. The project we started three years ago will be completed this year, which means that thousands of reel-to-reel tapes, vinyl records, cassettes and audiographs will be transferred to a CD-ROM format. Today we would like to play a couple of samples from this vast collection. There are no particular reasons we selected these samples. We could have selected thousands of others just as interesting, and we would still have the feeling: don't stop the tape now, let it roll on. After all, which one of us ever tires of listening to Bill W., Dr. Bob, or any of the oldtimers relating their experiences.

I would like to make a brief explanation of what is going on currently with this project, as well as what our plans are for the future. As a starting point, let me note that the original records, reels, vinyls, and cassettes were stored virtually untouched for decades. A large number of recordings carried extensive personal notations on their labels—notes regarding the individual speakers, dates, descriptions of the circumstances of the talks, explanations for comments made on the audio, etc.

We are currently in the process of creating a catalog for these items, where all information from the labels will be included. As we say in archival terminology, several series have been created and these series are reflected in a catalog number that we assign to these tapes: General Service Conference series, International Convention series, Bill W. series, and oral histories/ talks in general series. You can imagine the labor intensiveness of the three-year project thus far, as we have been packaging the old tapes, shipping them out for transfer, receiving them and matching the originals with the CD-ROM copies, and entering everything into a new catalog. Notice, we haven't said a word about listening to this vast collection of talks. Like everything else in A.A., we can only handle a mega-project of this magnitude a step at a time. The first step—to complete the audio transfer in this calendar year, by this summer most likely—has also been the most pressing, as we have been losing the audio material due to the rapid deterioration. The second step is to transfer the information from the labels to create a new catalog for these items, as well as new and more easily accessible categories for each series.

Then comes the third step, which reflects a fundamental underlying question: what are we going to do with these tapes once they have been transferred? Are we going to put them back into the old cabinets, back into oblivion, and not touch them again for another 20 years or so, when probably the next preservation project will have to be scheduled? How can we best use this material?

The next phase in this project will be just as large in its scope as the first, namely, to access the contents of individual records, some of which are very important business records, similar to the audio records of this current General Service Conference being recorded right now as we speak. The contents of these early business records have been unavailable even to the G.S.O. until now. All we had to rely upon, in our own background research, were the early *Conference Reports*, and the recollections of longtime supporters of the Fellowship. We still actively use the help of longtime Conference attendees such as Mike Alexander, Dennis Manders, and others, in order to clarify certain things for us. Now, however, we will also have a chance to listen to the original debates, try to understand the original reasoning, hear out the original arguments pro and con on an issue, so we at the General Service Office can make more informed decisions on what we are doing today. I don't think that I am incorrect in thinking that there is a very serious learning curve in front of us by just listening to the early business records of Alcoholics Anonymous. Other records will have, naturally, a historic significance and interest to researchers, both internal and outside, that would clarify or expand upon material that has been saved on paper documentation in the Archives.

To be very realistic, this "listening phase" will not be an easy task in the next couple of years. Just listening to a couple of tapes, trying to find excerpts that give a sense of times in a few short minutes, made me realize that there are mistakes on the old labels. Personalities are misnamed, dates are incorrectly noted, etc. So this listening experience will have to be done with sufficient attention to make sure that corrections are made when necessary.

Here are examples from some of the audio material that was rescued, literally in the last minute, from total disaster and at a tremendous loss for us and all those coming after us to enjoy the gifts of our Fellowship.

[Judith then played recordings of the following: Bill phone call to Forth Worth, TX recorded without his knowledge—6 minutes; oldtimers Dr. Bob, Ann Smith, Betty (Dr. Bob's daughter-in-law), Smith (Bob, Jr.), Bill and Lois; early fund raising—"life among the anonimi."]

Judith Santon, archivist

OUR SINGLENESSE OF PURPOSE

Susan Campbell, Grapevine director, moderated the following presentation/discussion session Tuesday afternoon.

Our Responsibility to the Newcomer

My name is Andy Talbert and I am an alcoholic. I am privileged and proud to be the delegate in Area 53—Panel 53, serving the 38 counties through 42 districts of Central and Southeast Ohio.

Because no single individual may speak for Alcoholics Anonymous, this becomes *my* responsibility to the newcomer, my responsibility to myself for each morning I wake up a newcomer. I now have a responsibility to practice the principles of the A.A. program in all my affairs; to carry myself in a manner and with actions that attract others to want what we have. I must be available as in our Responsibility Statement "When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I am responsible."

This is not *my* program I practice. My program was to lie, cheat, and steal; my program led me to be alone; it is "The Program," a Fellowship of men and women who come together to share 12 suggested Steps, Traditions, and Concepts, developed to daily teach me—as a newcomer, as a student—to learn a way of living which demands rigorous honesty, while practicing principles for others to emulate. When the program began it was one drunk talking to another, sharing, *not telling*, their experiences; it was unconditional love, expressed through *listening*, not just hearing voices of despair and offering the hope found through personal recovery; the togetherness of friends we have not met being there when we need them for many hours of conversation, sharing the strengths gained from following these Steps, practicing these Traditions; and the ever present cup of coffee.

My responsibility is also that I continue the primary purpose, as defined in the last line of our A.A. Preamble "to stay sober and help other alcoholics to achieve sobriety." To show the newcomer the meaning of living one day at a time, and to offer a way out to a new life of acceptance of God's will for us. First, my responsibility is to stay sober, for without my personal sobriety I am unable to do anything in my life and I cannot follow through with my second responsibility, that I help other alcoholics achieve sobriety. Each day I must practice the single message of recovery from alcoholism, not only for my own recovery, but also to carry this message to those yet to come, for I am now a part of a greater whole. I am a member of a great society of men and women who practice being responsive to others, who have but one purpose—to stay sober and to help others to achieve sobriety. These are not new ideas or foreign concepts, but they are difficult for me and for newcomers. Unless I maintain an improved conscious contact with a God of my understanding I am prone to return to my easier softer way; then I might possibly return to drinking.

Who would believe that each morning I awake to join millions of other sober alcoholics in being grateful for this one day, to share my experiences with others. Just by taking my seat in a meeting shows others it works, to not judge and not be judged, to give away freely what I have been given, for those yet to come. This is my responsibility to the newcomer, this is A.A.'s responsibility to the newcomer, and this is A.A.'s responsibility to me.

Andy Talbert, Ohio

Communicating Our Singleness of Purpose

In Eastern Pennsylvania when someone mentions fear of service opportunities, you will likely hear the statement: "God does not choose the qualified, He qualifies those He chooses." Bill [Archer],



thank you for your loving invitation to share on this topic. And God, I hope you did your job.

Traditions Three, Five and Six speak to our singleness of purpose. Tradition Three is who we're about; Tradition Five is what we're about; and, Tradition Six is what we must not be about. Tradition Three states, "The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking." It ensures that the road to A.A. is accessible to all alcoholics who wish to travel its path. In honoring this Tradition, our groups communicate the spiritual principles of inclusiveness and identification. When I came into A.A., I didn't want to be an alcoholic and tried with all my might to convince myself that I wasn't. One day I happened to notice the Third Tradition, and it dawned on me that it didn't matter whether I was or wasn't an alcoholic. I knew I had an alcohol problem and I knew I didn't want to drink anymore. Tradition Three allowed me to quit the debating society and start the identification process. I found a sponsor who walked me through the Steps, and who told me to do the same with others. She said that I not only carry the message, I am the message. Everything I do and say in A.A. must communicate to others that A.A. has one single purpose—recovery from alcoholism through the practice of the Twelve Steps of Alcoholics Anonymous. This is our message of hope.

Tradition Five states: "Each group has but one primary purpose—to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers." When a group honors Tradition Five, it communicates the spiritual principles of simplicity and purpose. In *As Bill Sees It*, (p. 79) Bill writes "This is why sobriety—freedom from alcohol—through the teaching and practice of A.A.'s Twelve Steps, is the sole purpose of the group. If we don't stick to this cardinal principle, we shall almost certainly collapse. And if we collapse, we cannot help anyone." In our groups we must communicate that message to every newcomer, and even to the "not so newcomer" who thinks that our meetings are dumping grounds for drug talk, relationship problems, spending, and everything other than alcohol. It is our responsibility to help those persons learn about and understand our single purpose and, if necessary, we should help them get to the appropriate program, *always* remembering that love and tolerance of others is our code.

In *The Language of the Heart*, (p. 82) Bill writes: "How well we need to heed the principle that it is better to do one thing supremely well than many things badly." He goes on to warn us "Temptations to do otherwise will come aplenty."

The Grapevine's Traditions Checklist asks the question: "Do I ever cop out by saying, 'I'm not a group, so this or that Tradition doesn't apply to me?' " As individuals, we can make a difference in our groups by sticking to recovery from alcoholism. At a workshop recently, a young woman shared an allegory about the King of Denmark. It seems that the king one day went out alone on horseback. A visitor to the country was surprised to see the king unattended and asked one of the citizens if the king didn't have a bodyguard. The citizen replied with pride, "We are all his bodyguards." Each member of A.A. who sticks individually to our singleness of purpose becomes part of the citizenry of bodyguards who communicate and protect our Fellowship. My home group communicates our singleness of purpose. Our format includes the "Primary Purpose Card"—". . . we ask that all who participate confine their discussion to their problems as it relates to alcohol." Our literature table has only Conference-approved books and pamphlets. We point newcomers to other local meetings that stick to recovery from alcoholism. Sponsors communicate our single purpose, one alcoholic sharing with another how they got sober through the Twelve Steps. All of our literature, but especially the Big Book, the Twelve and Twelve, *Daily Reflections* and "The A.A. Group" pamphlet communicate our singleness of purpose.—

P.I., C.P.C., C.F. and T.F. committees are all means of communicating our singleness of purpose. Whenever we take a meeting into correctional or treatment facilities, our responsibility is to make certain that the message we carry in is recovery from alcoholism through the Twelve Steps of Alcoholics Anonymous. The clients or inmates might share about other substances or issues, but as A.A. members, we share only about our alcoholism. A little while ago, my home group hosted a women's halfway house, and we soon learned that many who were bringing in the A.A. meeting were sharing their drug stories rather than their recovery from alcoholism. We typed up a meeting format and included the "Singleness of Purpose" statement and we actually saw improvement in the sharing.

The long form of Tradition Six states, "While an A.A. group may cooperate with anyone, such cooperation ought never to go so far as affiliation or endorsement, actual or implied." A group that honors this Tradition communicates the spiritual principles of cooperation and solidarity. I go to a great little group twice a week, which meets in the same classroom as an N.A. group. There are two racks of literature that sit on a table, separated only by the coffee set-up. One for A.A.; the other for N.A. I suggested to the general chairperson that a newcomer could become confused and think that A.A. and N.A. were affiliated. A few days later, I came in to find that the N.A. literature rack was under the table and turned around so that it wasn't visible during the A.A. meeting. The message that we communicate must be simple and clear. According to Bill in the Twelve and Twelve, (p. 131), "On anvils of experience, the structure of our Society was hammered out." We have the history of the Washingtonians of yesteryear to fall back on. Once 500,000 members strong, they fell apart because they didn't stick to their singleness of purpose. Today, as recovering alcoholics we must be humble enough to learn from the experience of those who have gone before us, and we must be courageous enough to communicate our singleness of purpose.

In closing, Bill writes in *The Language of the Heart*, (p. 116) ". . . we are sure there must be a million alcoholics who would join Alcoholics Anonymous tomorrow if only they knew what we do. We keenly realize that any fundamental disunity among us could instantly disillusion tens of thousands who would again turn their faces to the wall. Hence those disruptions common to great wealth, power, or controversy ought never be for us. Too many of the 'million who don't yet know' would surely die. So long as we remain grateful for what has befallen us, and for so long as this Tradition of high and single purpose is indelibly emblazoned on our hearts, our destiny will be assured. We shall be worthy of God's Providence."

Nancy Kohane, Eastern Pennsylvania

INTERNATIONAL

Wednesday afternoon the International Presentations were moderated by Elaine McDowell, chair of the General Service Board.

REDELA

My name is Murray McIntosh, and I am an alcoholic. I have the privilege of serving our Fellowship as trustee-at-large/Canada. In this capacity, I serve as one of the two delegates from the U.S./Canada conference structure to the World Service Meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous, which is held every two years. Countries that have general service structures for Alcoholics Anonymous share their experiences in the ongoing effort to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic, wherever in the world he or she

may be. In the off years between the World Service Meetings (WSM), the nations in each of the designated zones of the world meet together in Zonal meetings. We are members of the Americas Zone, which includes all those countries in North, Central and South America that have developed a general service structure. The name "REDELA" is an abbreviation of the Spanish phrase "Reunion de Las Americas," which translates to "Meeting of the Americas." The purpose of this presentation is to discuss the XIII REDELA and to relate it to the Conference theme, "Our Singleness of Purpose—The Cornerstone of A.A."

On October 8, 2003, Charles Bartell, trustee-at-large/U.S., and myself, along with Adrienne Brown, G.S.O. staff member and secretary to the trustees' International Committee (an invited observer), rendezvoused at the Miami airport to proceed to the XIII REDELA, being held at the Hotel Paseo, in Maracaibo, Venezuela. It was wonderfully hosted by the board of trustees and the general manager of the G.S.O. of Venezuela. Present at this event were delegates from Brazil, Colombia, Dominican Republic, Ecuador, Mexico, Venezuela and United States/Canada: 11 delegates in all. We were disappointed that Cuba and Peru, although registered to attend, did not. In Cuba's case, they were denied a visa permit. We had no explanation why the Peruvian delegate did not attend.

After a lovely dinner in the hotel, we had a welcoming address by Dr. Domingo Baptista, a Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee. This was followed by a general meeting in which a paper entitled "Spiritual Awakening, the Basis of Service," was read. Country reports were next, and were very interesting for me as a first-term delegate. Questions and answers on both the theme and the reports were lengthy and energetic. We closed the meeting at 11:30 p.m., setting a precedent for the rest of the week—in fact, we went until midnight twice, partly to cover the material, but mainly due to interest and enthusiasm.

Other sharing meetings throughout the remainder of Thursday and Friday entailed the presentation of themes, with three delegates presenting various aspects of each theme, followed by an exchange of ideas. These themes consisted of: The Big Book, an Occasional Friend or a Permanent Fellow; Spiritual Awakening, the Basis of Service; The Spirit of the Traditions Secures Our Future; Spiritual Aspects of the Concepts of World Service; Spiritual Leadership, A Twenty-First Century Challenge; Carrying the A.A. Message Through Electronic Means; and Does A.A. Continue to be Attractive In This Changing World?

We started workshops Friday morning on "How Has REDELA Helped your Country?", "Sponsorship from Country to Country." "Veterans in Service: Are They Used or Excluded?" Friday evening, the REDELA delegates were invited to attend the

II Congresso Zona D, comparable to one of our Regional Forums, and we were invited to address the Congresso.

Saturday morning, we started committee meetings. The REDELA has four committees: Agenda; Policies, Finance & Admissions; Literature & Publications; and Working with Others. Charlie and I each served on two committees, so we had the opportunity to serve on all four committees. In the afternoon, we discussed the recommendations, but the final vote on the approval on these recommendations and the suggestions accompanying them was not made until 12:10 a.m. Part of the reason for the late windup was we once again were invited to conjoin with the *II Congresso*. It was a forum on Working with Others, in which three REDELA delegates shared what was happening in their countries.

On Sunday, we ended our work with an assessment by each delegate. There was large agreement on the utility and benefit of the shared information. There was also a sense of gratitude and support for face-to-face meetings of this kind. We then reconvened with the *II Congresso Zona D* meeting for a joint

closing. Between 11:50 a.m. and 2:00 p.m., each of the delegates of the REDELA had the opportunity to address the *Congresso* in their closing ceremonies. Several speakers, including two Class A trustees, shared a message of hope. It was a wonderful five days of sharing, at many different levels.

I want to bring to your attention two aspects of this XIII REDELA, which I believe illustrate our Conference theme: "Our Singleness of Purpose—The

Cornerstone of A.A." First, in the recommendations of this XIII REDELA, there emerges a consistent, across-nations concern for keeping the message of Alcoholics

Anonymous as close to the original as possible, given the necessity of translation into other languages. The message stays the same in each language, country to country, because the A.A. structures cooperate and coordinate their efforts to ensure that our message is available through Conference-approved literature. The delegates agreed to sell only Conference-approved literature. To this end, there was agreement among the REDELA delegates present to sell literature only to the G.S.O. of other countries. This will encourage money to be spent by the Fellowship to support its own A.A. structure. With a self-supporting structure, each can more effectively reach out within that nation to its own suffering alcoholics, and it may later offer support (financial) to "fellow structures" in other nations and/or to A.A. groups in nations without a general service structure.

Similarly, there is evidence of consistent concerns to ensure that every effort is being made to have the A.A. hand available to alcoholics everywhere—whether through sponsorship of groups or structures in neighboring nations, or the solicitation of A.A.-sympathetic professionals to approach their counterparts in



these nonstructure nations. Parallel concerns are emerging among our younger structures, which testify to the effectiveness of the sponsoring that has gone before. It bodes well for the future in developing this "singleness of purpose" in our A.A. structures yet to be.

The second aspect of the XIII REDELA that I believe showed the singleness of purpose of our program was the sessions held with the *II Congresso*. In these we spoke, some through an interpreter, of what we were doing in the REDELA, and the participants of the *Congresso*, in their response to these talks and afterward in their sharing individually with us, showed that they could relate our work to theirs—and all for the same end: that the hand of A.A. might always be there for the alcoholic who needs it and wants it, wherever he or she may be—in Venezuela, in the Americas, or worldwide. Nation to nation or service level to service level in a single structure, we share the common goal of helping others of us find the way out of the well of despair of alcoholism.

The temptation to get involved in the issues of the day, no matter how pressing they may be, will always be a distraction for alcoholics in service, but the formidable strength we find in sticking to this simple principle lends us unwavering focus. We must maintain it for the sake of those alcoholics who have yet to reach our doors, and who, once recovered, will carry on in our stead for the same purpose.

Murray McIntosh, trustee-at-large/Canada

Zonal Growth

My name is Adrienne and I am an alcoholic. I am grateful to know that and to be the staff member on the International desk at the General Service Office. Since rotating onto the assignment in June 2003, I have had the unique opportunity of witnessing the growth of A.A. through interim zonal meetings. These meetings, which take place in the year between World Service Meetings (WSM), maintain continuity between meetings and offer help to A.A.s where no structure has as yet been set up. Each zonal meeting has adapted the "statement of purpose" from the World Service Meeting, which states: "The primary purpose of the World Service Meeting is the same as that of all A.A. activity—to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers, wherever in the world he may be, whatever the language he speaks." World Service and zonal meetings serve as forums for sharing the experience, strength and hope of delegates who come together every two years and encourage the planning of sound service structures suited to the needs and capabilities of the various countries. The 18th World Service Meeting, October 24-28, 2004, will be in New York City; the theme is "One Message—Many Languages—One Fellowship."

The idea for zonal meetings came out of the 5th World Service Meeting in Finland, where delegates discussed setting up an European Information Office to foster better communication. At the same time, delegates hoped that countries that had never participated in the World Service Meeting could become involved in the European A.A. community.

The Meeting of the Americas (originally called the Ibero-American Service Meeting) was the first of the zonal meetings. Inspired by the meeting in Finland, the first meeting was held in Bogotá, Colombia, in 1979, and delegates from ten countries, including several that could not attend the World Service Meeting, were present. In October 2003 seven countries from South, Central and North America participated in the 13th Meeting of the Americas (REDELA). Cuba and Peru, although registered, were not able to attend.

The European Service Meeting gathered for the first time in 1981 in Frankfurt, Germany, where 14 countries were represented. In October 2003, 30 delegates from 24 European countries gathered together in Frankfurt at the 12th European Service Meeting. For the first time a delegate from the Czech Republic attended.

The first Asia-Oceania Service Meeting was held in 1995 in Japan, and its success led to a second meeting in Auckland, New Zealand, in 1997, when six countries participated. In 2003 at the 5th Asia-Oceania Meeting (AOSM) in Hong Kong, 20 delegates from 10 countries participated, and China and Mongolia were represented for the first time.

The first Eastern European Service Meeting was held in 2002 in Warsaw, Poland, and was attended by delegates from 14 countries. The next Eastern European Service Meeting is tentatively scheduled for 2005.

In June 2003 I had the privilege of attending the historic gathering of 17 delegates from nine countries as they met to examine regional problems and share ideas during the first Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting (SSASM) in Johannesburg, South Africa. For most of the delegates, nearly all from small and struggling A.A. communities, this was their first opportunity to talk and spend time with A.A. members from other countries. Over the next three days, participants rediscovered a universal A.A. reality—that two or more alcoholics can do what would be impossible for one.

The concept for an African conference originated in the early 1980s. Due to the political climate in South Africa, however, it would be some years before the idea became a reality. Eventually the "Into Africa" Project was initiated and the General Service Boards of U.S./Canada and Great Britain agreed to support the South African structure in organizing the meeting and committed to funding the travel and lodging for all the delegates who could attend. Those countries most accessible to South Africa were each invited to send two delegates. Botswana, Kenya, Lesotho, Malawi, Namibia, South Africa, Tanzania, Uganda and Zimbabwe were all represented. Observers from non-African countries included a member of the G.S.B. Great Britain, the staff member on the International assignment and the general manager of G.S.O. New York. Over the weekend, as the delegates related their unique experiences and ideas for the future, the possible challenges became clear and the delegates agreed to the following action plan:

- Countries will form Public Information and Cooperation With the Professional Community committees, drawn from all existing groups, to provide information about A.A. to the general public and the professionals in their communities.
- Each country will endeavor to form a service center, with a telephone, in order to distribute literature, provide information, and form a focal point for communication between groups and the public.
- G.S.O. New York will send, together with literature packets, other information on how A.A. groups and service entities can begin taking responsibility for their finances.
- Each country will share information about what they are doing with the other countries represented at the Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting. This will be done by means of reports in the proposed quarterly newsletter.
- All of the delegates agreed that they should help groups to embrace the Traditions.

I was filled with gratitude as I watched the delegates leave that meeting with a renewed sense of commitment, feeling good about what they could do, rather than discouraged by what they have not yet accomplished. Since that meeting it has been report-

ed through their quarterly newsletter that some countries have developed central offices, intergroups, or literature distributions centers, and one country will have its first A.A. convention with the theme "Living the Steps." A few weeks ago, we heard from G.S.O. France that the newly created French International Service Committee is beginning preparations for the first Central Africa Zonal Service Meeting.

Our co-founder Bill W. wrote, in 1955, "Our Twelfth Step—carrying the message—is the basic service that the A.A. Fellowship gives; this is our principal aim and the main reason for our existence. Therefore, A.A. is more than a set of principles; it is a society of alcoholics in action. We must carry the message, else we ourselves can wither and those who haven't been given the truth may die." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. 51)

Interim Zonal Meetings are an integral part of the growth of A.A. worldwide—carrying the A.A. message to the still-suffering alcoholic, Everywhere—Anywhere.

Adrienne Brown, G.S.O. staff

THE CORNERSTONE OF A.A.

Thursday afternoon Gary Kluksdahl, Southwest regional trustee, moderated the presentation/discussion session.

Safeguarding Our Unity

"The unity of Alcoholics Anonymous is the most cherished quality our Society has. Our lives, the lives of all to come, depend squarely upon it. We stay whole, or A.A. dies." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 129) You recognize that from the beginning of the first Tradition. When I received the invitation, the topic "Safeguarding our Unity" was, on the one hand a bit uncomfortable, but it is also a subject that I am passionate about. When challenged with a complex topic like this one, I start with the dictionary. The first word I looked up was "cornerstone," something that is fundamentally important. The second word that interested me was "safeguarding," "to prevent something or somebody from being harmed, damaged or lost." Is our unity something that needs to be safeguarded? I always thought that unity is sort of like gratitude, it automatically happens to those who have suffered through a common problem, and found a miraculous common solution. I might be a bit Pollyannaish at times.

In the pamphlet "A.A. Tradition—How It Developed" (p.4), Bill reminds us that "Unity is so vital to us A.A.s that we cannot risk those attitudes and practices which have sometimes demoralized other forms of human society. . . . But A.A. unity cannot automatically preserve itself. Like personal recovery, we shall always have to work to maintain it. Here, too, we surely need honesty, humility, open-mindedness, unselfishness, and, above all—vigilance." He went on to implore newer members to carefully ponder the experience of older members, and learn from it, because our own untreated personal defects can endanger not only our own sobriety and peace of mind, but the well-being of the entire Fellowship.

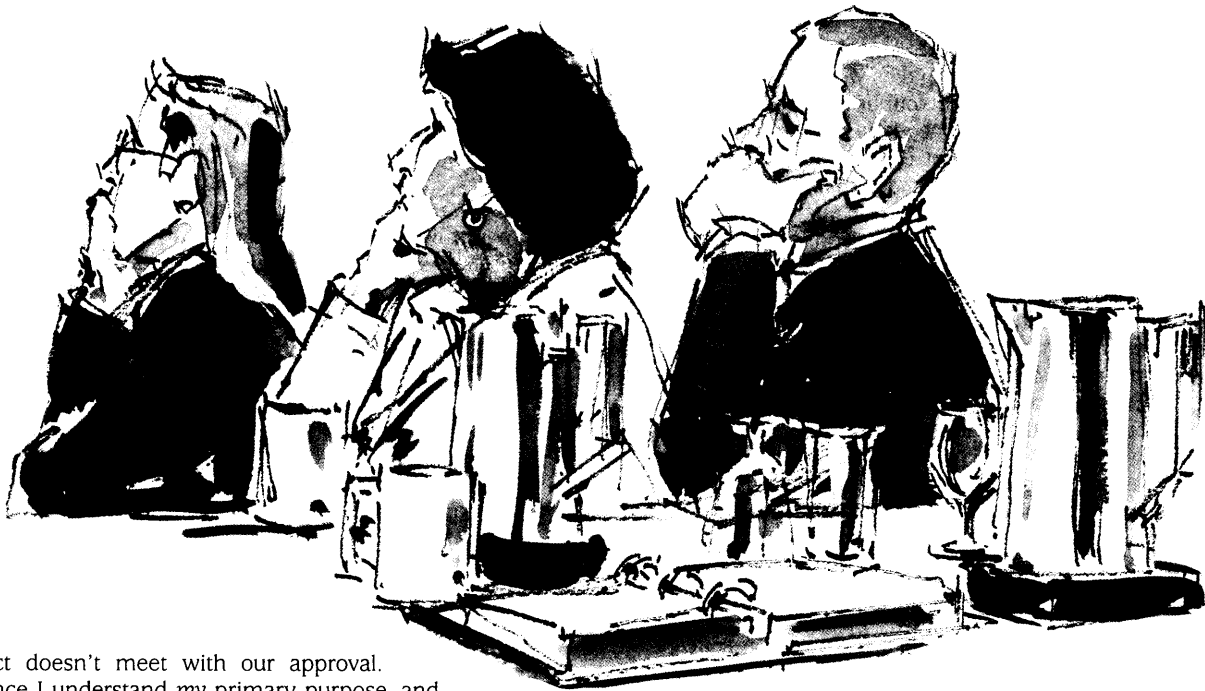
Who do we need to protect A.A.'s unity from? Outsiders, those people who think A.A. should "change with the times"? A.A. has been blessed with a wonderful reputation on the outside as being nonexclusionary. Dr. George Vaillant, Class A trustee, wrote in the 2002 Fall/Winter issue of *About A.A.*, ". . . mental health workers often admire the success and geographic availability of A.A., they understandably wish to broaden its membership to include other substance abusers . . . that the Tradition is a holdover from the early days of A.A. . . . When there is no drug treatment center or

NA group, they find it hard to understand why A.A. won't step in." But A.A. does welcome many thousands of minorities and poor, or alcoholics with drug problems, and tens of thousands of convicts into its membership each year. Nobody with a desire to stop drinking is ever excluded. But that deals with Tradition Three. What about Tradition Five?

If A.A. has the potential to collapse from within, what is our responsibility to newcomers who come into A.A., referred or on their own? Do we just welcome anyone who wants to be there? Yes! The beauty of Alcoholics Anonymous is that one might walk into any meeting, anywhere, and declare, "I can't stand you people! I can barely stomach your lousy old coffee, your Steps make me want to vomit, and you can keep your God stuff! But I have a desire to stop drinking, and I am therefore a member of A.A.," and there isn't anything anyone can do about it. In fact, we usually greet such loving sentiments with a hearty "Keep Coming Back!"

Here's where the vigilance Bill was talking about comes in. I believe we are overlooking a great Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) opportunity right before us. Treatment centers play a valuable role in helping alcoholics, but they are very quick to send *all* their patients to A.A., regardless of their problems. Many fortunately end up catching alcoholism at the meetings. (I tell people it's in the coffee.) When the topic of "singleness of purpose" comes up, invariably a debate about drug addicts at meetings ensues. The lines are drawn very quickly. Patience, tolerance and humility are cast aside. Is that the treatment center's fault? Or is it ours, for not cooperating with them more closely? The patients certainly don't know what A.A. is all about, and more importantly, *they* don't know what they are all about. We do not imply that Alcoholics Anonymous knows what to do about problems other than alcoholism, if we believe in our singleness of purpose. ". . . we who condemn them are the Pharisees whose false righteousness does our group the deeper spiritual damage." (*ibid.*, p. 112) Many of us can remember the faces of those persons we once condemned, those we were sure wouldn't make it, or were a menace to the group. Where are they today? Did they stick around long enough to decide for themselves if they belonged and to find our beautiful solution, or were they told by words or attitude they didn't belong? It would be easy to wait for G.S.O. to come out with an edict or a mandate about who can qualify as a member, but it's our responsibility to meet newcomers at the door armed with information. We must mostly be vigilant against complacency among our own members.

The challenge is this: How can we safeguard our unity while not being overly rigid? "Perhaps there is no society on earth more solicitous of personal welfare, more careful to grant the individual the greatest possible liberty of belief and action. Alcoholics Anonymous has no 'musts.' Few A.A. groups impose penalties on anyone for nonconformity. We do suggest, but we don't discipline. Instead, compliance or noncompliance with any principle of A.A. is a matter for the conscience of the individual; he is the judge of his own conduct." (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 76) Unity is not preserved by rejecting or judging. Reacting from fear to what others do, whether they are inside or outside A.A., will never succeed in protecting A.A. unity. Unity has been preserved, and will always be preserved, by our collective realization that to stay sober we must reach out and carry the A.A. message of recovery to those who still suffer—on their terms, not ours—with patience, understanding and love. Reactions based on fear, an implicit rejection of newcomers who we suspect may not belong, not giving new people a chance to determine for themselves whether they belong, judging other members or groups (all things I've done, I'm embarrassed to admit) most certainly pose a greater threat to A.A. unity than those whom we fear or whose



conduct doesn't meet with our approval. But, once I understand *my* primary purpose, and understand that our common welfare must come first, I can finally live in harmony and unity with you, without fear or judgment.

Doug Grude, California, Northern Coastal

The Role of the Home Group

My name is Barbara Bridges and I am an alcoholic. I am currently serving our Fellowship as a Panel 53 delegate, Northern New Jersey, Area 44. My sobriety date is February 19, 1992.

It is a joy and special honor for me to be here. When I received our Conference coordinator Bill Archer's invitation, I was delighted to be asked to prepare a presentation on "The Role of the Home Group," focusing this topic on the Conference theme, "Our Singleness of Purpose—The Cornerstone of A.A."

I can remember being in a rehab for the second time and attending in-house meetings. This one Saturday, three gentlemen came and carried a message of hope to this still sick and suffering alcoholic. They talked about having a home group and they seemed reasonable happy. After I was "dismissed" from this rehab, (on a Wednesday), I started making meetings on a daily basis. On Sunday night I went to what is now my home group, East Orange Step Ten, and saw those same three men. What a surprise. I did not know it then, but this was our Fifth Tradition in action: "Each group has but one primary purpose—to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers." The seed had been planted.

Over the years the role of the home group has changed for me. When I first came to A.A. scared, desperate, homeless, jobless and full of fear, the home group was where I was welcomed. I felt safe and "at home" at last. The home group is where someone offered their hand as they greeted me at the door and told me to sit up front so I could hear the message of recovery.

The home group is where I first felt I belonged, like when they asked me to help serve the members and other A.A.s at our Group Anniversary. It is the place where I looked forward to hearing about recovery (hope—the first spiritual gift I received from the Fellowship), and the meeting before the meeting, the meeting, and the meeting after the meeting. It is the place where they

took me to the literature rack and gently told me to "read this one, sweetheart."

The home group is where I learned to rely on someone else—my sponsor—and where I was introduced to the A.A. program, as found in the first 164 pages of our Big Book, and to the Steps. It is the place where people told me to "keep coming back," and where the oldtimer said, "surrender to win, kid!" The home group is where I learned how to give back or, as we say, the ABCs (ashtrays, brooms and coffee), as well as: "(a) That we were alcoholic and could not manage our own lives. (b) That probably no human power could have relieved our alcoholism. (c) That God could and would if He were sought."

I learned that there is more to staying sober than just not drinking, and that I had to give it away to keep it. The home group is where I learned how to get along with others, (through the practice of the Traditions), and it was there that I learned how to carry the A.A. message so that others might recover (through the practice of the Concepts).

Today, the home group is where I meet old and new friends alike. It is the place where I put my hand out to the newcomers, and oldtimers as well, and the place where I know I am not alone. It is where I show my gratitude to my Higher Power by giving back what was so freely given to me. It is where I can and do encourage others. It is where we take commitments to other groups, as well as to institutions, jails and prisons, and to encourage all to participate in the business meeting; to listen to our G.S.R. give his/her reports; to attract others to join in a standing committee position on a district level; and to participate in area assemblies, as well as state and international conventions.

So, what is The Role of the Home Group? It is to show the still sick and suffering alcoholic who stumbles through the door for the first time that "you are welcomed here." Because of the trust that develops through the meetings of a home group, it is where we first begin to care about someone else so that we might eventually be able to love again. It is where we first learn how to take responsibility for the meeting (coffeemaker, booker, secretary, etc.), so that we might eventually take responsibility for our lives.

The home group has been called the heartbeat of A.A. and I believe, as it says on page 16 of The Home Group: Heartbeat of A.A., "... that just as surely as we are aware of, sensitive to, and

in need of our own heartbeat, each of us needs a home group." If the home group dies, the Fellowship dies with it.

The home group is the heart and soul of the Fellowship. If it did not exist, there would be no need for a General Service Conference. Taking from the concept of the book, *Everything I Need to Know About Life I Learned in Kindergarten*: kindergarten is where we learn how to work with others, raise our hands to share and speak only when called on, ask permission, ask questions. Our home group's business meetings taught us how to conduct ourselves in relations with other group members, how to voice our opinion, yet accept the decisions of the group conscience. It is here that the foundation is set, so that we know how to participate at district meetings, area committee meetings, assemblies and the General Service Conference.

The home group stays alive through prayer and service "one alcoholic needing another." It is getting sober together to help other alcoholics achieve sobriety. Singleness of purpose is difficult to hold onto, but hold onto it we must. A diversion of opinion among A.A.s is good for the Fellowship; a diversion from our Singleness of Purpose will destroy the Fellowship.

Realizing that the fundamental authority for Alcoholics Anonymous comes from the groups, where our newest members are found, the direction of our Fellowship relies on the concept that God is responsible for the arrival of all our members. In listening to the voice of the drunk who says, "Help me!" we can hear the voice of God, guiding us in the achievement of our Singleness of Purpose.

Acceptance of such a spiritual concept is the cornerstone of all three of our Legacies. Let us all remember our Responsibility Pledge: "I am responsible. When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I am responsible." Thank you, for planting the seed, and for the opportunity to be of service.

Barbara Bridges, Northern New Jersey

Traditions Three and Five: Our Members, Our Message

Thank you for the invitation to make a presentation on *our members*—Tradition Three, "The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking"—and *our message*—Tradition Five, "Each group has but one primary purpose—to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers." My talk will be to examine the effect these two Traditions, if not respected, could have on the future of A.A. For if *our members* and *our message* are true to our Traditions, A.A. will flourish. If not, A.A. could very well perish.

Tradition Three says, "You are an A.A. member if you say so." Would people claim *membership* if they did not have that *desire to stop drinking*? One would think not. So, if our members have a *desire to stop drinking*, then our primary-purpose *message* would logically be about staying *sober* as we try to help other *alcoholics* to achieve sobriety. Our critics might therefore be justified in saying our cautions are unnecessary.

We read in *A.A. Comes of Age* (p. 102) that in the early days our founders feared that "all kinds of odd people . . ." other than just guzzlers—" . . . mighty queer people . . . criminals . . . social undesirables" would show up. We know that before A.A. became "really democratic," membership rules were so stringent that few would have joined. Today, people claim membership *without* a desire to stop drinking—people who either never drank alcohol or for whom alcohol has never been a problem. How many of our newer members are "*pure alcoholics*?" How many groups do not have at least one member declaring themselves to be an addict, or powerless over people, places, and things, or a compulsive

overeater, gambler, or sex addict? How much sharing, as a result, includes no references to drugs, relationships, food, gambling, and sex addictions? At times, it seems we are becoming a Society of Alcoholics.

Frightening rules are being made by members of a rather new "subset" of A.A.—*members* who coach newcomers on appropriate attire, who assign opposite-sex sponsors, who say working a good program will cure clinical depression. But even the old line, "Suit up to show up," can imply a membership requirement for the newcomer who may not have the wisdom to say, "I came here to get sober, not to get laid."

So what then happens to our members, our message?

While much can be learned from what these nonalcoholic self-declarers have to share, it is imperative to heed certain suggestions from our literature. From *The Language of the Heart* regarding *our members*:

- Pages 79-80 tell us that "If we raise [any] obstacles, [the alcoholic] might stay away and perish." Our *only* qualification ". . . relates to the use of our name, Alcoholics Anonymous." "Let us of A.A. therefore resolve that we shall always be inclusive and never exclusive. . . ."
- Page 93 says, "Tradition Three requires that we exclude no alcoholic from A.A. membership."
- And from page 317, we learn that we cannot deny *personal liberty* nor deprive membership because of behavior or attire nor, dare I say, *im-pure* alcoholism. In November of 1960, Bill W. wrote, ". . . there has never been any cause for regret." May it *ever* be so.

Regarding our message:

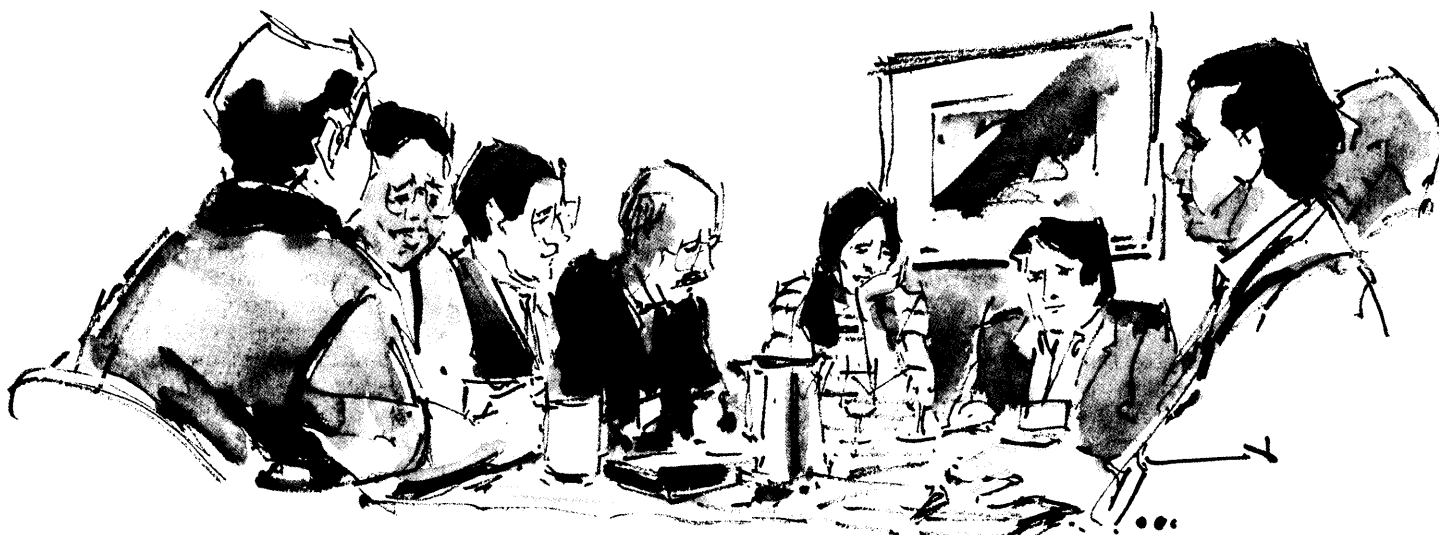
- On pp. 82-83, where Bill says ". . . it is better to do one thing supremely well than many things badly," his focus moves quickly to the conduct of "the *Society* of Alcoholics Anonymous."
- Likewise, on p. 93, the focus is on the group: ". . . Tradition Five restricts the A.A. group to a single purpose, carrying our message to other alcoholics."
- Finally, on p. 116, he writes, "We keenly realize that any fundamental disunity among us could instantly disillusion tens of thousands who would again turn their faces to the wall."

Worthy principles in general, they must, however, be applied to our specific day-to-day encounters, whether we carry our message intentionally or unintentionally. Perhaps one solution would be a slight revision to the goal of sobriety, which I heard described as "sodriety"—a word the speaker could spell with a 'b' once he started (after twelve years) working the Steps.

No, the solution is to hold in the highest possible esteem the principles hammered out on the anvils of experience—principles that have helped and continue to help not just tens of thousands but literally millions of people. We must keep the common welfare of recovering alcoholics first. Our lives and the lives of future alcoholics depend on the unity and consistency of *our members*, *our message*.

Hopefully, "If it ain't A.A., it'll go away." But can we passively accept some latter-day requirements for membership and secondary purposes for our message? Or do we gently guide our newcomers to grow under the buttresses of the Traditions? The formulaic solution is simple, the dynamics of execution, complex. May God, as we understand Him (or Her), guide *our members* to carry *our message* with unity and clarity as we all trudge the Road to Happy Destiny.

Ruth Barth, Virginia



Reports from the General Service Board, A.A.W.S., Trustees' Committees and G.S.O.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD REPORT

Trustees' report: I'm delighted to be with you as together we experience the 54th General Service Conference. Each April, your group conscience inspires and guides trustees, directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs, and support personnel. We are grateful for your dedication and example. We join you in celebrating the Conference theme, "Our Singleness of Purpose — The Cornerstone of A.A." On behalf of your trustees, this report will reflect our respect for A.A.'s primary purpose as vital to A.A. unity and the assurance that A.A.'s simple message is available to alcoholics everywhere.

Since the 53rd Conference, the board has hosted Regional Forums in Grand Island, New York; Columbus, Indiana; Minot, South Dakota; Kansas City, Missouri; and Grande Prairie, Alberta. Special Forums were held in Smithers, British Columbia, and Hawaii, where we visited the islands of Kauai, Maui, Oahu and Hawaii. Your suggestions to encourage attendance and participation in Forums are always welcome.

We welcomed five new trustees: Herbert Goodman, Class A, and four Class B trustee: Murray McIntosh, trustee-at-large/Canada; general service trustee Arnold Ross; and regional trustees Gary Kluksdahl and Michael Perry. At the close of this annual meeting, three trustees will rotate: Ric Downey, Ted Stoa and George Vaillant. Each represents outstanding service and sacrifice on behalf of the Fellowship. Your board interviewed nine candidates for two Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee openings — one for an existing vacancy and the other that will occur with the rotation of George Vaillant, whose contributions have added immeasurably to the board. The nine outstanding nonalcoholics we interviewed for the Class A openings reflected the respect and admiration that A.A. garners among professionals through contact with sober members like you. We also welcomed new G.S.O. staff member Irene Kontje, and Publications' production manager Carole Harley.

In January, the English edition of the Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, our Big Book, was added to G.S.O.'s Web

site, followed by the French and Spanish translations of the Big Book. Shortly after that, the General Service Office received sharing that a suffering alcoholic was led to A.A. and sobriety through the online availability of A.A.'s basic text.

The 2004 budget projects a 2% increase for literature sales, and restoration of pre-Fourth Edition prices for the hardcover and portable Big Books. The incredible response to the Fourth Edition of the Big Book enabled A.A. World Services (A.A.W.S.) to decrease the price of Big Books temporarily.

You have heard the good news that Robin Bromley became executive editor of the A.A. Grapevine on April 1st. The Grapevine Corporate Board unanimously selected Robin as executive editor, and the trustees' Nominating Committee wholeheartedly affirmed the Grapevine Board's decision. Now, I want to express again my gratitude and warm wishes to Robin.

The Grapevine Corporate Board made considerable progress in the past year, while also addressing several challenges. The Grapevine magazine achieved a positive net income of \$5,300 for 2003, and projects the trend to continue for the balance of 2004. Throughout the year, the Grapevine staff fulfilled their responsibilities and avoided distractions. We applaud their dedication.

Charlie Bartell and Murray McIntosh, your trustees-at-large, U.S. and Canada, traveled great distances to convey experience, strength and hope during the first Service Conference in Minsk, Belarus, the XIII Meeting of the Americas in Maracaibo, Venezuela, and the celebration of 15 years of A.A. in Latvia. Internationally, A.A. continues to take root and flourish. The first Sub-Sahara (Africa) Service Meeting was held in South Africa last June, with G.S.O. general manager Greg Muth and Adrienne Brown, staff member on the International assignment, present as observers. Adrienne delivered an inspiring keynote address. Since then, we've received newsletters from the Sub-Saharan region indicating that the Service Meeting inspired local members to carry the light of A.A. further in their lands. Enthusiastic A.A.s in Uganda established several service committees; members in

Zimbabwe held their first A.A. convention under incredibly difficult circumstances; and A.A. membership in Malawi increased by more than 20 members. From Oman in the Middle East, we learned of the third A.A. Convention in Muscat. Adrienne and Greg also attended the 5th Asia-Oceanic Service Meeting in Hong Kong as observers and resources of shared experience. Zonal Service Meetings are invaluable to emerging countries as forums for passing on A.A. experience and reassurance that, although the growth of A.A. presents challenges, no single member or country is alone, thanks in large measure to the support of groups and members in Canada and the U.S.

Adrienne and I traveled to the Planning Meeting of the World Health Organization (W.H.O.) in Geneva, Switzerland. There, we learned that the W.H.O. will consider inviting A.A. members to future meetings so that information on A.A.'s program of recovery would be more available. During the trip, we were pleased to meet with several members of Switzerland's General Service Board, who sought to gain by shared experience of the U.S./Canada structure so that they may encourage development in Switzerland's service structure. In November, Greg and I were guests of the General Service Board of A.A. in India. For almost 15 days, we maintained an amazing schedule of visits and meetings with professionals, government officials, and A.A. groups and local offices, culminating in the 32nd General Service Conference of A.A. in that vast country. The depth and breadth of our experiences cannot be described in this report. I encourage you to request a copy of our "trip report" and benefit by the remarkable progress of A.A. in India.

Adrienne, Greg, and publications director Chris Cavanaugh responded to invitations to visit A.A. in Colombia, Nicaragua, Paris, and Vienna, where they shared information on licensing, distribution, copyrights, and production of A.A. literature. The three also attended the 12th European Service Meeting in Frankfurt as observers, where discussions centered on safeguarding the integrity of A.A.'s written message in all languages, in every country and structure throughout the world — values that are rooted in our singleness of purpose, the cornerstone of A.A. here and elsewhere.

Toward that end, your Publications Department is responsible for overseeing translations of Conference-approved books. *Alcoholics Anonymous* in Icelandic and Zulu; *Daily Reflections* in Italian and Portuguese; *Living Sober* in Latvian and Greek; Swahili *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*; and *As Bill Sees It* in Italian have been published since the 53rd General Service Conference last April. Publications staff also maintain contact with General Service Offices or committees in other countries to achieve accurate translations of Conference-approved pamphlets. Among the pamphlets translated in the last year are: Thai-language "Is A.A. for You?," "44 Questions," "A Newcomer Asks," and "This is A.A."; the Simplified Chinese version of "A Newcomer Asks"; and, "Is A.A. For Me?" in German. Nearing completion are several pamphlets in various languages spoken in India; "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship"; "The A.A. Group," and "Understanding Anonymity" in Latvian; and "The Twelve Steps Illustrated" in Inuktitut. In each case, the translation reflects the original (English) manuscript, and the practice of assuring that the basic A.A. message is tied to our principles and primary purpose.

The General Service Board's role in observance of A.A.'s singleness of purpose occasionally necessitates difficult decisions or actions. Since 1993, with the support of the General Service Conference and the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Boards, we addressed a serious challenge to copyrights on A.A. literature, first granted to Bill W., and later assigned by Bill to A.A.W.S. on behalf of the Fellowship as a whole. Bill W. copyrighted the First Edition of our Big Book so that the text could not be altered to suit

individual views or interpretations not fully considered by a representative group conscience. The General Service Conference (U.S./Canada) has served as the effective group conscience of A.A. as a whole since 1955 and adoption of the historic resolution in St. Louis. (*The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Services*, pp. S89-90)

Most of you are aware that a German citizen undertook to publish and distribute several Conference-approved books and pamphlets, first in Germany and then in other countries. Our first contact with him occurred in 1993. For more than four years, we and the General Service Board of A.A. in Germany used every possible means of communication to reason with him. Each contact was a sincere effort to persuade him that unauthorized publications in the name of A.A. ignored principles established by Bill W. and reflected in the Current Conference Charter: "In countries where a General Service Structure exists, the United States/Canada Conference will delegate sole right to publish our Conference-approved literature to the General Service Board of that structure."

For four years, we requested that he cease publishing unauthorized literature in the name of A.A. Yet, he translated and distributed Conference-approved books and pamphlets in several languages, including Finnish, Hebrew, Russian, Spanish, and Swedish, as well as German and English. The effect in countries with new or struggling service structures was profound. The unauthorized books created confusion within the membership, were unconnected to the local service office or structure, and raised concerns about the integrity of A.A.'s simple message. Unsolicited books arrived in local groups; A.A. members were confused and distracted from the group's primary purpose. In some cases, unity was threatened.

Secondarily, a majority of A.A. service entities in other countries depend on literature sales, as well as contributions, to support basic services. Our friends in other countries looked to your structure for they recognized the challenges to copyrights held in trust by A.A. World Services (A.A.W.S.) for A.A. as a whole. In November 1997, we realized that we had exhausted all avenues of reason and/or negotiation. The German General Service Board and A.A.W.S. initiated legal proceedings in Germany that sought to prevent further publication and distribution of unauthorized literature. Our aim was that the defendant would cease activities that fostered misunderstanding and disunity. Past General Service Board chairmen updated each succeeding General Service Conference on progress of the German Court's considerations. Throughout, trustees and directors were kept informed. Past chairmen of our board, Jim Estelle and Gary Glynn, provided guidance, joined by past chairman Michael Alexander, who has served on the board's Legal Affairs Committee since its inception. (Established by Board Chairman in 1999 to provide guidance on legal matters.) Although, the German Court of Common Pleas ruled for the plaintiffs, the German Board and A.A.W.S. in May 1999, the defendant appealed the ruling, thus forcing a process that absorbed energy and resources over four more years.

In October 2003, the Court of Appeals in Frankfurt decided the matter in favor of A.A., represented by the German General Service Board and A.A.W.S. The defendant's claims were not allowed, and the court directed that he cease producing and distributing Conference-approved books and pamphlets in any language. The court affirmed the validity of copyrights held in trust by A.A.W.S., and recognized Bill W. as author of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, A.A.'s basic text. The German Court decreed that the defendant must reimburse A.A.W.S. and A.A. in Germany for legal expenses, including attorney fees. Early in 2004, we and the German General Service Board offered the defendant an opportunity to forgo reimbursement of legal costs and fees provided

the defendant does not publish or distribute Conference-approved literature in any language or country, now or in the future, and accepts all other stipulations in the court's order. The defendant has not responded to our offer. Therefore, we have asked that remedies stipulated in the Court's final order of October 2003 be fulfilled by the defendant.

While these matters were before the court, we were constrained from discussing relevant details. We promised past and present members of the General Service Conference that we would report more fully when the matter was concluded. Legal fees and related expenses over the seven-year period, 1998 - 2004, totaled \$227,707. In the process, we drew on the experience and wisdom of A.A.'s founders and early members, as well as examples of self-sacrifice for the common welfare that you and those before you exemplify. We gain nothing financially from protecting foreign copyrights. We receive no payments or financial benefits from any A.A. literature published by other boards or service structures. Protecting copyrights is a service we perform to help carry the message. We believe protecting copyrights is of great benefit to A.A. worldwide because it helps maintain the integrity of the message in our literature, and because it helps other boards and offices to serve their groups. It is also our legal duty as trustees.

Trustees, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors have no sense of victory or accomplishment. Throughout, we have applied ourselves to the principles handed down to us and to you. We recognized and faced our responsibilities, and the supreme importance of protecting the integrity and simplicity of Conference-approved literature, as well as the message handed down from Dr. Bob, Bill W. and the first members.

Your General Service Board continues to be led by a Power Greater than any single trustee, delegate or group. Throughout the year, we have been uplifted by the humility demonstrated by each newcomer who enters an A.A. meeting, wishing, hoping, but not yet believing, that A.A.'s solution can push away the fog of alcoholism, and lead him or her to the Sunlight of the Spirit.

We join you in looking upward to two significant gatherings. The 18th World Service Meeting will take place in New York City this coming October, where the theme will be "One Message — Many Languages — One Fellowship." With hearts full of gratitude, we join you and A.A.s everywhere in joyful anticipation of the Fellowship's 70th Anniversary in Toronto, where we will come together for the 2005 International A.A. Convention, and reaffirm "I Am Responsible."

During the 1995 General Service Conference, a trustee shared these thoughts: "Not one of us is given a torch big enough to lead the drunks of the world out of darkness and into the light. Instead, each of us has been given a candle that burns for a short while with a flickering flame. If we stand together, the light will outshine the greatest torch. If we argue and bicker and blow at each other's candle so that each of us starts shielding our own little flame, then the alcoholics of the world will continue to suffer in darkness, and so will we."

Elaine McDowell, Ph.D., chair

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: Each year, directors serving on Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) report to the General Service Conference on A.A. publications, group services provided by the General Service Office (G.S.O.) and other activities linked directly to A.A.'s primary purpose. A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. employees agree that our purpose, expressed through requested services and publication of A.A. literature, is to enable members and groups to continue and enlarge their Twelfth Step work, sharing A.A.'s solution with each alcoholic who still suffers.

Structure, composition and responsibilities of Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. are described in Chapter 10, *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, and in footnotes to this report.¹

The A.A.W.S. Board met seven times since the 2003 Conference to receive G.S.O. management and staff reports; review progress on implementation of Conference and board actions; consider financial reports; review publishing operations, price new or revised publications; receive updates on essential group services; consider requests from A.A. members and non-A.A.s for permission to reprint copyrighted literature; and, address matters of G.S.O. administration. We utilize committees² to consider requests in depth, gather background and report to the full board. Long-range planning is done within each committee and by the board as a whole.

Guests and Visitors to G.S.O.: In the past year, G.S.O. welcomed 1,600 visitors, plus 15 groups of 10-50 members—some traveled great distances to spend a day in their office. Other special guests were: Isamu Shiroma, director of publications, General Service Office in Tokyo, visited G.S.O. and was a guest during our January board meeting. In May, we welcomed two friends from the United Kingdom: Jim Keeney, general; secretary, G.S.O. Great Britain, and Ann Napier, general secretary elect, G.S.O. Great Britain. In March 2003, we coordinated a visit by two officials of the White House Office of National Drug Control Policy: John P. Walters, director, and Dr. Andrea G. Barthwell, deputy director for Demand Reduction. Elaine McDowell, chair of our General Service Board, and A.A.W.S. chairman John Koster, as well as trustees Allen Ault and Leonard Blumenthal, joined general manager Greg Muth, Grapevine and G.S.O. staff, for sharing and presentations describing ways that A.A. has cooperated with professionals over many years.

The U.S. State Department coordinated a visit by healthcare professionals from Azerbaijan who were researching methods of "harm reduction" and became interested in how A.A. works to help alcoholics find sobriety and useful lives. Our new friends were given Russian-language literature, and they expressed interest in the possibility of translations of A.A. literature into Azeri. In December 2003, G.S.O. hosted the Annual Day of Sharing with staff from the National Council on Alcoholism and Drug Dependence (NCADD) and the Al-Anon Family Group Headquarters.

Regional and Special Forums: A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff participated in five Regional Forums: Northeast in Grand Island, NY, June 20-22; East Central in Indianapolis, Indiana, July 18-20;

¹ Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) is a not-for-profit corporation composed of nine directors. Members of A.A.W.S. are trustees of the General Service Board, who elect directors responsible for oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.), group services, printing and distribution of Conference-approved literature and service material. A.A.W.S. owns copyrights on A.A. literature, and is responsible for translations of A.A. literature, including titles licensed to A.A. boards or committees in other countries.

A.A.W.S. directors include two general service trustees and two regional trustees; three nontrustee directors; G.S.O.'s general manager and staff coordinator. Essential nonvoting support personnel attend each board meeting: senior advisor to the general manager, G.S.O. staff, controller, publications director, information services director, human resources manager, archivist, board secretary, and one or more representatives of the A.A. Grapevine.

² Committees of the A.A.W.S. board are: Services—considers the needs of each service assignment; Publishing—reviews reprint requests, translations, and publications concerns; Finance—oversees salaries and budget, retirement planning, and audit review; and, Nominating.



West Central, in Minot, North Dakota, September 5-7; Southwest, in Kansas City, Missouri, October 3-5; and Western Canada in Grand Prairie, Alberta, February 27-29. Two Special Forums held in Smithers, British Columbia, May 17-18; and the Hawaiian islands of Kauai, Maui, Oahu and Hawaii, January 16-19.

Annual Intergroup Seminar, September 26-29. Julio Espallat, Chris Cavanaugh, Andrea Brennan, Mohja Rhoads and Greg Muth attended the 18th Annual Intergroup Seminar in San Diego, California.

Greg Muth also attended the *50th Anniversary Convention of Narcotics Anonymous (N.A.)* in San Diego, July 3-6, as a guest of the N.A. Board. Approximately 20,000 N.A. members and guests celebrated the founding of the N.A. fellowship. Greg also met with N.A. trustees and management for discussions on ways that A.A. and N.A. might continue to cooperate, while carefully observing our Tradition of nonaffiliation.

Group Services and Registration: During 2003, 1,169 new groups were registered with G.S.O. Each new group's general service representative (G.S.R.) or contact received A.A. literature and basic information, encouraging the group to participate in and support the local structure. G.S.O. welcomes each opportunity to share with A.A. members and groups.

G.S.R. and District Committee Member (D.C.M.) Kits were revised and are available in English, French and Spanish.

Electronic Transmission of Conference Background Material. In response to a request by the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference, A.A.W.S. determined that a CD format would be the most practical method for electronically distributing Conference background material. However, A.A.W.S. encouraged full Conference input before embarking on what could have a dramatic effect on the Conference process.

A.A.W.S. directors believe that all potential ramifications of widening distribution of background that has historically been a responsibility entrusted to Conference members and committees should be fully considered. A.A.W.S. recommended that the trustees' committee consider the sharing compiled by A.A.W.S. and G.S.O.

G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site. The board approved the Intra-Office Web site Committee's recommendation to place the pamphlet "The A.A. Grapevine—Our Meeting in Print" on G.S.O.'s Web site, in the section "Services for Members," under "Your A.A. General Service Office." The board also approved a privacy statement to be added to the Web site.

Public Service Announcements (P.S.A.s): In November 2003, a

video compiled of all current television P.S.A.s., including "We Know What It's Like," was mailed to all Area Public Information Committees, as requested by the 2003 Conference Committee on Public Information.

Special Format Items and Pricing: The board approved production and/or pricing by the Publications Department: Large-print, softcover formats of *As Bill Sees It*, *Living Sober*, *Came to Believe*; and, Large-print versions of the pamphlets, "This is A.A." and "44 Questions"; Updated the American Sign Language (A.S.L.) video of the Big Book to reflect the Fourth Edition of Alcoholics Anonymous; and, add A.S.L. versions of the pamphlets, "Is A.A. for You?" and "A Newcomer Asks," within a budget not to exceed \$10,000; Video compilation (noted above) of current TV P.S.A.s were priced at \$10 (Items TV-44, TV-45, STV-44, STV-45, FTV-44, FTV-45; and, \$5.00 for item TV-49).

Good news. We learned that Polish-speaking groups in the Chicago Area formed a new intergroup to serve members and groups whose first language is Polish.

International Visits: G.S.O. staff responded to invitations from service structures in other countries. These visits are invariably useful for passing on G.S.O.'s shared experience gathered over many years, and enabling local services to better reach the still-suffering alcoholic.

Europe: International assignment staff member Adrienne Brown visited the German G.S.O., in Munich, on October 14, before joining Greg Muth and publications director Chris Cavanaugh, as observers for the European Service Meeting in Frankfurt, Germany, October 17-19. En route home, Greg and Chris visited the French G.S.O. in Paris, October 20-21, to further develop ways to support French-speaking groups in Africa, and to discuss plans for a trip to Togo.

Africa: Greg Muth and Adrienne attended the first Sub-Saharan Zonal Meeting (S.S.S.M.) in Johannesburg, South Africa. Seventeen delegates represented nine Sub-Saharan African countries — the first such gathering by representatives of A.A. communities in that huge continent.

Latin America: August 27-31, Adrienne Brown accompanied Greg Muth to Medellin, Colombia, for a visit with members of the Colombian General Service Board. They also visited Managua, Nicaragua, where they were joined by Chris Cavanaugh, to discuss a request from the General Service Board of A.A. in Nicaragua for a literature assistance loan to assist with establishment of a publishing operation. Adrienne, Greg and Chris also met jointly with members of the General Service Boards of

Nicaragua and Costa Rica. Adrienne was an observer at the XIII REDELA (Meeting of the Americas) in Maracaibo, Venezuela.

Asia/Oceania: Greg Muth and Adrienne Brown traveled to Hong Kong for the 5th Asia-Oceania Service Meeting (AOSM), July 6-8. Twenty delegates from 10 countries participated, including, for the first time, representatives from China and Mongolia.

In response to an invitation from the General Service Board of India, Elaine McDowell and Greg Muth visited India, November 5-19, to attend the 32nd General Service Conference of A.A. in that vast country. Elaine and Greg also visited Calcutta, Bangalore, Delhi, Madras and Chandigarh for meetings with professionals and media representatives, who were keenly interested in learning about A.A. Elaine and Greg also visited India's General Service Office in Bombay.

The 13th Annual International National A.A. Native American Indian Convention was held in Burbank, California, October 17-19. Staff member Doug Richardson attended as G.S.O. guest.

A.A.'s 70th Anniversary International Convention, June 30-July 3, 2005, Toronto, Canada. Plans and preparations are well underway to insure that this International Convention will be an exciting and successful celebration for A.A. members from around the world. February 20th, representatives from G.S.O. and Convention Consultant Gregg Talley of Talley Management Group visited Toronto to meet with city officials, transportation companies, vendors, and Canadian Customs and Immigration officials.

Financial - 2003: A brief summary of the 2003 finances reflected gross sales of \$10,769,000, approximately \$325,700 (3.1%) greater than budgeted, but \$30,000 less than in 2002. Contributions in support of G.S.O.'s group services totaled \$5,100,300, approximately \$25,000 (.5%) less than budgeted and about \$2,500 more than in 2002. Total revenue of \$9,809,800 was about \$73,800 (.8%) greater than budgeted, but \$238,075 (2.4%) less than in 2002. Total operating expenses for the 12-month period ending December 31, 2003 were \$10,454,900, approximately \$231,800 less than budgeted, and \$289,800 more than last year. We incurred a net loss of \$645,160, compared with a budgeted loss of \$950,800. The \$305,000 difference includes increased net revenue of \$74,000, when compared with budget, and expenses of \$231,000 less than budgeted.

Mid-Year Budget Adjustments. The board approved these mid-year budget adjustments (2003) that added \$60,500 to the budget: P.S.A. video distribution and tracking - \$30,000; processing and placement of the Fourth Edition Big Book on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site - \$20,000; comprehensive Review of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet (draft) - \$10,500. These adjustments were forwarded to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee for approval.

The 2004 Budget was developed by the A.A.W.S. Finance Committee and reviewed by the full board, who recommended the 2004 budget to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee for review. (Details on A.A.W.S. financial operations are included in the report by the treasurer of the General Service Board.)

Restoration of pre-Fourth Edition prices for Hard-Cover and Portable Big Books: After lengthy and thorough discussion, the A.A.W.S. Finance Committee recommended that prices of the various formats of *Alcoholics Anonymous* be restored to their pre-Fourth Edition levels. The board approved these prices to take effect July 1, 2004:

Big Book Format	Pre-Fourth Edition	Fourth Edition	Price on July 1, 2004
B-1, Hard Cover	\$6.00	\$5.00	\$6.00
B-30, Portable	5.60	4.60	5.60

Publications: Publications Staff: John Hackett joined us as associate editor (he is fluent in French as well as English). Carole Harley began work as our new production manager, replacing Bob Cubelo.

Unit Distribution, Books: In 2003, we distributed 1,702,161 units, 8% less than the 1,861,660 units distributed in 2002. A.A. purchasers accounted for 1,356,225 units, (80%), while non-A.A.s purchased 345,936 units, or 20% of the total.

Big Book Sales for 2003 totaled 1,014,605 units, compared with 1,169,767 units last year. 2003 distribution of 155,162 units was 13% less than in 2002.

First Trilingual (English/French/Spanish) Catalog was produced and mailed in July 2003. The Spring/Summer 2004 updated Catalog was distributed in March and included a new Special Needs section. We received many compliments from central and intergroup offices on the design and efficiency of the catalog.

The board approved a suggestion to offer a boxed set of the Big Book and Experience, Strength and Hope, for \$13 per set. Distribution began on November 15.

Revised pamphlets. Revisions of "A.A. and the Armed Services" and "What Happened to Joe" were completed and made available.

Archives Scrapbook: The board approved a price of \$65 for the Archives Scrapbook 1944 (Volume I).

Prices of Large-print format items in English and Spanish was approved by the board. English: *As Bill Sees It*, \$6.50; *Came to Believe*, \$3.25; *Living Sober*, \$3.25; *"This is A.A."*, .25; *"44 Questions,"* .35; Spanish: *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, \$6.30; *Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones*, \$5.75.

Translations. The board approved requests for translation and publication of five pamphlets (the first ever) in Mongolian: "This Is A.A.," "Is A.A. for You?," "44 Questions," "A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous" and "A Newcomer Asks." The Swahili *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* was priced at \$5.00. "A Newcomer Asks" in Simplified Chinese is available. Cambodian translations of our Big Book were shipped to Cambodia. *Living Sober* in Latvian was completed and sent by expedited shipment to arrive for the celebration of 15 years of A.A. in Latvia. Translations of literature into languages of India have been approved: Punjabi *Daily Reflections* and pamphlets, "The A.A. Group," "A Newcomer Asks," "A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous" and "This is A.A."; Marathi pamphlets "A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous," "The Jack Alexander Article about A.A.," "A Member's Eye View of Alcoholics Anonymous," and "Where Do I Go From Here?," and the service piece, "Memo to an A.A. Group Treasurer"; and *As Bill Sees It* in Tamil.

Permission granted for Other Foreign Language Translations. The Icelandic Big Book is being published in Iceland; Germany is publishing *Bill's Own Story* in their language; Italian translations of *Daily Reflections* and *As Bill Sees It* are being published in Italy; Portuguese *Daily Reflections* will be published in Portugal; and Lithuanian pamphlets have been approved for publication in that country.

Literature Assistance Loans Requested by Peru and Nicaragua: The board approved a request from the General Service Office in Peru for a \$5,000 loan to set up a local publishing operation to facilitate distribution of A.A. literature in that country. The loan will be repaid in 7 years. The board also approved a request from the General Service Board of Nicaragua for a loan not to exceed \$6,500 to be used to set up a literature inventory, as well as shipping and handling costs. The loan will be repaid in 10 years.

Don Meurer, G.S.O.'s controller, was accidentally locked in the bathroom of his hotel room. Fortunately he had his cell phone with him. Moral: Have your cell phone with you at all times.

New and Updated Translations of French Literature: As a natural consequence of A.A.W.S. assuming the functions of Services Mondiaux des Alcoolistes Anonymes (S.M.A.A.), we initiated a publishing plan for new French translations of English-language literature and service material, as well as to apply to existing French translations, so that French literature would be inclusive through use of the International French style.

Schedule and Budgets for Translation of French Literature prepared by the Publications Department were reviewed and approved. The board approved a recommendation to print laminated or similar format sheets (paper) containing the Twelve Steps in French, which S.M.A.A. previously distributed to French-speaking groups and members. In response to a request from Grapevine management, G.S.O. will continue to fulfill and distribute Grapevine orders for French-language *The Home Group*, *The Language of the Heart*, *The Best of Bill*, and the Slogans. Grapevine will reimburse A.A.W.S. for administrative expenses. (This is an example of services once provided by S.M.A.A. whose functions were assumed by G.S.O.)

International Sales Policy: Chris Cavanaugh presented a draft proposal of A.A.W.S. International Sales Policy that incorporated office policies based on the principles of cooperation and respect for the autonomy of other General Service structures. The board approved these points as our policy for literature requests and orders from A.A. groups and members in other lands where there is an existing A.A. office: When an order is received from an A.A. group or individual living in a country served by a G.S.O. or central service office, A.A.W.S. will refer the group or individual to their local office. If the local office does not stock the item(s) ordered, a representative from the General Service Office of U.S./Canada will contact that office to determine if they would like to purchase the item(s). If the local service office does not publish or choose to stock the requested A.A. literature, A.A.W.S. will fulfill or ship the item(s) upon payment or other arrangements.

Copyright Infringement Cases in Germany: October 7, 2003, the Court of Appeals in Frankfurt, Germany, denied the defendant's appeal in the copyright infringement matters that have consumed energy and resources over several years. We hope that the rulings will place the matter behind us and that the infringer will cease unlawful activities.

New Board Officers and Directors. The board elected a slate of officers to serve through the April 2004 Conference. In June, we welcomed Eastern Canada regional trustee Robert Pelot as a director; and, were pleased to welcome Valerie O'Neill, who, on rotation of G.S.O. staff, became staff coordinator, a position that entails serving as an A.A.W.S. director for two years.

Amendments to Employees' Retirement Plan of A.A. World Services and Grapevine: The A.A.W.S. Board approved an amendment to the Retirement Plan, effective January 1, 2003, to add a section outlining the terms of the Early Retirement Window offered in 2001 to those participants who met the terms of the offering on July 31, 2001 and who will have actually retired no later than 2003. The board also approved amendments to the Retirement Plan as requested by the Internal Revenue Service (I.R.S.) at the time of our application for requalification of the Plan. A Flexible Spending Plan was approved by the board as an additional employee benefit.

Staff/Employees: At year-end 2003, G.S.O. had 76 full-time employees, plus 7 part-time/students. Biennial Staff Rotation was accomplished during the last week of June, rather than in September, as had been the practice. The early transition has worked well. In October, we welcomed Irene Kontje to the G.S.O. staff, who, after a training period, assumed responsibility for the Treatment Facilities/Loners-Internationalists assignment. The

board recognized Joanie Moncrief for her years as a G.S.O. staff member and past A.A.W.S. director.

Conversion to Traverse Information Services (Windows-based software) *System* was completed and the AS-400 mid-range system retired. This transition completed Phase Two of the systems upgrade, and provides great improvement in our ability to integrate multiple tasks, while enhancing functionality.

Office Emergency Response Planning: The Blackout of 2003 (electrical system failures in northeastern states) caused the General Service Office to close for one day. Thereafter, we endured several days of disruption to our Local Area Network (LAN) due to Blaster Worm viruses uploaded during reconfiguration of our systems. Consequently, we have added several items to our Disaster Recovery Plan that continues to be refined by the Management Committee. We agreed to expand Disaster Recovery to include Emergency Response Planning so that our focus is the entire organization, including protection and recovery of information technology.

Dorothy J. May, chairperson

ARCHIVES

Trustees' committee: This year we completed the French and Spanish translations of the video, "Markings on the Journey." The third volume of the Archives Scrapbook has been reproduced and is available at \$65.00. The first volume covers the years of 1939-1942; the second volume focuses on the single year of 1943. There were three volumes of clippings gathered for 1944, and the newly produced item is a reproduction of the first volume. In time the other two volumes will follow. In December the revised Archives Workbook was published incorporating suggestions, commentaries received from areas.

A revised Research Permission Policy document was developed by the committee including sections on the importance of anonymity in archival research, as well as a copyright and ownership statement. The document is also available on the G.S.O.'s Web site.

The Mission Statement of the General Service Office Archives has been revised to reflect our goals more accurately. The newly revised statement titled Mission and Purpose has been approved by the General Service Board on November 3, 2003.

The committee developed Guidelines for Collecting Oral Histories, in order to offer assistance to local oral history collecting efforts. The document summarizes suggestions for collecting, use and access to oral histories, along with technical suggestions and sample questionnaires.

Ric Downey, chairperson

Archivist's report: The Archives Department provides assistance as well as conducts historic research for A.A. members, members of the G.S.O. staff, members of the boards, as well as nonmembers qualified researchers. The Archives staff includes Michelle Mirza, assistant archivist, Noela Jordan, research assistant. They are assisted by one full-time and three part-time employees.

Two display cabinets have been added to the exhibit area at the G.S.O. Archives. The museum quality display cabinets have been special ordered to provide an archivally safe and secure place to display some of the cherished items: e.g. an audiogram recording of an early African-American member personally collected by Bill W., early pamphlets, and 19th century literature on alcoholism, among others. We plan to rotate the items and display additional "treasures" from our collection.

We reformulated the role and contents of Markings, the archives newsletter. The publication has been expanded into a bimonthly

historic newsletter, and we plan to publish a variety of historic articles in addition to archival sharing from areas.

The archivist met with legal counsel to discuss several issues affecting our collection, both in term of our plans for reproducing audio material, and also regarding our commitment to support researchers in their work to the best of our abilities. The G.S.O. Archives has become an important and reputable center for research on Alcoholics Anonymous. It is critical to maintain our role in supporting scholarly and academic historic heritage and the impact of our Fellowship on many lives.

We expect to complete the audio preservation project in early 2004; thousands of reel-to-reel tapes of varies formats, cassettes, vinyl records, and audiograms have been digitized in order to protect the records from further deterioration.

Judit Santon, archivist

AUDIT COMMITTEE

Trustees' report: During the past year your General Service Board formed an "Audit Committee," which consists of four trustees in addition to the board treasurer, who chairs the committee. The committee meets with the outside auditor and G.S.O. and Grapevine management, then separately with the auditor, and then reports to the General Service Board. The committee reviews such items as audit process, audit results, internal controls, best accounting practices, and management integrity.

The committee recommended, and the trustees' Finance Committee followed through on the creation of a financial policy guideline. The committee felt that even though our financial officers and auditor understand "Generally Accepted Accounting Principles," the purposes of the document was to assist nonfinancial types to understand the general financial policies we follow.

Vincent Keefe, treasurer

CONFERENCE

Trustees' report: The committee met three times since the 2003 General Service Conference. During that period, we reviewed the Advisory Actions pertaining to the 2003 Conference, including the theme chosen for the 54th General Service Conference, "Our Singleness of Purpose — The Cornerstone of A.A."

During the July meeting, the committee discussed a Summary of the Evaluation Questionnaires and a Summary of the Post-Conference Sharing Session. We implemented the following suggestions:

- As suggested by the 2003 Conference Agenda Committee, the committee reviewed the General Service Conference Evaluation Form and suggested that the question under the category "Pre-Conference," which reads, "Was the advance material and preparation from G.S.O. adequate and timely, () Yes () No" be replaced with the following two questions:

a) Was the advance material and preparation from G.S.O. adequate?

☐ Yes ☐ No

b) Was the advance material and preparation from G.S.O. timely?

☐ Yes ☐ No

- As suggested by the 2003 Conference Agenda Committee, the committee also suggested that the parenthetical explanation "(e.g. schedule of Conference activities, meals, hotel accommodations, the trip to G.S.O., etc.)" be added to the sentence for item 7 which would then read: "If you have suggestions for improving the Conference (e.g. schedule of Conference activities, meals, hotel accommodations, the trip to G.S.O., etc.), please list them here:"

We agreed that the joint committee sessions should continue to be scheduled in two sessions with an attempt to offer more flexibility to the joint meetings of the Grapevine.

The committee accepted the report and recommended to the General Service Board that the subcommittee's Report on Laptop Use — suggesting continued use of laptops with existing guidelines — be forwarded to the 2004 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions for their consideration.

- We reviewed and accepted the preliminary budget for the 54th General Service Conference and forwarded it to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee.

- We reviewed and approved the workshop questions for the 54th General Service Conference for distribution in the Communications Kit to be mailed on or about January 2, 2004.

- We reviewed the preliminary Agenda of the 2004 General Service Conference and approved the schedule.

- We carefully reviewed all agenda items submitted to date and forwarded each to the appropriate committee or board for consideration.

- We discussed the laptop experiment and requested that the secretary include a copy of the guidelines for PC users at General Service Conference with the invitation to all Conference members about the continuing laptop experiment.

During the committee's January meeting the following actions were taken:

- We finalized and approved the main Conference Agenda, including presentation topics chosen by the Conference Agenda



Committee and approved by the 2003 Conference.

- Considered the request to compile and make available all proposed items and their source of origin, which were not forwarded to the Conference and make a list of these items available to the Conference delegates with the final Conference Agenda. Following a lengthy discussion the committee agreed to table this item until its July 2004 meeting. The committee asked the committee secretary to communicate with the submitting area outlining the committee's questions and concerns and to gather further details on other options for reporting this information.
- Reviewed the report from the A.A.W.S. Board requesting wider sharing on the electronic transmission of Conference Agendas and background material and agreed to forward it to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.
- Since the 2003 General Service Conference, the committee has forwarded 50 proposed Conference agenda topics to trustees and Conference committees or, where appropriate, to the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Corporate Boards.
- We welcomed the delegate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee to our January meeting.

Our committee sincerely hopes that everyone has a wonderful Conference experience and that we will all continue to enjoy the wonderful life that has been given to us in Alcoholics Anonymous.

Ron Gauthier, chairperson

Staff Report: The Conference coordinator is the G.S.O. contact for General Service Conference members. The Conference process continues throughout the year and the coordinator corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates, who cooperate to make the annual Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. The coordinator of the Conference is also the contact for area and district committee members, as well as past delegates, in the 93 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

Created in 1951, the annual meeting of the General Service Conference became in July 1955 "...the guardian of the traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous, the perpetuators of the world services of our Society, the voice of the group conscience of our entire Fellowship, and the sole successor of its co-founders, Doctor Bob and Bill." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, pp. S91-S92)

A.A. members are encouraged to submit topics through their area structures for consideration by the Conference. Suggested topics may be forwarded to a trustees' committee for consideration and, where appropriate, referred directly to a Conference committee. Occasionally topics are submitted, which are more appropriately under the purview of either the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Boards. These items are accordingly forwarded to those boards for their attention. The Conference coordinator is responsible for:

- Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are reviewed by the Conference Agenda Committee, which makes selections that are recommended to the Conference for approval.
- Working with the G.S.O. staff and general manager on planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and other information for the Conference Manual; and, with the guidance of the Publications Department, the Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.

None of this work would be possible without the help of a very capable staff assistant and an "in house" team of extraordinary G.S.O. employees working behind the scenes to ensure that the Conference week is a memorable experience for all.

Bill Archer

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY/TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustee's report: The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community and Treatment Facilities were combined by action of the General Service Board in April 1998. Since the 2003 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities has met three times. The committee's work embodies A.A.'s primary purpose, and is guided by actions of the General Service Conference and the General Service Board. Highlights of trustees' Committee meetings have been sent to area, district and other C.P.C. and Treatment Facilities chairs, in addition to current sharing that could benefit local committees.

At the November meeting, the committee made a minor revision to its Composition, Scope and Procedure. The committee also reviewed the Treatment Facilities and Cooperation With the Professional Community Workbook Guide Letters and agreed that the guide letters should be made available for transmission to A.A. members in electronic format upon request.

Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) — A primary committee focus is assisting local C.P.C. committees to provide A.A. information to professionals who, through their work, may come in contact with the still-suffering alcoholic. The committee oversaw a revision of the text and format of "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous" (F-02). We also reviewed a request to develop a pamphlet similar to the flyer "So the Court Sent You to A.A. and You Hate the Idea." The committee concluded that the flyer could be produced locally, and did not feel that it should be produced by A.A. World Services.

The committee reviewed the 2003 list of 52 exhibits as well as the exhibit evaluations and expressed gratitude for the breadth and depth of these opportunities for contact with so many professional groups. Offers to exhibit at professional conferences are considered based on expanding the range of professions and on new geographical locations. A new design for the traveling displays sent to national professional exhibits was implemented. One retired display is being provided to each region in the U.S. and Canada for disposition by the regional trustee.

Treatment Facilities — The committee's interest in treatment facilities, rehabilitation centers and similar centers is reflected through local A.A. committees on Treatment Facilities, Hospitals & Institutions and Bridging the Gap. Shared experience about this facet of Twelfth Step work is conveyed in literature, by written communications, and by articles in *Box 4-5-9*. The committee considers the need for changes in related literature and service material, such as the Treatment Facilities Workbook and Kit.

At the suggestion of the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee, the trustees oversaw the development and implementation of the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook into a three-ring binder format.

A committee member shared his concerns regarding the current scope and activities of T.F. committees at all levels in A.A. The committee began a long-range discussion of the effectiveness of T.F. committees and the General Service Office Treatment Facilities staff assignment. The committee member submitted his thoughts in writing and this item will be discussed further at the August meeting.

Allen Ault, chairperson

Staff reports:

Cooperation With the Professional Community — Experience indicates that many professionals are aware of A.A., yet few know what A.A. is, or what we do, and fewer have been to an A.A. meeting. The staff member on the Cooperation With the Professional

Community (C.P.C.) assignment, along with a capable assistant, provides information about A.A. and facilitates good communication with those outside of A.A. who may have direct contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their professional work.

In 2003, the C.P.C. desk responded to more than 1,900 inquiries from professionals, 1,017 of which were associated with visits to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, other requests coming by letter, e-mail and phone. Many of those same professionals were put in touch with local C.P.C. committees who responded with offers for direct contact, information about how to send clients to meetings, offers of literature, or other means to assure that A.A. is a resource for professionals.

Another way that we endeavor to see that professionals are aware of the long-range help offered by A.A. include the newsletter for professionals, *About A.A.* Three issues of *About A.A.* were published in 2003. The Spring and Summer issues focused on the role doctors have played in A.A., and the Fall issue was about A.A. as a spiritual, rather than religious program. Currently, more than 15,000 professionals are receiving *About A.A.*

Professional exhibits continue to result in requests for additional A.A. information, as well as personal contacts with local committee members. The C.P.C. assignment arranged for displays at fifty-two at national or international conferences of professionals. At these exhibits, G.S.O. provides the booth space and literature; local C.P.C. committees coordinate A.A. volunteers who staff the booth to questions and provide literature and contacts. In addition, over 20 local exhibits were referred to area C.P.C. committees.

The C.P.C. desk is a resource for C.P.C. chairs throughout the U.S. and Canada. New chairpersons at the area and district levels are sent a welcome letter and applicable C.P.C. background material. Upon request, we assist C.P.C. committees by sharing C.P.C. experience. C.P.C. committees are encouraged to send minutes and to share their experiences for possible inclusion in future *Box 4-5-9* articles. Articles were published in *Box 4-5-9* about local C.P.C. activities throughout the year. This created interest in C.P.C. service work with courts, clergy, doctors, medical students, educators and other professionals.

The C.P.C. staff member greets students from Cornell University Medical Center who visit G.S.O. throughout the year. These future physicians are helped to see that A.A. can be a valuable resource when they encounter the still-suffering alcoholic. The students are provided with literature, given a brief introduction to the A.A. program, a tour of G.S.O. and encouraged to attend "open" A.A. meetings. The staff member on C.P.C. serves as the liaison to area, district and other committees involved in carrying the A.A. message to remote communities — those communities to which it is difficult to carry the A.A. message because of language, culture, or geography.

The staff member on C.P.C. also serves informally as a liaison representative to several national meetings such as the National Institute for Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism, and Recovery Month planning meetings.

Rick Walker

Treatment Facilities — The primary purpose of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to share experience and information with committees that carry the A.A. message into a variety of treatment settings. G.S.O. currently lists 89 area Treatment Facilities (T.F.) committee chairpersons, plus 389 district and other T.F. chairpersons, as well as 22 area Bridging the Gap (BTG) and 15 area Hospitals and Institutions (H&I) committee chairpersons; 116 BTG and H&I district and other chairpersons are also listed. The total list comprises 631 T.F. — related trusted servants. Each is involved in one or more facets of providing A.A. meetings

and/or information in treatment settings.

Highlights of quarterly meetings of the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities are sent to members of the Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, Public Information and Treatment Facilities Committees. Periodically, we share highlights from the trustees' meetings and activities from the T.F. staff assignment with area, district and other T.F. chairs, for the benefit of the committees they chair. In addition, we are always grateful for local T.F. experience that may be included in an activity report or in a *Box 4-5-9* article.

Each committee chair is sent a welcome letter along with the Treatment Facilities Kit and/or Workbook, as well as A.A. Guidelines and related material. These trusted servants receive *Box 4-5-9* and *About A.A.* to share with their committee. Area T.F. chairs also receive an up-to-date, confidential list of all Area T.F. Committee chairs so that they can share experiences and activities. Correspondence, including requests for sharing and for G.S.O.'s collected experience, is always welcomed from local committees. Some committees are invigorated through cooperation with professional staff in local facilities, often learning better ways to approach clients within the regulations established by the facility.

The T.F. staff member also receives correspondence from clients or patients in treatment centers. Each request receives a response from the staff member along with A.A. literature. Some of these patients submit a request for help and are referred to local committees so that local committee members have the opportunity to extend the hand of A.A. Requests from professionals in treatment centers are given careful attention. Each professional is sent literature, and in most cases contact with members of the Treatment Facilities or C.P.C. Committee is arranged. The staff member on this assignment also serves as secretary to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities, and as co-secretary to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities.

Irene Kontje

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

Trustees' report: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities is to recommend to the General Service Board actions that support carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Since the 2003 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities has met three times.

At the recommendation of the 2003 Conference: The trustees' Committee asked the Fellowship for stories/sharing to update and revise A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate. In particular, sharing was sought from young people and women. Given the ongoing need to gather additional material, the trustees' committee prepared a progress report on the development of a draft manuscript of A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate, noting that a) requests for stories with language particularly pertinent to youth will be sent in February to the Host/Advisory Committees of Young People in A.A. Conventions, and b) a second letter requesting stories will be sent to Area Correctional Committee chairs asking for any tapes of women and youth from their correctional conferences. We reviewed production suggestions developed by G.S.O.'s Publication Department.

The committee agreed to forward the following statement on A.A.'s singleness of purpose, approved by the 2003 General Service Conference, to the 2004 Conference Committee for possible inclusion in the Correctional Facilities Workbook: "Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as 'sub-

stance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend open A.A. meetings, but only those with a drinking problem may attend closed meetings."

The committee reviewed a report from the subcommittee on prerelease material and agreed to forward the report, along with edited samples of prerelease material, to the 2004 Conference Correctional Facilities Committee for their consideration. We also reviewed their Composition, Scope and Procedure, and agreed that: a) an accurate description of the committee and related Twelfth Step work is important, and b) the committee title should reflect their shared experience of the wide scope of correction service. Consequently, the committee has proposed a name change from "trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities" to "trustees' Committee on Corrections."

We reviewed sharing from the Fellowship regarding how A.A. is introduced into training programs for correctional facilities personnel and agreed to forward this topic to the 2004 Conference Correctional Facilities Committee for their input, in particular on how to best gather additional sharing. The Correctional Facilities Workbook Guide Letters were reviewed and it was agreed that the guide letters should be made available for transmission to A.A. members in electronic format.

The committee reviewed the revised letters for the biennial mailing to 10,000 correctional professionals. The letters now include the information that A.A. pamphlets and books are available in languages other than English, and contain language about A.A. that is particularly pertinent to selective correctional settings. The committee agreed to send a copy of the July 2003 issue of the *A.A. Grapevine: Released — One Day at a Time* out with the biennial mailing; it already is being sent to all inmates who contact the office for prerelease assistance.

The committee also discussed ways of adding new appointed committee members so that rotation occurs on alternate years, facilitating the work of the committee. A request to replace two appointed committee members rotating in 2004 was forwarded to the trustees' Nominating Committee and five candidates were interviewed. The committee continues to discuss ways to improve the methods of carrying the A.A. message into a variety of correctional settings.

Leonard M. Blumenthal, chairperson

Staff report: The Correctional Facilities assignment is responsible for helping A.A. members and local committees carry the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Over 750 letters a month arrive from inmates, most asking for free literature, many asking for names of outside A.A. members with whom to correspond, or for help in making contact with A.A. upon release. We try to facilitate these requests, primarily through our network of area, district and local Correctional Facilities committees. The newsletter, *Sharing From Behind the Walls*, containing sharing from inmate letters sent to G.S.O., is also a responsibility of this assignment.

The Corrections Correspondence Service (CCS), coordinated by this desk, continues as one of our most valuable efforts. Many inmates are looking to turn their lives around and crave outside support from A.A.s with whom they can share their experience, strength and hope. There is an ongoing need for "outside" A.A. members, particularly men, to participate in this service. Yet whenever a G.S.O. staff member attending an assembly, convention, conference or other Fellowship function has mentioned the tremendous need for CCS volunteers and provided ample supplies of the service piece *Corrections Correspondence — a Special Kind of A.A. Service* (F-26), there has been a substantial increase in the number of A.A.s wishing to correspond with those on the

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 2004¹

	Groups	Members
United States	52,735	1,187,169
Canada	4,884	96,446
Sub-Total	57,619	1,283,615
Correctional facilities ²	2,545	66,509
Internationalists		70
Lone members		204
Total	60,164	1,350,398
Outside U.S. & Canada ³	44,425	716,453
Grand Total	104,589	2,066,851

1. The General Service Office does not keep membership records. The information shown here is based on reports given by groups listed with G.S.O., and does not represent an actual count of those who consider themselves A.A. members.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

3. We are aware of A.A. activity in approximately 150 countries, including 54 autonomous general service offices in other lands. Annually we attempt to contact those G.S.O.s and groups that request to be listed in our records. Where current data is lacking we use an earlier year's figures.

inside. Additionally, a letter explaining the Corrections Correspondence Service is sent twice a year to delegates and correctional chairpersons asking for A.A. volunteers to write to inmates on an individual basis.

The staff member sends an alternate year informational letter to wardens and correctional professionals throughout the United States and Canada, enclosing a return postcard for those professionals requesting additional information or contact with a local A.A. Correctional Facilities committee. Welcome letters are sent to all newly elected Correctional Facilities (C.F.), Hospitals and Institutions (H&I) and Bridging the Gap (B.T.G.) chairpersons of area, district and central office/intergroup committees.

One of the most pleasant duties of the assignment is communicating with the area and district Correctional Facilities, Hospitals and Institutions and Bridging the Gap committees. We shared with the committees our list/order forms, available in English, French and Spanish, for obtaining Correctional Facilities discount packages. These packages were designed to assist Correctional Facilities committees in their Twelfth Step work by providing an assortment of A.A. literature at discount prices.

A frequent question asked by A.A. members involved in corrections service is how to get their fellow members on the "outside" to commit to speaking or sponsoring a meeting in a correctional facility. The fear of not having the inmate identify with an A.A. member who has not been to prison, and the amount of time institutions require for orientation seminars to qualify to go into correctional facilities are commonly pointed out as impediments to Fellowship participation. *Carrying the Message Behind These Walls*, a video created to encourage A.A. members to participate in correctional service, addresses many of the concerns that may hold members back from this rewarding Twelfth Step work.

Mary Clare Lynch

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' report: At last year's Conference we reviewed the proposed budget for 2003 and reported that the G.S.O. expected a loss from operations of approximately \$890,000, which after mid-year adjustments resulted in an estimated loss of \$950,000. Actual results for 2003 were some \$305,000 better. Net revenues were about \$75,000 better than expected and expenses were about \$230,000 less than budgeted. At the end of 2003 the Reserve Fund balance represented approximately 9.7 months of operating expenses.

General Service Office — Our revenue essentially comes from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions. We should all be encouraged that contributions in 2003 were again higher than the previous year, even if ever so slightly. This represents the sixth year in a row that contributions have increased over the previous year and reflects a positive trend. Contributions of \$4,997,400 received from groups and members were \$102,600, or 2% less than budgeted, but \$6,000 more than in 2002. The \$4,997,400 in contributions came from about 25,400 groups, individuals, and service entities. That, for comparison, represents 44.7% of the 56,904 groups registered with G.S.O., and is just slightly less than the previous year. Beginning in 2002 we were obliged to record funds received on behalf of the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund as Contributions to G.S.O. Total contributions of \$5,100,308, as reflected in our 2003 financial statements, include approximately \$103,000 received to help carry the message around the world from those participating countries. During 2002 the comparable number was \$108,000. While contributions dollars were essentially flat, so were the number of groups reported. Interestingly though, both the number and percent of groups contributing appear to be decreasing ever so slightly. It is important to remember that the statistics we discuss concerning number of groups, membership and averages are only a reflection of the information we capture on "our systems." We report to you what you report to us.

Turning to the other major component of our income, net sales of literature were \$10,460,500. This was \$300,000, or 3%, greater than budgeted, and within \$25,000 of the prior year. During 2003, there continued to be a leveling off of the Fourth Edition Big Book sales (approximately 134,000 fewer units sold). However, this was offset somewhat by sales of 65,000 units of *Experience, Strength and Hope*. In total, printing and other manufacturing costs, shipping expenses and royalty payments were greater than budget, as were sales. As a result, gross profit of \$4,706,250 was \$100,000 more than budgeted.

The combination of contributions and net literature sales resulted in total G.S.O. revenue of \$9,809,800, some \$73,800 (less than 1%) greater than originally budgeted. Total operating expenses for G.S.O. during 2003 were \$10,454,900. This was \$231,800 less than budget, but \$290,000 more than the previous year. Therefore, compared with the budget, the increase in revenues augmented by the decreased expenses resulted in an operating loss of \$645,160 for the year, a substantial improvement from the budgeted loss of \$950,845. It should be noted that these figures reflect the combined results of G.S.O. New York and the SMAA Office in Montreal. Effective January 1, 2003, the SMAA office was closed and the French-speaking A.A. members are being serviced from G.S.O. in New York. In 1994, G.S.O. lowered prices and increased discounts on literature. These changes were undertaken to lower the Reserve Fund, which was approaching the upper limit established by the General Service Conference. The Conference-approved limit is 12 months of combined G.S.O. and Grapevine operating expenses. We had accomplished the objective of lowering the Reserve Fund. At December 2003 the balance was about 9.7 months. At \$9,730,900

(the adjusted balance used for the calculation), the Reserve Fund amounts to \$167 per listed A.A. group. To give perspective to this number, contributions per group averaged about \$88 for the 56,904 groups registered, while expenses to support services to those groups averaged \$124 per group.

Turning to 2004, the G.S.O. budget, after taking into account a leveling off of sales of the Fourth Edition, as well as the anthology *Experience, Strength and Hope*, we have assumed relatively flat unit sales of books and booklets. Your responsible trusted servants, after reviewing financial matters, recommended a restoration of the price of the Big Book effective July 1, 2004. You may remember that the price of the Fourth Edition was set at \$5.00 vs. \$6.00, thus specifically reducing the expected Gross Profit with a goal of reducing the Reserve Fund. Projections at that time anticipated that, depending on contributions, the price would be restored in a few years. Prudence dictates that even though contribution revenue has seen a favorable upward movement during the last several years, a restoration of the revenue stream is appropriate. Trusted servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations, as well as assess the services supplied. You may also be aware that as we continue to strive to have literature available — for our Service Conference, in the Spanish and French languages as well as English, lower print runs in those languages result in higher production costs. Because we strive to have similar selling prices regardless of our manufacturing cost, lower overall gross profits are an expected result.

In keeping with our Seventh Tradition of self-support, this year's budget also includes a slight increase in contributions. The budget envisions approximately a 6.8% increase in costs when compared with 2003 actual, but only a 4.5% increase when compared with the 2003 budget. Based on these primary assumptions — a slight increase in dollar sales; a 1.5% increase in contributions; an increase in total operating expenses — the projection for 2004 is for an excess of expense over revenue of \$618,241, which compares with the 2003 budgeted loss of \$950,845. As mentioned in prior reports, following three consecutive years of planned losses (1995-1997), the Reserve Fund was at a point where it was prudent to anticipate slightly better than break-even years, and we did! Then, following a very good year in 2000, both from operations and the Convention, as noted last year, the Reserve Fund was approaching the 12-month level. We were grateful when the Conference moved forward the "Floating Cap plan" allowing for the orderly "managing down" of the Reserve Fund. We are seeing the results of that action.

Just to expand a bit on the use of the Fellowship's money in providing services back to the Fellowship — in 2003 we spent \$7,088,055 on services to the Fellowship, approximately \$94,000, or 1%, less than the \$7,182,000 spent in 2002. This compares with \$6,685,600 spent in 2001, \$6,143,300 spent in 2000, \$5,876,500 in 1999, \$5,867,700 in 1998, and \$5,944,000 in 1997. Contributions provided 72% of this and 28% came from the profit from literature sales. (This compares with 71% and 29% in 2002, 70% and 30% in 2001, and 73% and 27% for 2000.) Services spending amounted to \$125 per listed A.A. group, down \$2 from last year, while contributions were about \$89 per group, up \$1. The 2003 service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services 34.8% (which includes the Group Services assignment; *Box 4-5-9*; A.A. Directories; records and files; contributions processing; and French services); the General Service Conference, 13.7%; Loners, Internationalists, and Overseas Services, 9.7%; trustees' and directors' activities, 6.7%; Regional Forums, 7.1%; Archives, 9.2%; C.P.C., 5.5%; Spanish Services, 1.8%; Public Information, 5.2%; Correctional Facilities, 3.7%; and Treatment Facilities, 2.0%; other 0.6%.

The Grapevine — At the Grapevine, magazine income was approximately even with the previous year, as was circulation.

Average circulation during 2003 was 112,614 compared with 115,753 for 2002, 115,000 in 2001, 115,700 in 2000, 115,900 for 1999, 117,300 for 1998, 120,679 for 1997, and 128,360 during 1996. Gross profit on the magazine was \$1,156,152, which was \$89,000 more than last year but \$23,400 less than budgeted. Revenue of Other Items was \$13,600, less than budgeted but \$67,300 more than last year. Gross profit on Other Items, was approximately \$32,000 more than budgeted and \$81,300 more than 2002. Therefore, total income, including interest income, was \$1,574,700, approximately \$170,600 more than last year and about \$8,700 more than budgeted as well.

Costs and expenses for editorial, circulation and business, and administration were \$1,626,148. This is \$139,600 more than last year, however, it was \$4,000 less than budget. As a result, the Grapevine (excluding La Viña) reported a small profit from operations (excluding SMAA) of \$5,400 compared with the \$12,000 loss last year.

The Grapevine's 2004 budget, excluding La Viña, calls for a \$10,000 increase in magazine subscription income to \$1,652,500, compared with 2003, a decrease in magazine direct costs of \$70,000, and a gross profit of \$1,236,200. Gross profit on Other Publishing Income is anticipated to increase \$91,000, while interest income should be somewhat less. The anticipated profit for 2004 of \$105,104 compares favorably with the 2003 budget of \$4,358 and the actual 2003 results of \$5,400, which goes a long way toward putting a halt to many consecutive years of operating losses for the Grapevine.

La Viña — La Viña, the Spanish-language magazine project, was approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 2003 average circulation of 9,222, up slightly from the 2002 circulation of 9,000. Past circulation is, 8,600 in 2001, 8,500 in 2000, 8,000 in 1999, and 8,400 in 1997. La Viña appears to be a first-rate product. Our hope is that it will increasingly fulfill the needs of our Spanish-speaking members and we will see a growth in circulation. To date, the project has incurred losses each of the past seven and one-half years. During 2003, subscription income was \$72,552 and direct costs of publishing were \$63,630, resulting in a \$8,922 gross profit. Operating expenses directly associated with the publication were \$120,560. These include the editorial, circulation and administrative costs attributable to La Viña. Therefore, the overall loss on the project for the year was \$111,638.

The Grapevine Board and management have worked hard to put out a quality product that is responsive to the needs of the Spanish-speaking members of the Fellowship on a cost-effective basis. For 2004, the loss on the La Viña project is budgeted to increase approximately \$7,000, to \$118,695, and circulation is projected to increase slightly to around 9,500 copies. The Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee will continue to monitor progress against the original business plan and inform the Conference. Since the inception of the project, \$779,744 has been invested in La Viña, and, in 2001 the General Service Board recommended that La Viña continue to be published at the General Service Board's expense.

In summary, the Fellowship's finances remain in good condition, the outlook for this year appears to be favorable, and we continue to have the financial wherewithal to carry the message.

Vincent Keefe, treasurer

Bells and whistles went off when Linda Blumenthal (wife of trustee Leonard Blumenthal) passed through the entrance to the Museum of the American Indian. Linda was the 4 millionth visitor to the museum. She was photographed, interviewed and received books, t-shirts, CDs and was on the museum Web site.

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: Since the 54th General Service Conference, the board held three General Sharing Sessions. The topic of the August 2003 session was "Singleness of Purpose — For That I Am Responsible." The November topic was "Our Vision for A.A.'s Future — Our Responsibility for Long Term Planning?" In January 2004, the session focused on "Informing the Informed Group Conscience."

August 2003 — Bob Pelot, Eastern Canada regional trustee, opened his presentation on "Singleness of Purpose and the Home Group" with a comfortable definition of singleness of purpose for him — "great determination when you are working to achieve something." In his home group, Bob learned the importance of informed group conscience decisions, the importance of attendance and participation in regular meetings and, later, group monthly business meetings. He also noted that our First Concept states, "The A.A. groups today hold ultimate responsibility and final authority for our world services." So if he wants his voice to be heard it is in his home group.

The focus of Pacific regional trustee, Phyllis Halliday, presentation was "Singleness of Purpose as a Trusted Servant." The face of our Fellowship has changed with increasing numbers of dual addicted members and our singleness of purpose has been questioned, tested and the degree of latitude within Traditions Three and Five have been examined. Phyllis asked, "What is our responsibility?" To keep A.A. on a straight course and protect what has been passed on and entrusted to us. To avoid becoming rule bound or rigid in our thinking and to understand and trust the flexibility our program allows. To exercise individual responsibility as members of our beloved Society, Alcoholics Anonymous. The core principles of A.A. are the same. We rally around our Traditions, unwavering in our common purpose and message of hope and recovery. In holding fast to our singleness of purpose, we can never forget the day, the hour we reached out for help — the hand of A.A. was there and for that we are still responsible.

These presentations generated the following personal sharing: Emphasis on singleness of purpose should be steadfast, but tempered by kindness and tolerance consistent information about singleness of purpose helps non-A.A. professionals understand A.A.'s commitment to our Third and Fifth Traditions; sponsorship and loving discussion helped me to understand singleness of purpose.

November 2003 — Allen Ault, Class A trustee, opened the Sharing Session by referring to several outside organizations that have had to permanently close their doors, for lack of support, as older members died off. Allen's experience is that he has attended some regional and area meetings where "above 50" seem to be a requirement. However, recently Allen attended an area corrections meeting where young people outnumbered older ones by at least a two to one margin. "Our future is assured, if and only if we can make every effort to reach out to a new generation who can also successfully carry the message, one drunk to another on a very personal basis."

John Koster, general service trustee, shared: Our basic vision for the future is simple. It is primary. It is to carry the message of recovery from alcoholism based on the Twelve Steps to the still-suffering alcoholic — and to do so through the efforts of each and every one of our members — because without the opportunity to participate in carrying the message our members will not survive. A "continuous moral inventory of our collective behavior" is the challenge we face. Representation: Maybe we need to look again, difficult and painful as it may be, into whether our Conference is representative of our Fellowship, not just geographically or

numerically, but by age and temperament. Corporate Boards: We have reached a point where we need to examine whether we can restore a separation of function of the two separate corporations while avoiding a concentration of power and maintaining an independent editorial voice. Fellowship: Every time we develop a new recovery pamphlet I believe we say "Welcome" to a whole group of people who might otherwise feel our message was not intended for them, or worse, that they would not in fact be welcome. Every time we develop a "How to ..." guideline, or the like, I believe we run the risk of implying that "This is the orthodox and only way to do things."

While service should not be made unnecessarily difficult, it is not supposed to be easy or convenient — it is supposed to be service.

As a new director on the A.A. Grapevine Board, John Skilton commented on "Our Responsibility for Long Term Planning." He found himself thrust into a series of ongoing discussions and debates, mostly centered on crisis resolution or operational issues that required immediate attention. In other words, he came face to face with the dilemma we all must face — how do you free up the time to envision A.A.'s future when you are constantly engaged in the pressing business of the moment. More and more, he has come to think of a two-year period as being the maximum extent to which boards and managers can usefully engage in detailed planning. By the way, this two-year horizon for useful planning just happens to coincide with the most frequently used time span for rotation in A.A. service positions. He shared that the willingness to operate in an uncertain world should not be an uncomfortable notion to those of us who are involved in A.A. World Service. In Bill W.'s essay on leadership in Concept IX, he spends considerable time discussing the need for vision in our leaders. He goes so far as to label it as the "all-important attribute," "the very essence of prudence," and "an essential virtue."

One presenter concluded with this vision for A.A.: "I hope our vision for A.A.'s future includes an A.A. where we devote our considerable collective effort to emphasizing the A.A. group as the fundamental recovery unit. I hope our vision for A.A.'s future includes an A.A. where groups still have the right to be wrong. I hope our vision for A.A.'s future includes an A.A. where service involving actual human contact with other recovering alcoholics remains a matter of emphasis. I hope our vision for A.A.'s future includes an A.A. where talismanic organizational words like 'speed' and 'convenience' do not replace the basic service structure and the language of the heart, which often takes a long time and a good deal of effort, both to express and to 'hear.' In short, I hope our vision for A.A.'s future includes a willingness to engage in a 'continuous moral inventory of our collective behavior,' and to include as many of our members as possible in every aspect of that exercise."

February 2004 — Rick Walker, G.S.O. staff member, shared on the topic, "G.S.O.'s Role in Informing the Informed Group

Conscience." G.S.O.'s role in informing the group conscience is not limited to replies to correspondence. In addition to responses to requests for specific information, G.S.O. sends out literature and bulletins. New G.S.R.s, area officers, and committee chairs are automatically sent literature to help them get started in their new positions. G.S.O.'s role in the General Service Conference is to insure that each Conference member has the information they need to be able to be an effective participant in the Conference. G.S.O. plays a role in helping create an informed group conscience for A.A. around the world. They aid with translation and publication of A.A. literature and help coordinate the World Service Meeting. The experience gathered by hearing how members in those countries apply A.A. principles and rise to face their challenges is added to the store of experience available to members in the U.S. and Canada. At home the sharing at Regional and Special Forums also offers a path to informing the informed group conscience. All of these activities performed by G.S.O. are intended to help each A.A. member to know enough of our shared history and experience so that he or she has an understanding of the principles of A.A., and can be part of an informed group conscience which allows us to live in unity.

Paul Cleary, A.A.W.S. director, introduced the topic "Informing the Informed Group Conscience — How Do Boards Inform the Group Conscience at All Levels?" by defining U.S./Canada Boards — never forgetting that throughout Alcoholics Anonymous there are many other boards serving international structures, central offices and intergroups, institutional committees, conventions and all sorts of other A.A. entities. The U.S./Canada boards primarily inform the group conscience through their participation in the General Service Conference, Regional and Special Forums and local A.A. service meetings. No one is better situated to place board actions in context than the trustees of the General Service Board. Regional trustees in particular are the most vital and visible link between the boards and delegates and, through them, to the rest of the Fellowship. Nonalcoholic (Class A) trustees, because of their eminence in their fields, can have a positive effect on public and professional perceptions of A.A. This is a different group conscience, if you will, but a vital one indeed, for it involves the court of public opinion. In countries where A.A. is in its pioneering stage, a nonalcoholic can break down barriers to the acceptance of A.A. and boost A.A. membership by legitimizing our program and urging cooperation with the professional community.

Paul asked how can the boards better inform the group conscience of A.A.? The following suggestions are made to stimulate ideas for the future: Review our mailing lists; post board actions on the Web site; cast the net wider to fill our boards and committees; use our specialized contact groups such as International Lawyers in A.A., International Doctors in A.A., the International Advisory Council and International Conference of Young People in A.A.; Increase our presence at conventions and round-ups — a



basic principle of Twelfth Step work seems to follow the drunks, and many of them are at these gatherings.

The chair thanked both presenters for their thought-provoking and challenging presentations. The following are highlights of subsequent sharing:

- Be cautious about Floor Actions at the Conference, as a hurried group conscience decision can bypass the advantages and wisdom of the lengthy Conference process.
- If there is wider dissemination of board and Conference information, does information out of context jeopardize the integrity of existing structures?
- Another point of view — is the Fellowship over-informed? Are we chasing people away with too much information?
- Encouraging additional communication with central offices and intergroups, the front lines of A.A., may help unity and support of direct Twelfth Step service.
- Service structure information should communicate simply what we do and how things work.
- "Raw information is not the answer."
- The service messenger needs to be able to communicate with knowledge and enthusiasm and to create trust.

George Vaillant, M.D., chairperson

GROUP SERVICES

Staff report: The Group Services staff member oversees the production of service material that provides information and shared experience not found in Conference-approved literature. When a need is indicated G.S.O. provides service material, such as: New Group Forms; A.A. Guidelines; a catalog of A.A. Literature and Audiovisual Material, as well as a catalog for Special Needs. A multiple-page list describes the service items. The staff member on the Group Services desk oversees the production of these information pieces such as A.A. Guidelines, the Group Handbook, G.S.R. and D.C.M. Kits, and material for Special Needs. G.S.O. continues to work toward providing services in the three major languages of North America — English, French and Spanish. Current ongoing projects:

- Involved with coordination of three A.A. Directories: Eastern U.S., Western U.S. and Canadian. The staff member works closely with the Special Projects manager regarding directories and central/intergroup offices' records and lists.
- Supervision of G.S.O. Service files. There is a variety of service material available, upon request, to A.A. members, groups, and for service workshops. It is available in Spanish and French whenever possible.
- Liaison with intergroup/central offices, including serving on the Policy and Site Committees of the 19th Intergroup Seminar, which will next take place in Denver, Colorado, September 2004.
- Liaison with Special Needs Committees sharing available resources and experience from G.S.O.

Currently all correspondence in Spanish from the U.S./Canada comes to the Group Services desk, with the exception of corrections correspondence. There are approximately 1,680 Spanish-speaking groups in the U.S. and Canada. The Group Services staff member assists in providing services to the Spanish-speaking community. Many Spanish-speaking districts have been formed in area service structures, and continue to grow. The groups are represented by G.S.R.s at district meetings, where they elect D.C.M.s who represent the districts at area assemblies. Correspondence in Spanish from countries outside the US/Canada is handled by the staff on the International assignment.

A bilingual French-speaking staff member communicates and coordinates services for French-speaking groups and members in the US/Canada. In addition, a bilingual employee responds to

requests and inquiries from French-speaking members regarding literature orders and record issues. The staff member on Group Services also serves as secretary of the Conference Committee on Report and Charter and is currently G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site liaison.

Julio Espallat

INTERNATIONAL COMMITTEE/ WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Trustee's report: This committee is responsible for suggesting policies and actions to assure that the A.A. message is available around the world, especially in areas where there is no established service structure. We provide shared experience, support translations of A.A. literature in other languages, and encourage the expansion of regional or zonal meetings. The committee is the primary link between the international A.A. community and the U.S./Canada General Service Board of Trustees.

World Service Meeting — The 18th World Service Meeting will be held October 24-28 in New York City, with the theme "One Message — Many Languages — One Fellowship." We are anticipating over 40 delegates representing over 30 countries or zones. Murray McIntosh, trustee-at-large/Canada, will be a first-term delegate, and Charlie Bartell, trustee-at-large/U.S., will be a second-term delegate representing the General Service Board. G.S.O. general manager Greg Muth will be presiding at the event and staff member Adrienne Brown will serve as WSM coordinator. Other staff members who will serve as secretaries to WSM committees are Valerie O'Neill, Warren Stafford and Rick Walker. John Kirwin will be the logistical coordinator, in charge of the workroom and hotel facilities.

The 17th WSM in 2002 recommended that the A.A.W.S. Board develop material on country-to-country sponsorship. At the request of the A.A.W.S. Board, this committee reviewed a draft service piece on country-to-country sponsorship developed by G.S.O.'s Publications Department, and agreed to forward it to the Literature/Publishing Committee of the 18th WSM for their consideration.

Literature Assistance — The 2002 Literature Assistance budget of \$267,000 will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish a variety of foreign language books, pamphlets and reprints. A portion of this expense will be drawn from the International Literature Fund, representing contributions from A.A. groups and structures around the world. A.A.W.S. holds the copyrights on all foreign-language versions of our Conference-approved material and issues licensing agreements for publication and distribution to those countries which have an established general service office, board, conference or structure. When necessary, we translate and publish the material, subject to scheduling by the Publications Department and approval of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Since the last Conference, our basic text, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, has been translated into Khmer, the official language of Cambodia; the Big Book is now in 51 languages. *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* has been translated into Swahili; *Living Sober* is in Latvian and "A Newcomers Asks" in Simplified Chinese. We have started translating our "Basic Five" pamphlets, including "This is A.A.," "Is A.A. for You?" "44 Questions," "A Newcomer Asks," and "A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous," into Mongolian.

Interim Zonal Meetings — The United States and Canada were represented at four zonal service meetings, which are held in the year when the World Service Meeting does not meet. In 2003, Greg Muth and Adrienne Brown attended, as observers, the 1st Sub-Saharan Africa Meeting in Johannesburg, South Africa, the Fifth Asia-Oceania Meeting in Hong Kong, and the 12th European Service Meeting in Frankfurt, Germany. Charlie Bartell and Murray McIntosh were delegates to the 13th Meeting of the Americas (REDELA) in Maracaibo, Venezuela, and Adrienne Brown also

attended as observer.

International Trips — The General Service Board and General Service Office responded to many invitations from other countries to attend events ranging from conventions, anniversary celebrations, conferences, board meetings, office visits, regional assemblies, and other events. Trustees and staff members visited many countries, including Belarus, Colombia, Germany, Hong Kong, Iceland, India, Japan, Latvia, Mexico, Nicaragua, South Africa, Switzerland and Venezuela.

The committee reviewed a service piece highlighting international activities of the boards and G.S.O. and asked that it be added to the List of Service Material available at G.S.O. We continue to be encouraged and inspired by the international A.A. community and General Service Boards and offices in other countries, who carry our message to countless thousands in new regions and across difficult linguistic, cultural and economic barriers.

Charles Bartell, chairperson

Staff report: The International desk receives correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s and professionals interested in obtaining information about A.A. in countries outside of the U.S. and Canada. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 56 international general service offices and literature distribution centers. The International desk is also responsible for communication with structures, groups and members outside the United States/Canada. Correspondence arrives at the International desk in many languages and it is answered in the appropriate language, often accompanied by A.A. literature. In order to accomplish this, the staff member on the International desk is assisted by a bilingual (English-Spanish) assistant and the services of both our G.S.O. translators and outside professional services. In addition, G.S.O. staff who are fluent in other languages aid in telephone or in person communications. Where there is a nearby office, we provide the location, telephone number and e-mail or Web site address. We emphasize our faith in the fact that these members can maintain sobriety, help others and become independent in their own countries.

The International staff member benefits by the experience of G.S.O. staff, great cooperation with the Publications Department and, most importantly, the complete support of the trustees' International Committee, which he or she serves as secretary.

Other responsibilities on the assignment are:

- Serving as coordinator for the biennial World Service Meeting (WSM) and maintaining contact with WSM delegates and their offices throughout the year.
- Maintaining close communications with our Publications Department on requests for new translations of literature (most touching are the unanticipated translations of the Big Book lovingly prepared by an A.A. member), and the beginnings of new general service or information offices that may be able to distribute literature to local members and groups.
- Translation of A.A. literature: Each year, the A.A. World Services Board receives offers to translate our literature into foreign languages. Primary in consideration of each request is the need to ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message. To that end, the Publications Department has the responsibility of having each translation checked against the English original. In countries where there is a general service board licensed to publish or distribute A.A. literature, an approved translation is often financed and published there. Where a stable A.A. structure is not yet present, the A.A.W.S. Board undertakes the new publication when funds are available. The Big Book has been translated into about 50 languages, and additional translations are pending approval and/or funding.
- Communications related to overseas trips, including Interim

Zonal Service Meetings, held biennially in the year between each World Service Meeting. In addition, our office sends one or two observers to the Asia-Oceania, European, Eastern European and Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meetings. Our two trustees-at-large (U.S. and Canada) are our delegates to the REDELA (Meeting of the Americas).

Adrienne Brown

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' report:

International Conventions — The purpose of the trustees' committee as it relates to International Conventions is to work on plans for each forthcoming International Convention. Ultimately the committee acts and makes recommendations in order to affect broad purposes of the General Service Board, as those purposes relate to the strengthening of the Fellowship and the advancement of its message, through well-planned International Conventions.

The objectives of the 2005 International Convention with its theme "I Am Responsible" are: 1) To provide opportunities for a rededication of attendees to the primary purpose of A.A. 2) To enable attendees to witness the success and growth of the A.A. program around the world. 3) To let the world know that A.A. is alive, flourishing and available as a community resource, locally and internationally.

The committee reviewed its procedures and timeframe regarding inviting the proposed local host committee chair, Barry Watson, to attend one of its upcoming meetings. Subsequently, an invitation was extended to Barry to attend the November 2003 committee meeting. Following that meeting, the committee recommended that Barry serve as the local host committee chairperson for the 2005 International Convention. We reviewed the preliminary listing of host committee responsibilities from the 2000 convention based on 15 proposed subcommittees. In addition, the committee reviewed and approved a color change to the 2005 International Convention logo as well as reviewing and approving titles for the 2005 International Convention Program.

The committee forwarded to the Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forms for its consideration an editorial amendment to the General Service Board's 1989 policy on discounts and subsidies to change the use of "i.e." in the policy text to "for example" which more accurately reflects the original intent of the policy.

The General Service Board approved the committee's recommendation that a booklet and CD reflecting the growth of A.A. around the world be produced as souvenir items of the 2005 International Convention. The board also accepted the committee's recommendation that Atlanta, Georgia, be the site of the 2015 Alcoholics Anonymous International Convention.



Regional Forums — Since the 2003 General Service Conference, Regional Forums have been held in the Northeast, East Central, West Central, and Southwest regions of the United States. All were well attended by enthusiastic A.A. members interested in general service. In addition, Special Forums were held in Smithers, British Columbia, Canada and on four islands in Hawaii. Many in attendance were experiencing their first A.A. service event as well as their first Forum. Following is a list of the committee's activities relative to Regional/Special Forums since the 2003 General Service Conference:

The committee reviewed the final report of its subcommittee on Special Forums and noted the following:

1. Regarding Forums as a whole — without designation. It was the sense of the committee that the current designations of "regional" or "special" should remain as is.

- Number of participants at Forums appears to be on the upswing again. Numbers for last three Forums were all up from the last Forum held in each region.

- Forums seem to attract primarily those A.A. members involved in general service. However, Special Forums attract a wider range of the Fellowship.

- Special Forums were originally intended to provide a "Forum experience" to remote areas in any given region (e.g. Hawaii, the Yukon, Labrador).

2. The process for selecting location: The committee agreed that the current process should remain unchanged. For Special Forums: a) One Special Forum per region in any two year period; b) Only two Special Forums to be held in any given year; c) increased number of requests for "specials" are being accommodated within current framework.

3. Staffing and participants at Forums: The committee agreed that the current staffing structure should remain as is. Currently, a total of 10 – 12 members of the various boards and G.S.O. and GV staffs attend Regional Forums, while a reduced compliment of five attend Special Forums.

4. Number of Forums: The committee agreed that the number of Forums to be held annually should remain at six and that the new procedures approved at the December 2002 meeting will be very helpful.

5. Length of Forums: The committee agreed that the current time schedules allotted for Regional Forums should remain as is and that the one and a half day format used for Special Forums should be reviewed on a case by case basis.

6. Content of Forums: The committee agreed that the current format used and information provided at Regional Forums and Special Forums should remain as is. The committee reviewed the 2004 Regional Forums schedule and made no changes.

The committee agreed to a request that the Special Forum in Hawaii be extended by one day and moved to the holiday weekend January 16-19, 2004, in order to include four of the islands. The committee recommended that a Special Forum be held in four cities in Alaska (Area 02) in August 2005. We recommended that a Special Forum be held in Western Ontario (Area 86) in February/March, 2005. We reviewed the Preliminary 2004 Budget and will review a final budget at their January 2004 meeting.

Note: At its January 2004 meeting, the committee reviewed the 2004 Regional Forums Budget and forwarded it to the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The committee reviewed summaries of evaluation questionnaires for the 2003 Northeast, East Central, West Central, and Southwest Regional Forums and suggested that more time be allotted for questions and sharing after the Grapevine Presentation segment at future Forums. The committee agreed that the past trustee talks at Regional Forums should be taped for archival purposes only. This matter was forwarded to the trustees' Committee

on Archives for their information and follow-up.

The following Regional and Special Forums are scheduled prior to the 2005 General Service Conference:

2004		
June 5-6	Special Forum	Goose Bay, Labrador
July 16-18	Pacific	Portland, Oregon
August 27-29	Eastern Canada	Saint-Hyacinthe, Quebec
December 3-5	Southeast	Louisville, Kentucky
2005		
March 12-15	Special	Parry Sound, Ontario, Canada

Phyllis Halliday, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Convention — This International Convention assignment entails coordinating every aspect of the many processes and plans that go to make up the A.A. International Conventions, held every five years. Working with four committees — Trustees, Conference, G.S.O. Planning and Host — the International Convention coordinator is responsible for making sure that the Convention comes together as a wonderful celebration for A.A. members to share gratitude and sobriety.

Plans proceed apace for the 2005 International Convention, which will be held in the wonderful, world-class city of Toronto, Ontario, Canada, June 30 — July 3, 2005. The Convention theme, chosen from suggestions sent in by the Fellowship is "I Am Responsible." The 2005 International Convention will kick-off with a "Party in the Park" and dances across the street from the South Building of the Metro Toronto Convention Center, on the CN Tower Plaza and in other Convention locations. There will be stadium Big Meetings, Workshops, Panels, Regional Meetings, Topic Meetings and Marathons, all of which include about 750 speakers. The traditional flag ceremony of nations in attendance will take place at the Friday night Big Meeting in the SkyDome Stadium, and Saturday night, oldtimers, chosen from the hat, will share about their forty-plus years of experience, strength and hope in Alcoholics Anonymous. The Metro Toronto Convention Center will be the major daytime focus of activity on Friday and Saturday. Toronto A.A.s will serve as members of the local Host Committee. Excitement is plentiful as this 70th Anniversary celebratory event draws nearer.

Doug Richardson

A.A. Regional Forums — The staff member handling Regional Forums is responsible for coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. service workers in a region, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., the Grapevine Corporate Board, and the Grapevine and General Service Office staffs. Regional Forums are organized by the General Service Board and held at the invitation of a particular region every two years; there are four Forums annually. The work gets done with the help of a very able staff assistant.

The location and agenda for a Regional Forum are decided jointly by the regional trustee, area delegates and G.S.O. The responsibility for direct contact with the hotel is assumed by a local A.A. host contact working with the Regional Forums coordinator and regional trustee. The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes invitations and registration forms to groups and service workers throughout the region and, working with the host contact and regional trustee, coordinates the details of the Forum.

The Regional Forums coordinator is also responsible for preparing and distributing an "Early Bird" Newsletter at each Forum and a Final Report of the Forum to all who attend.

A region may request a Special Forum, which has fewer participants from the boards and staff over shorter time periods. Special Forums require the approval of the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums. They may be designed for remote, sparsely populated or urban areas. The Regional Forums coordinator works closely with the regional trustee and host contact tailoring each agenda to local needs.

A combined total of 469 A.A. members attended the Special Forum in Hawaii held on the islands of Kauai, Maui, Oahu, and Hawaii (the Big Island) — January 16-19. The four-day event featured presentations and Ask-It-Basket/Sharing Sessions, in which everyone had an opportunity to make comments and to pose questions, most of which were responded to by the trustees and G.S.O. and GV staff present.

The staff member on A.A. Regional Forums also serves as secretary of the trustees' Nominating Committee, Conference Committee on Trustees and, currently co-secretary of the trustees' and Conference International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

Warren Stafford

LITERATURE

Trustees' report: This report offers a summary of the literature projects of the trustees' Literature Committee since the 2003 General Service Conference.

- *Introduction to the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* — In response to the 2003 General Service Conference Advisory Action, the committee reviewed a draft introduction prepared by the Publications Department to be added to the front matter of the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* and agreed to forward it to the 2004 Conference Literature Committee for consideration.

- *"It Happened to Alice!"* — The committee reviewed the draft manuscript presented by the Publications Department of a new comic book format pamphlet reflecting updated illustrations to replace the pamphlet "It Happened to Alice!" and agreed to forward it to the 2004 Conference Committee on Literature.

- *"The A.A. Group" pamphlet* — Following the 2003 General Service Conference, a memorandum dated May 16, 2003 was sent to all 2003 General Service Conference members from the staff secretary of the trustees' Literature Committee soliciting suggestions for updates or revisions to the pamphlet "The A.A. Group" with a final deadline date of January 1, 2004.

Following its review of the 2003 Advisory Action, a subcommittee was created on August 2, 2003 for the comprehensive review of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet. Since the August trustees' Literature Committee meeting, the subcommittee met nine times to review the 330 suggestions that were submitted from 33 entities (6 members, 12 groups, 3 districts, 1 literature chairperson, 3 area literature committees, 2 area committees, 4 area assemblies, staff and the GV Board) by the January 2004 deadline. The subcommittee expressed appreciation for all of the suggestions received. The subcommittee prepared a progress report that the trustees' Literature Committee reviewed and forwarded to the 2004 Conference Committee on Literature.

- *Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, Alcohólicos Anónimos* — Following its review of the 2003 Advisory Action, a subcommittee was created on August 2, 2003 to develop a report on content, process and story solicitation for the development of a Third Edition of the Spanish-language Big Book. The subcommittee met five times by conference call since the August meeting.

In accordance with the Advisory Action, the Spanish-language Big Book subcommittee prepared the following outline on the development of the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*:

Contents: the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book to be similar in page count to the English Fourth Edition Big Book and the first 164 pages of the Big Book, Dr. Bob's Nightmare, the Preface, the Forewords will undergo a complete review to assure accuracy of translation and consistency of style and tone throughout the text (as in translations of all languages, the Publications Department strives to reflect the best possible translation of Bill W.'s writings and does not require Conference-approval); retain selected stories from current Spanish-language Second Edition; select stories from A.A.'s *La Viña* magazine; select new stories from Spanish-speaking membership; stories to be organized in three main sections similar to the English Fourth Edition Big Book.

Story Solicitation: within the United States and Canada and internationally to Spanish-speaking countries.

Story Selection Process: to be under the direction of the trustees' Literature subcommittee on the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book; Story selection subcommittee to be all bilingual — Spanish and English, include Spanish editors, Spanish-speaking staff members, and the chair to appoint some subcommittee members from the Fellowship. The basic selection criteria: to use the same criteria as the English Fourth Edition Big Book based on Bill W.'s recommendations; each story must, as Bill W. recommended, reach out to the newcomer who is still looking for the A.A. solution; each story must be a standard A.A. story that tells what it was like, what happened, and what it is like today.

The trustees' Literature Committee reviewed and agreed to forward the report to the 2004 Conference Committee on Literature, and that the report be translated by the Publications Department into Spanish in an effort to communicate the progress of this project to the Spanish-speaking community.

- *Recovery Literature for Young People* — In response to suggestions to develop a new comic book format pamphlet "aimed at teenagers" and suggestion to update/replace "Too Young" pamphlet, a subcommittee was formed at the August 2, 2003 meeting to review literature for young people, which included "Too Young?" and "Young People in A.A." The subcommittee met twice by conference call since the August trustees' Literature Committee meeting.

The subcommittee reviewed and discussed the A.A. Conference-approved pamphlet "Too Young?" along with background material and sharing from local young people. Based on the fact that the pamphlet was last updated in 1987, the subcommittee agreed that the pamphlet "Too Young?" is dated and would have greater appeal to young people of today if the pamphlet underwent a complete revision. The subcommittee acknowledged that the pamphlet is often made available at school health fairs and noted that the distribution figures indicate the pamphlet continues to serve a purpose in addressing the basic concept of identification: "Could I be an alcoholic?"

The subcommittee recommended that Publications rewrite the pamphlet "Too Young?" with changes to layout and style as determined by the Publications Department, taking into consideration the following suggestions: update language, idiomatic expressions and references; avoid "talking down" language and tone; add new story lines; add color and new layout; use illustrations depicting some contemporary trends and styles amongst young people (skate-boards, roller-blades, computers, cell phones, DVD/CD players, clothing, hair, tattoos and/or piercings, etc.) and reference to music.

The subcommittee reviewed the pamphlet "Young People and A.A." and agreed that it continues to serve the needs of young people in the Fellowship, but simple changes in style would increase attraction. The subcommittee agreed that the pamphlet appeared extremely text heavy and suggested editorial updates to be determined by Publications. Overall, the subcommittee acknowledged that the existing pamphlet adequately reflected a good cross section of gender and age, however, lacked in stories for young teens. Currently there is no story for under the age of 15, and three stories under the age of 18.

The subcommittee recommended that Publications update and shorten existing stories wherever appropriate in the pamphlet "Young People and A.A.," and that the trustees' Literature Committee consider adding new younger stories solicited from the Fellowship to reflect current experience of young people.

Following the review of all existing A.A. recovery literature for young people, the subcommittee discussed the possibility of the development of comic book format pamphlets for teens. It was noted that there are easy-to-read adult comic book pamphlets, "What Happened to Joe..." and "It Happened to Alice!", both of which are in the process of being made more contemporary. No comic book story pamphlets exist for young newcomers coming into the Fellowship or potential members.

The subcommittee recommended that the trustees' Literature Committee consider developing companion comic books for the new and younger members in the Fellowship, taking into consideration the following suggestions: based on the successful distribution of the "Joe" and "Alice" comic books, create two comic books, one for boys and one for girls; show progression of illness over three or four years so more teens can identify (Example: young person starting to drink at 13 and getting sober at 17); each comic book to follow the formula: what it was like, what happened, and what it is like to be sober in A.A.; emphasize the joys of sobriety showing that a teen can have a fun and fulfilling life without alcohol; show how alcoholism took away some things that a teen enjoyed and how the A.A. way of life brought some back, and more; have a positive "cool" person sponsoring the teen; use names from most current popular name list and names that may be used in a variety of ethnic and/or religious groups; use bright colors, energetic contemporary style and simple language; stories to be written and illustrated by professionals.

The trustees' Literature Committee reviewed the subcommittees' report and agreed to forward the recommendations on recovery literature for young people.

Project Completed:

- "What Happened to Joe..." — Following the 2003 Advisory Action that all text and illustration changes in the revised pamphlet "What Happened to Joe" are to be reviewed by the trustees' Literature Committee prior to publication, the committee reviewed the final draft manuscript with pencil illustrations and updated text for the comic book pamphlet "What Happened to Joe..." presented by the Publications Department. The committee agreed that illustrator attribution will be included in this pamphlet as is the current practice in existing comic book pamphlets.

Projects forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee for consideration:

- Draft introduction developed by the Publications Department to be added to the front matter of the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*.
- Recovery literature for young people:
 - a) Suggestion that Publications rewrite the pamphlet "Too Young?" with changes to layout and style as determined by

the Publications Department.

- b) Suggestion that Publications update and shorten existing stories, wherever appropriate, in the pamphlet "Young People and A.A.," and that the trustees' Literature Committee add new younger stories solicited from the Fellowship to reflect current experience of young people.

- c) Suggestion that the trustees' Literature Committee develop comic books for the new and younger members in the Fellowship.

- Progress report on the comprehensive review of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet.

- Report from the trustees' Literature Committee on the development of the Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, specifying suggestions for contents, process and story solicitation.

The committee extended its gratitude to Chris Cavanaugh, G.S.O.'s Publications Director, and his staff for their professional expertise which is invaluable in completing the work of this committee.

David Every, chairperson

Staff report: As secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees, the literature coordinator works closely with the editor, writers and illustrators on reviewing all new recovery pamphlets, books and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. Along with the Publications Department, the coordinator follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all existing recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications Department. This year there was close collaboration and cooperation with the Publications Department on final preparation for the updated "What Happened to Joe..." comic book pamphlet, the "A.A. and the Armed Services" pamphlet, a suggested draft manuscript for "It Happened to Alice!" and updating text in the pamphlets "Your A.A. General Service Office" and "The A.A. Group."

This was a year of extensive subcommittee activity, meetings, conference calls, deadlines and detailed reports. The literature coordinator served as secretary to the subcommittees reviewing "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, subcommittee reviewing recovery literature for young people and the Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book subcommittee.

The literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups about literature. Many of these inquiries are passed along to our Order Entry Department, our Customer Service representatives, our Publications staff and our Archives staff. Contact is maintained with all current area, district, intergroup/central offices and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and guidelines to assist the chairperson in this vital responsibility. There are currently 62 area literature chairpersons, 346 district literature chairpersons and 183 literature persons serving intergroups and individual A.A. groups. The Literature chair packets have been updated to include current material and are also available for Spanish and French Literature chairs. The literature assistant is invaluable in supporting and helping facilitate the responsibilities of this aspect on the assignment.

The Literature staff member also gathers sharing for *Box 4-5-9*, published in English, French, and Spanish with the following distribution: 53,000 copies in English, 2,500 copies in French and 6,000 copies in Spanish. The staff member works closely with the Publications Department editor and the G.S.O. editorial committee to continue to bring the Fellowship news and notes from G.S.O. in *Box 4-5-9*. The editorial committee welcomes

ideas, suggestions and sharing on service from the Fellowship so that *Box 4-5-9* can be an accurate reflection of both Fellowship and G.S.O. activities.

As literature is essential in helping to carry our message of recovery, this remains a challenging and rewarding assignment.

Eva Sanchez

LONERS/INTERNATIONALISTS, HOMERS (LIM)

Staff report: The Loners/Internationalists Correspondence Service is a valuable method of sharing for about 210 Loners in 57 countries, plus 73 Internationalists, and 185 Homers. Loners are members who are unable to attend A.A. meetings because there are no A.A. groups within a reasonable distance. Internationalists are members working or serving on a seagoing vessel for lengthy periods, and Homers are A.A.s who are house-bound due to illness or physical incapacity. Each is a valuable part of a service coordinated by the General Service Office that enables the member to stay sober by sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters, tapes and/or e-mail, in addition to reading A.A. literature.

The correspondence service also includes 475 Loner Sponsors, who are not "Sponsors" or "Loners" in the traditional sense. Instead, these members share their A.A. group experience and activities with Loners, Homers and Internationalists through correspondence. We also list more than 55 Port Contacts who are valuable resources when Internationalists are briefly onshore. These members also share experience and hope via correspondence.

Complimentary literature is sent to each new member, including the *Loners, Internationalists, & Homers Directory* and a subscription to *Box 4-5-9*. Each LIM member receives the *Loners/Internationalist Meeting-by-Mail (LIM)*, a bimonthly publication composed of excerpts of letters from LIM members to the General Service Office. As with any directory or list distributed by G.S.O., LIM is confidential to insure the anonymity of LIM members.

In 2003, correspondence from around the world demonstrated that A.A. continued to be the basis of sobriety and our way of life. A single issue of LIM may include sharing from Australia, Belgium, Germany, England, India, Ireland, New Zealand, Peoples Republic of China, Slovenia, Taiwan, one or more countries in Africa, as well as Canada and the U.S. The letters are inspiring in their simplicity and straightforward sharing.

It is a joy to be on the LIM assignment, to benefit by the sharing of members who encounter and walk through difficult circumstances each day. The courage of these Loners, Homers and Internationalists is an inspiration that I hope to pass on.

Irene Kontje

NOMINATING

Trustees' report: Since the 2003 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Nominating has met three times. At each meeting, the committee's work was guided by the principles of love, responsibility, and mutual respect.

- The committee reviewed its Composition, Scope and Procedures and added a section to the Composition section whereby the chairperson of The General Service Board determines the balance of members of the committee and may amend the number of voting members from time to time, as indicated by the needs of the committee. The committee also made changes to several of its procedures to more closely reflect actual practice.
- A search for two Class A trustees was made and seven "friends of A.A." were interviewed. The committee unanimously recom-

mended to The General Service Board that William D. Clark, M.D., and the Very Rev. Ward B. Ewing, D.D., be invited to serve as Class A trustees, replacing George E. Vaillant, M.D., and to fill the existing vacancy, following the 2004 General Service Conference.

- The committee reviewed and approved the request from the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities for two appointed committee members to serve beginning in July 2004.

The committee recommended to The General Service Board the following nominations: A.A. World Services Corporate Board — Gary Kluksdahl, Southwest regional trustee, replacing Dorothy J. May; The A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board — Michael D. Perry, Northeast regional trustee, replacing Richard F. Gallagher; and Dorothy L. Hurley, as a director, replacing Susan Campbell.

The proposed slates of General Service Board members, officers of the board, and A.A. World Services and Grapevine directors were forwarded to the 2004 Conference Committee on Trustees for disapproval, if any. The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees to the annual meeting of the members of The General Service Board in April, following presentation at the 2004 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Trustees of the General Service Board:

Class A

Allen L. Ault, Ed.D.	Herbert I. Goodman
Leonard M. Blumenthal, L.L.D.	Vincent E. Keefe
William D. Clark, M.D.	Elaine McDowell, Ph.D.
Ward B. Ewing, D.D.	

Class B

Charles Barta	John C. Koster
Charles F. Bartell	Tom Kraemer
David V. Every	Murray McIntosh
Richard F. (Dick) Gallagher	Dorothy J. May
Ronald J. Gauthier	Robert Pelot
Phyllis A. Halliday	Michael D. Perry
Gary Kluksdahl	Arnold L. Ross

Officers of General Service Board:

<i>Chairperson</i>	Elaine McDowell, Ph.D.
<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D.
<i>Second vice-chairperson</i>	Allen L. Ault, Ed.D.
<i>Treasurer</i>	Vincent E. Keefe
<i>Secretary</i>	John C. Koster
<i>Assistant Treasurer</i>	Donald W. Meurer
<i>Assistant Secretary</i>	Valerie O'Neill

Directors of A.A. World Services Corporate Board:

Paul Cleary	Greg Muth
Ronald J. Gauthier	Valerie O'Neill
Gary Kluksdahl	Robert Pelot
John C. Koster	Jane Sheppard
Don Miller	

Directors of A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board:

Leonard M. Blumenthal	Raymond Massey
Robin Bromley	Michael D. Perry
David V. Every	Arnold L. Ross
Phyllis A. Halliday	John Skilton
Dorothy L. Hurley	

Ted Stoa, chairperson

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' report: The trustees' Public Information Committee is charged with the responsibility of helping the membership to carry the message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers. We do this by recommending and coordinating activities which include: creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing television and radio public service announcements; producing films about A.A.; preparing press releases and reports to the public; coordinating health fairs and other community exhibits with local P.I. committees; conducting the triennial A.A. Membership Survey; and carrying A.A.'s message through electronic as well as print media. The committee met three times since the last Conference. Projects over the past year have included:

Television and Radio P.S.A.s — The P.S.A. approved by the 2003 General Service Conference, "We Know What It's Like," was distributed to over 800 networks and stations around Canada and the U.S. in English, French and Spanish. The committee viewed with appreciation the tracking information on this P.S.A. as it became available, and also expressed ongoing concern that the centralized distribution serve merely as an adjunct to the valuable Twelve Step service done by P.I. committees who have personal contact with television stations in their areas.

In response to the recommendation from the 2003 General Service Conference, the committee oversaw the production of a new television P.S.A., "Living in Chaos," which was forwarded to the 2004 Conference P.I. Committee.

A thorough review of radio P.S.A.s was completed and the committee agreed that the current P.S.A.s did not require updating in terms of content. They asked that the cassette format for radio P.S.A.s be discontinued as an inventory item, since CDs were the current format of choice of most radio stations. The committee agreed to forward to the 2004 Conference Committee on Public Information the suggestion that the tag line on all radio P.S.A.s be changed from "Look us up in the phone book" or "Phone or check your newspaper," to the tag line currently in use in the television P.S.A.s, "Look us up. We're in the phone book and on the web at www.aa.org." This update would incur no additional expense to the Fellowship. An enclosure was developed to be sent out with each CD, informing recipients of the option, where available, of having local radio stations add contact information for local intergroups, central offices, or answering services.

Communications with the Media — The use of "Alcoholics Anonymous" in the return address of future mailings to media professionals was approved. The committee acknowledged the need to clearly identify the source when mailing the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media, press releases, and P.S.A.s to increase the chances that the items will be opened.

The committee reviewed and accepted the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media, which is mailed in February 2004. They chose a graphic to be included on the memo to make it more attractive to those who receive it and increase the probability it will be read.

Membership Survey — The committee reviewed the report of the 2003 Conference Committee on Public Information, including the draft of the 2004 Membership Survey questionnaire with the addition of "Skilled Trade" to Question 12: "What is the nature of your employment status now?" The committee forwarded to the 2004 Conference Committee on Public Information the recommendation that the 2004 Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis as was done in the 2001 Membership Survey.

Kits and Workbooks — The guide letters from the Public Information Workbook were made available for transmission to A.A. members in electronic format upon request. Notice of elec-

tronic availability of the guide letters was added to the Public Information Workbook.

Videos about A.A. — The committee forwarded to the 2004 Conference Committee on Public Information a proposal that the videos "Young People and A.A." and "A.A. — Rap With Us" be reviewed as to relevance for today's young people.

Alcoholics Anonymous Toll Free Office Locator Service — In an ongoing attempt to find an economically feasible way to have responses to the television P.S.A.s routed to local central offices, intergroups and answering services, the committee were very pleased with the latest possibility presented, and they look forward to continuing to explore the proposal with additional information regarding prices to include Canadian rates as well as other pricing options.

The committee remains committed to do all they can to assist the membership in their service of carrying the message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers, and welcomes suggestions from delegate areas as to what more can be done.

Robert Pelot, chairperson

Staff report: The purpose of the Public Information assignment is to assist the A.A. members who carry our message to the suffering alcoholic through the public — schools, businesses, health fairs, libraries, and others, including the media. The assignment provides accurate and consistent information to the media, researchers, students and the general public about Alcoholics Anonymous. Throughout the year the staff member and a staff assistant respond to hundreds of written and telephone inquiries that come in from the general public and the Fellowship. The staff member is also responsible for handling interviews or for arranging Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee interviews with the media describing what A.A. is, and what it can and cannot do.

The staff member communicates with over 700 P.I. Committee chairpersons at the area, district, and intergroup/central office or group level. All new Public Information chairpersons are sent a "welcome" letter and receive material, including the P.I. Workbook, A.A. Guidelines on Public Information, and a subscription to *Box 4-5-9*, which includes articles focused on P.I. Through activity updates sent two to three times a year, this assignment can serve as a resource for sharing from the P.I. committees throughout the U.S. and Canada.

During the past year, literature was provided for 19 local health and community fairs. Whenever possible, we try to connect the community resource with a local P.I. committee, so that there can be a local group conscience decision about how A.A. can best participate in these events. In many cases, local Public Information committees provide literature and participate. Using the P.I. Discount Package Order Form, they are able to purchase quantities of pamphlets at reduced prices. The results of the A.A. Membership Survey are useful at such events, and are available as an attractive tabletop display as well as in a pamphlet format.

The Public Information desk reads and processes a number of newspaper, magazine and Internet feature stories that mention Alcoholics Anonymous, and receives information from members regarding anonymity breaks at the level of press, radio, film or on the Internet. If there is a break at the public level, and the area can be identified, the area delegate is contacted with a request to reach out to the member. We generally do not contact media professionals regarding anonymity breaks when they are reporting on information given to them by an A.A. member. It is the responsibility of the individual A.A. member and not the media professional to observe our Tradition of anonymity. However, we do write to express gratitude to publications which present accu-

rate information about A.A. and maintain members' anonymity.

In 2003, the General Service Conference approved a new television public service announcement — "We Know What It's Like" — that was centrally distributed in English, French and Spanish, and also made available for committees to provide to stations. The staff member provided P.I. committees with information regarding this process in order to enhance their efforts on the local level and referred media requests for this P.S.A. to local committees. One of the more exciting moments was when the P.S.A. was chosen to be shown on the NBC/Panasonic Astrovision screen in Times Square, New York City, twice every hour during the month of September. The P.S.A. was also seen during many prime time slots on network and cable channels throughout 2003, giving us many opportunities to share with members the history of P.S.A.s in A.A., and how they are "attraction and not promotion."

The annual Anonymity Memo to Media was mailed in February to more than 9,500 media outlets in the U.S. and Canada. This included daily and weekly newspapers, wire services, radio stations, and TV networks, stations and cable services. The distribution included French and English outlets in Canada and the black and Hispanic media in the U.S.

We responded to numerous other requests from media professionals for information about Alcoholics Anonymous or information on subjects related to alcoholism. We referred inquiries not directly related to A.A. to an appropriate source. When requested, we also reviewed movie, television and radio scripts to see that references to A.A. were accurate and in keeping with our Traditions. We declined to comment on controversial issues in keeping with our Tenth Tradition of not entering into public controversy. In this instance, Alcoholics Anonymous is unique in that Public Information succeeds when we do not get media attention.

The success of any Public Information work at G.S.O. is measured in the same way as any other A.A. service: Are we doing all that we can to see that the A.A. message of recovery reaches the still-suffering alcoholic by informing the general public about the A.A. program?

Gayle Solheim Riese

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services to A.A. groups are the heartbeat of the General Service Office. Eleven A.A. members comprise the "G.S.O. Staff" with each person responsible for a functional assignment in addition to responding to requests from a specific region in Canada and the U.S., or from other countries. In 2003, the staff received 34,727 such requests by mail, fax, plus many phone calls daily. The staff coordinator helps to assure that letters are answered when staff members are involved in large projects, away from the office to attend large A.A. events, or at times of illness or vacation. All mail, e-mail, faxes, etc. are responded to in ten business days.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff trips to area assemblies, conventions, Regional Forums, and other large A.A. events, making sure that the office is adequately covered at all times. To further assure that the work flow is smooth and adequately covered, assignments are divided into two units. Unit A consists of Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, International Convention, Literature, Public Information and Treatment Facilities. Unit B includes Conference, Regional Forums, Group Services, International, and staff coordinator.

G.S.O. staff has the benefit of the experience of A.A. groups gathered over many years, resources that are passed on to members who seek guidance for their group, central office, district or area assembly. Requests for guidance received from the

Fellowship are often brought to weekly staff meetings, so that all responses reflect either research from A.A. literature or service material or the collective experience of G.S.O. staff and archives. Our weekly meetings also provide a forum for sharing ideas on ways to further improve services to A.A. groups and members. The staff coordinator chairs these weekly meetings and prepares a report on this weekly staff sharing session which is distributed to heads of various G.S.O. departments for their information.

Mary Clare Lynch joined the staff in September 2003 and had the opportunity to observe the 2003 General Service Conference before rotating on to the Correctional Facilities assignment in July. Mary Clare was one of over 200 members who applied for the staff position being vacated by Joanie Moncrief. Criteria for applicants who want to be considered for an opening in the G.S.O. staff are: a minimum of six years sobriety, professional background, excellent verbal and writing communication skills and A.A. service experience. The staff coordinator is involved with training new staff members.

In October 2003, Irene Kontje joined our staff and plunged into the Treatment Facilities assignment and *Loners/Internationalists Meeting-by-Mail (LIM)*, a bimonthly sharing) for and by A.A. members (Loners, Homers and Internationalists) who do not have access to A.A. meetings.

G.S.O. staff members serve as secretaries to trustees' and Conference Committees and also are voting members of the General Service Conference. The staff coordinator is secretary to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

In 2003, G.S.O. welcomed a total of 1,600 individual and 15 English and Spanish-speaking groups ranging in size from 10 to 50. Each visitor had an opportunity to see and hear "how G.S.O. works" during a tour of G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. Often visiting members and guests attend the "open" A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays. This is an opportunity for the G.S.O. staff to welcome A.A. members from all over the world or from around the corner. A recent visitor was the A.A. member who was the first person to carry the A.A. message to Croatia.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance material, preparing the minutes of board meetings and gathering information on board activities that appears in the Quarterly Report. The staff coordinator has the privilege of serving as a director of A.A. World Services, Inc. in accordance with Concept IV, and also serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments. None of these activities would be possible without the assistance of a very capable support staff.

Valerie O'Neill



Literature Distributed — 2003

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous (4th Ed)	518,757
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover-4th Ed)	352,253
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print-4th Ed)	30,089
Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)	113,506
Daily Reflections	153,388
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. ed.)	181,272
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift ed.)	13,754
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)	156,004
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	16,978
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (pocket ed.)	59,203
A.A. Comes of Age	11,879
As Bill Sees It	45,819
As Bill Sees It (soft cover)	27,597
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	11,982
"Pass It On"	11,979
Experience, Strength & Hope	64,501
Total	1,768,961

Booklets

The A.A. Service Manual/	
Twelve Concepts for World Service	32,971
Living Sober	158,317
Came to Believe	74,991
A.A. in Prisons: Inmate to Inmate	24,128
Total	290,407

Pamphlets

A.A. and the Armed Services	11,194
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	28,689
A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional	35,967
A.A. for the Native North American	19,819
A.A. for the Woman	112,680
The A.A. Group	93,097
A.A. in Your Community	47,881
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	25,402
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	25,942
The A.A. Membership Survey	37,499
The A.A. Member – Medications and Other Drugs	107,155
A.A. Tradition – How It Developed	34,067
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	15,260
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	114,592
Circles of Love and Service	47,875
Bridging the Gap	27,447
Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.	23,032
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	16,811
Do You Think You're Different?	122,191
44 Questions	245,935
G.S.R.	44,445
Grapevine – Our Meeting in Print	20,816
How A.A. Members Cooperate	17,751
How It Works	71,931
If You Are a Professional	38,223
Inside A.A.	48,573
Can A.A. Help Me Too?	39,740
Is A.A. for You?	338,871

Is A.A. for Me?	100,574
Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?	23,237
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	81,019
It Happened to Alice	49,804
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	50,538
The Jack Alexander Article	25,959
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	13,725
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	73,511
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	54,206
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	34,550
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	13,203
A Newcomer Asks	311,243
Problems Other Than Alcohol	121,694
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	274,494
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	17,411
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	32,846
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	78,419
Twelve Tradition Flyer	8,358
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	48,157
This Is A.A.	255,973
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	19,597
AA for the Older Alcoholic (Lrg Print)	65,486
Too Young?	72,617
Understanding Anonymity	64,675
What Happened to Joe	53,875
Young People and A.A.	116,700
Total	3,874,756

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards-two-fold	334,500
Wallet cards-I Am Responsible	49,360
Wallet cards-Anonymity	36,584
Anonymity Display Card	3,508
Parchment-scrolls	2,871
Placards	565
C.P.C. Workbook	1,556
Archives Workbook	681
Correctional Facilities Workbook	1,357
P.I. Workbook	1,961
Treatment Facilities Workbook	1,509
Treatment Facility Kit	390
Big Book on computer disk	285
Twelve and Twelve on Computer Disk	183
A.A. Guidelines	73,451
Group Handbook	2,220
Wire Racks	2,116
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	1111
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	3,429
Alcoholics Anonymous (4th Ed cassette album)	262
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	325
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	1,638
TV Public Service Announcement	242
Radio Public Service Announcements	367
Twelve Steps Shade displays	1,795
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	1,683
Fact File	2,484
Table Top Display 12 & 12	493
Pioneers of AA (Cassette Album)	86
Living Sober (Cassette Album)	296
Total	527,308
Grand Total	6,461,432

SPANISH

Libros y Librillos (Book & Booklets)

Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous soft cover)	25,258
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)	9,392
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)	12,099
Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	5,460
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	3,819
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	3,878
Transmitelo (Pass it On)	4,344
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)	9,805
Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	14,963
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./ Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	6,447
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	26,010
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	8,419
A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	7,788
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (pocket ed.)	8,220
Total	145,902

Folletos (Pamphlets)

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	8,680
44 Preguntas (44 Questions)	31,379
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	27,913
Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	68,575
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	7,781
Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	7,883
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	6,230
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	4,104
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	2,011
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	3,638
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	16,480
Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)	10,641
Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)	9,163
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	4,870
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	8,945
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	13,409
El Miembro de A.A. – Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas (The A.A. Member – Medications and Other Drugs)	6,160
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	5,709
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	3,054
Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	13,536
La Tradición de A.A. – ¿Cómo se Desarrolló? (A.A. Tradition – How It Developed)	2,633
Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	10,004

A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	3,782
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	10,005
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	9,674
¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.? (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	1,559
Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	6,683
A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	2,000
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A. (The Clergy Asks)	1,787
R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	4,604
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think Your Different?)	10,490
Le Sucedió a Alicia (It Happened to Alice)	5,934
Hablando en Reuniones no-A.A. Speaking at non-A.A. Meetings	1,600
A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	10,513
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	1,443
¿Hay un alcohólico en el lugar de trabajo? (Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)	2,702
Es A.A. Para Mi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	14,033
A.A. para el alcohólico de edad avanzada (A.A. for the older alcoholic)	4,497
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated)	8,524
Círculos de Amor y Servicio (Circles of Love & Service)	3,381
Uniendo las Orillas (Bridging the Gap)	1,978
Los Doce Conceptos Ilustrados (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	2,365
A.A. para los alcohólicos gays/lesbianas (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	1,448
Total	381,800

Diversos (Miscellaneous)

Guías (Guidelines)	5,896
Parchments, Spanish	621
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)	16,560
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album) (Big Book on cassette)	779
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album) (Twelve Steps on cassette)	881
Total	24,737
Grand Total	552,439

FRENCH

Livres (Books)

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous – format relie)	12,332
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous – format souple)	1,988
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous – format poche)	821
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve – format relie)	1,785
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions	

(Twelve & Twelve – format souple)	1,522
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions	
(Twelve & Twelve – format poche)	942
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte	
(A.A. Comes of Age)	557
Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	2,512
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	4,700
Dr Bob et les pionniers	
(Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	693
Total	27,852

Plaquettes (Booklets)

Nous en sommes venus a croire (Came to Believe)	1,789
Vivre... sans alcool! (Living Sober)	2,710
Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	1,544
Total	6,043

Brochures (Pamphlets)

Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	9,450
Les A.A.: 44 Questions (44 Questions)	4,107
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	13,621
Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	2,918
Collaboration des membres des A.A.	
(How A.A. Members Cooperate)	575
Y a-t-il un Alcoolique dans Votre Milieu de travail?	
(Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)	1,176
Le membre des A.A. face aux médicaments et a la drogue	
(The A.A. Member – Medications & Other Drugs)	2,415
Les A.A. – Article du Saturday Evening Post	
(The Jack Alexander Article)	384
Collaborons avec nos amis	
(Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	765
Questions et reponses sur le parrainage	
(Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	3,242
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les medecins	
(A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	1,223
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement	
(A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	814
La Tradition des A.A. et son developpement	
(A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	677
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme?	
(If You Are a Professional)	1140
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	1110
Jean face a son probleme d'alcool	
(What Happened to Joe)	1150
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	1,405
Problemes autres que l'alcoolisme	
(Problems Other Than Alcohol)	2,980
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A.	
(A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	1,139
Les Douze Traditions illustrees	
(The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,902
Les A.A. dans les etablissements correctionnels	
(A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	800
Ca vaut mieux que de languir en prison	
(It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	1,037
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A.	
(A Brief Guide to A.A.)	1,935
Les membres du clerge se renseignent	
(Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)	443
Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)	987

Message a l'intention d'un detenu	
(Memo to an Inmate)	882
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels	
(Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	192
Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	3,205
Les Douze Concepts illustres	
(Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	2,483
Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	2,371
Trois causeries a des societes medicales	
(Three Talks to Medical Societies)	807
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie?	
(Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	2,173
Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	1,920
Causeries a l'exterieur des A.A.	
(Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	1,022
Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	2,244
La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	1,832
L'Heritage des Services des A.A.	
(A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	526
Cercles d'amour et de service	
(Circles of Love & Service)	1,693
Vous croyez-vous different?	
(Do You Think You're Different?)	2,576
Lettre a une femme alcoolique	
(Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	1,260
Sondage sur les membres des A.A.	
(The A.A. Membership Survey)	1,444
Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)	2,513
Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	1,718
AA pour l'alcoolique plus age	
(AA for the older alcoholic)	1,597
Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	5,175
Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	1,523
Favoriser de rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)	794
Les Douze Etapes Illustrees (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	3,235
Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques	
(A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	925
Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amerique du Nord	
(A.A. and the Native North American)	538
Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	2,918
Total	104,961

Divers (Miscellaneous)

12 & 12 (cassette album)	77
Le Gros Livre (cassettes album)	84
Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions	
(Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions)	2,501
Carte anonymat (Francais/anglais)	
(Anonymity wallet card)	500
Video Cassettes	33
Notre Methode (How It Works)	7,280
Manuel de Groupe	50
Pochette de l'Information Publique	57
Pochette des Centres de Detention	3
Pochette de la CMP	6
Prière de la Sérénité (12x16)	
(Parchment Serenity Prayer)	113
Pochette des Centres de Traitement	18
Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (Fact File)	142
Total	10,864
Grand Total	149,720

Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. is the arm of the General Service Board that publishes and distributes the Grapevine magazine, the international journal of Alcoholics Anonymous, and collections of Grapevine articles in books, CDs, and other formats. The A.A. Grapevine is also responsible for the publication of *La Viña*, the Spanish-language journal of Alcoholics Anonymous, and for Spanish-language translations of A.A. Grapevine publications.

The A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board met eleven times since the 53rd General Service Conference. It held four formal quarterly meetings — three during General Service Board weekends and a fourth during the General Service Conference week. Four planning committee meetings, of a more informal nature than the quarterly meetings, were held to consider both financial and policy matters of importance to the corporation. These meetings were supplemented by three special board meetings and several conference calls, convened to discuss corporate business that needed immediate attention.

Board Structure — There are nine Grapevine corporate directors: five trustees, including two general service trustees, two regional trustees, and one Class A (nonalcoholic); three non-trustee directors; and the executive editor. This year the board elected Dorothy L. Hurley as a nontrustee director to fill the position vacated by Susan Campbell, who is rotating from the board in April after four years of service. The board also forwarded the name of general service trustee David Every to succeed Southeast regional trustee Richard Gallagher as chair of the Grapevine Corporate Board following the 2004 Conference. Northeast regional trustee Michael Perry will fill the vacancy left when Richard Gallagher rotates in April.

This year, the board chairperson, Richard Gallagher, appointed several ad hoc committees to facilitate the board's oversight of the Grapevine Corporation. The customer service committee, chaired by Ray Massey, nontrustee director, addressed the issues of fulfillment and distribution, evaluated current vendors, and continued to monitor customer relations. The *La Viña* committee, chaired by Susan Campbell, nontrustee director, discussed the publication and distribution of the Spanish-language magazine. Chaired by David Every, general service trustee, the digital archiving and accessibility project committee (DAAP) tracked the progress of this important project, which will give the Fellowship access to sixty years of historic Grapevine articles. This committee also discussed a fee structure for archive subscriptions and the name of the project — now known as the A.A. Grapevine Digital Archive. Richard Gallagher chaired the risk management committee, which focused on questions of copyright and the conversion to a new financial software system. Nontrustee director John Skilton chaired the pamphlet committee overseeing suggested revisions to three pamphlets: "Your General Service Office," "The A.A. Group," and "The A.A. Grapevine." Phyllis Halliday, Pacific regional trustee, chaired the 1993 Advisory Action and Grapevine Non-A.A. Sales Committee, charged with reviewing the history of the Advisory Action on the resale of Grapevine materials in non-A.A. outlets and reporting its findings to the Conference. The finance committee, chaired by general service trustee Arnold Ross, supervised the budgeting process and tracked the corporation's finances, in concert with the treasurer and the executive editor.

The Grapevine Office — There have been several changes at the A.A. Grapevine office. In August, the position of controller was filled by Eugene O'Brien. As head of the financial department, Eugene worked with the executive editor and treasurer of the board to develop the Grapevine and *La Viña's* annual budgets and

to prepare quarterly financial reports for each. He also oversaw bookkeeping and accounts payable. The board in its long-range planning decided it would be in the best interest of the A.A. Grapevine to begin a search for a new executive editor. The search committee solicited resumes of qualified applicants for the position, and, after interviews, Robin Bromley was named the new executive editor effective April 1, 2004, by unanimous vote of the board.

In January 2004, J. Desmond Towey was appointed an advisor to the board. By mutual agreement, Desmond left the A.A. Grapevine effective March 31, 2004, to pursue outside interests. Eugene O'Brien, controller, very ably assumed management responsibilities until the new executive editor was named. The entire staff is to be commended for the professional manner in which they pulled together and continued to maintain the high quality of the magazine and related items during this transition. Personnel in the editorial and distribution services departments remain unchanged, although there was some reorganization to increase efficiency. The executive editor assumed responsibility for the distribution services department, assisted by the office manager who supervised four customer service reps, two of whom are bilingual; a bilingual GvR/RLV coordinator; and shipping. In the editorial department, Charles McGovern, the managing editor, was given oversight of *La Viña*, the A.A. Grapevine, and the Web site, www.aagrapevine.org. Working together, the staff produced and distributed a record number of publications this year, helping The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., fulfill the tradition of self-support.

2003 Financial Results — The Grapevine had a profit of \$5,366 for the year ended December 31, 2003, versus a budget of \$4,358. Average monthly circulation of the magazine was 112,614 for the year, versus a budgeted circulation of 115,000. The gross subscription income for the magazine was \$1,691,467, and the gross profit on the magazine was \$1,156,152. This was slightly below budget of \$1,179,560. Other publishing income, from the sales of books, tapes, CDs, as well as Grapevine wall calendars and pocket planners, was \$604,331, slightly below budget. The gross profit for this category was \$418,510. This was ahead of budget by \$32,080 and significantly ahead of 2002 as well. Total gross profit, including cash flow and interest from the Reserve Fund of \$56,850, was \$1,631,514. Total Grapevine expenses were \$1,626,148. This resulted in a net profit of \$5,366, which is \$1,008 better than budgeted. This can be attributed to a reduction in selling expenses from budgeted levels. For *La Viña*, the average circulation of the six bimonthly issues was 9,222; the budgeted amount was 9,500. Overall results show a net loss of \$111,638, better than the budgeted loss of \$125,809. This is due to effective containment of editorial expenses and circulation/business expenses.

A.A. Grapevine Editorial — In addition to sharing the experience, strength, and recovery of alcoholics around the world, the Grapevine magazine focused on a number of topics important to the Fellowship this year, including A.A. literature, emotional sobriety, alcoholism in the family, and A.A.'s singleness of purpose. Responding to numerous requests for staple-less magazines that can be taken into prisons, the staff created a thread-sewn edition of the July issue. With its stories of A.A.s staying sober through those first vulnerable months of release, the thread-bound edition proved very useful to inmates and was reprinted and distributed with A.A.W.S.'s prerelease packets. With the support of its Editorial Advisory Board, the Grapevine also published two new soft-cover books: *Thank You for Sharing: Sixty Years of Letters to the A.A. Grapevine* and *Spiritual Awakenings: Journeys of the Spirit from the Pages of the A.A. Grapevine*, which reflect the rich range

of experience that can be found in the Fellowship. A newly redesigned Web site was launched this March. While preserving popular features such as i-Say and Rule #62, the revised site contains more humor, more stories, a larger section on La Viña, more links to A.A.W.S., and a new name — A.A. Grapevine Online! Guided by the board's committee, the Grapevine also has been working on an exciting new project — the A.A. Grapevine Digital Archive, which will give the Fellowship online access to all the articles, letters, cartoons, and jokes published in the A.A. Grapevine between 1944 and 2003. Scheduled to be launched on the Grapevine Web site this June, the archive offers about 12,000 items (including the original version of the Traditions and Bill's pitch for the first General Service Conference), which readers can find by subject, name, department, location, or date, or by scrolling through the archive. A special issue celebrating the 60th anniversary of the Grapevine magazine and an anniversary poster featuring Victor E. are scheduled for publication in June.

La Viña — Under the direction of editor Hernán Merea and with the support of the General Service Board, La Viña has continued to flourish. With original articles from Spanish-speaking members and its own distinct design, La Viña has become a genuine mirror of the Spanish-speaking Fellowship, reflecting the cultural and geographic diversity of the population and carrying the A.A. message in Spanish to alcoholics in need. At the same time, it retains strong ties to the English-speaking Fellowship and to the A.A. Grapevine magazine, thanks to the collaboration among editors and the exchange of stories and ideas. Responding to a request for audio versions of the magazine, the editor has had several stories recorded for a new CD, which will be available this spring. A new translation of The Traditions Checklist was issued this winter, and a translation of *The Best of Bill* is in production.

Distribution and Customer Service — Working in concert with the board's customer service subcommittee, management has been carefully reviewing the services provided by the Grapevine's current fulfillment house and is considering undertaking a search for other vendors. It has accelerated its response to undeliverable subscriptions and taken several steps to improve customer service, including reorganizing voice mail and response systems and improving bilingual messaging.

The Grapevine has begun to reenergize the GvR/RLV network and to reestablish its relationship with central offices and intergroups by restoring monthly communication and offering updated service material. This includes the creating of a special section for Grapevine/La Viña reps on the Web site, where they can get information and share ideas, and the publication of "The Interim GvR Workbook" (an update of the 1993 workbook), while a revised workbook goes to the Conference for review. Working in conjunction with the board and the executive editor, the editor of La Viña has done much to increase the Fellowship's awareness of the magazine this year. Participation in Regional Forums and other service events in both North and South America, has strengthened the RLV (La Viña representatives) network, explored ways to develop communication with Hispanic central offices, and updated all La Viña service material. Circulation for 2003-2004 exceeds 9,000.

Mission Statement — The purpose of the Grapevine Corporate Board, an affiliate service corporation of the General Service Board, is to serve the A.A. Fellowship in the following ways:

- To oversee the publishing operations of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc.
- To provide sound financial management of the corporation.
- To establish corporate policies and set corporate priorities.
- To engage in the ongoing process of strategic planning.

- To operate in accordance with the principles of A.A. as expressed in the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions and the Twelve Concepts.

This mission statement was adopted by the corporate board on October 27, 2000, and amended on January 26, 2001.

Richard Gallagher, chairperson

Staff report: This has been a productive year for The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. The staff has continued to update the content and design of its primary publications, the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña, with the goal of attracting newcomers to the international journals of Alcoholics Anonymous and encouraging others to use them to carry the A.A. message. In addition, the staff made Grapevine articles available in a variety of new formats, worked to improve services to subscribers, and began to strengthen communication with Grapevine and La Viña representatives.

With the help of the Editorial Advisory Board, which met five times this year, the Grapevine published two books this summer — *Thank You for Sharing: Sixty Years of Letters to the AA Grapevine* and *Spiritual Awakenings: Journeys of the Spirit from the Pages of the AA Grapevine*. Selected from articles published in the Grapevine over the years, each reflects a wide range of A.A. experience. This winter, the Grapevine redesigned its Web site. Now known as AA Grapevine Online! it offers more stories, more humor, and more information about the Grapevine, La Viña, and Alcoholics Anonymous. This June, it will also become the gateway to the AA Grapevine Digital Archive, a collection of more than 12,000 Grapevine letters, cartoons, and articles covering the growth of A.A. from 1944 to 2002. With historic documents such as the proposal for a General Service Conference, early essays on the Traditions, and reports on each International Convention, along with sixty years of sharing on recovery and the principles of the program, it is hoped the Grapevine archive will be a valuable tool of recovery as well as a resource to the Fellowship and those interested in A.A. history.

The Fellowship's Spanish-language bimonthly, La Viña, has undergone considerable growth as well. Now reaching 9,000 subscribers, it is a vital tool for A.A. unity, recovery, and service. With its distinct design and articles written by A.A.s from diverse backgrounds, La Viña reflects the varied viewpoints of the current Spanish-speaking Fellowship, at the same time it maintains close ties with the A.A. Grapevine and English-speaking A.A.s. To further support the Spanish-speaking community, La Viña stories are now available on the A.A. Grapevine Web site and the publication of a Spanish translation of *The Best of Bill* and production of an audio CD of La Viña stories are underway.

Intent on improving customer service, the Grapevine is carefully reviewing current fulfillment and distribution systems and has initiated new procedures to respond to customer queries, including the installation of a new voice mail system and new procedures that are more responsive to both English- and Spanish-language callers. In addition, the office has taken several steps to strengthen its relationship with intergroups and Grapevine and La Viña representatives, with monthly mailings to area chairs and central offices/intergroups, GvR workshops at Regional Forums, the zip code project tracking circulation, and the update of the GvR/RLV database. In addition, a revised workbook has been sent to the Grapevine Conference Committee for consideration and the special section for GvRs/RLVs on the Web site has been expanded to include the AA Grapevine Workbook and a bulletin board, where registered reps can share ideas on letting the Fellowship and suffering alcoholics know about the experience, strength, and hope available in A.A.'s meetings in print.

Robin Bromley, executive editor

AA Grapevine Literature Distributed — 2003

ENGLISH

Books Units

Best of Bill	194
Best of Bill (Gift edition - hardcover)	6,818
Best of Bill (Gift edition - softcover)	9,719
Best of the Grapevine I (softcover)	2,517
Best of the Grapevine II (softcover)	1,993
Best of the Grapevine III (softcover)	2,219
The Language of the Heart	8,949
The Language of the Heart (softcover)	3,396
The Language of the Heart/Big Book Set	347
The Home Group	4,672
A.A. Around The World	2,191
Thank You for Sharing	5,763
Spiritual Awakening	4,457
Total:	53,235

Cassettes Tapes

Attitudes	476
Character Defects	476
Classic Tapes #1	232
Classic Tapes #2	218
Classic Tapes #3	196
Maintaining Spirituality	740
Pathways to Spirituality	452
Not for Newcomers Only, Vol. 1	136
Not for Newcomers Only, Vol. 2	141
Our Experience Has Taught Us	179
Practice These Principles	322
Back to Basics, Vol.1	314
Back to Basics, Vol.2	270
Sponsorship, Vol.1	371
Sponsorship, Vol.2	208
History Lights the Way	201
What We Were Like	303
Youth Enjoying Sobriety	215
Old-Timers Corner	236
Total:	52,246

CDs

Pathways to Spirituality	1,125
Classic Grapevine, Vol. 1	660
Classic Grapevine, Vol. 2	561
Classic Grapevine, Vol. 3	571
Not for Newcomers Only	783
Partners on the Journey	820
Total:	4,520

Miscellaneous

AA Preamble	1,617
Co-founder's Memorial Issue	41
Facsimile of first Grapevine	1,106
Grapevine Binder	653
Man on the Bed	2,175
Serenity Prayer	3,620
Slogans	1,640
Traditions Checklist	489
Wall Calendar	13,699
Pocket Planner	14,027
Total:	42,623

SPANISH

El Lenguaje del Corazon (Language of the Heart)	3,807
Preámbulo (Preamble)	402
Lemas (Slogans)	352
La Oración de la Serenidad (Serenity Prayer)	1,390
Sonidos de Sobriedad (Sounds of Sobriety)	7
Tradiciones (Traditions)	145
Total:	6,103

FRENCH

Les Sons de la Sobriété (Sounds of Sobriety)	69
Total:	69
Grand Total:	158,796

GRAPEVINE SUBSCRIPTIONS* — GEOGRAPHICAL BREAKDOWN

	APRIL 2004	APRIL 2003	INCREASE/ DECREASE
UNITED STATES*			
Alabama	1,017	1,070	— 53
Alaska	535	519	16
Arizona	1,750	1,800	— 50
Arkansas	572	689	— 117
California	6,185	10,274	— 4,089
Colorado	1,748	1,739	9
Connecticut	1,619	1,750	— 131
Delaware	351	440	— 89
District of Columbia	184	210	— 26
Florida	6,069	5,511	558
Georgia	2,460	2,787	— 327
Hawaii	450	612	— 162
Idaho	574	643	— 69
Illinois	3,678	4,282	— 604
Indiana	1,567	1,579	— 12
Iowa	1,248	1,273	— 25
Kansas	1,188	1,304	— 116
Kentucky	996	1,000	— 4
Louisiana	900	992	— 92
Maine	641	675	— 34
Maryland	1,427	1,558	— 131
Massachusetts	2,445	3,292	— 847
Michigan	3,483	3,620	— 137
Minnesota	2,886	3,010	— 124
Mississippi	577	607	— 30
Missouri	1,790	1,920	— 130
Montana	699	715	— 16
Nebraska	944	1,014	— 70
Nevada	750	774	— 24
New Hampshire	744	772	— 28
New Jersey	2,867	3,091	— 224
New Mexico	712	739	— 27
New York	6,278	6,330	— 52
No Carolina	2,422	2,593	— 171
No Dakota	400	438	— 38
Ohio	2,904	3,106	— 202
Oklahoma	929	1,025	— 96
Oregon	1,454	1,446	8
Pennsylvania	4,597	5,149	— 552
Rhode Island	370	422	— 52
So Carolina	989	1,120	— 131
So Dakota	388	440	— 52
Tennessee	1,215	1,238	— 23
Texas	4,295	4,484	— 189
Utah	541	644	— 103
Vermont	408	422	— 14
Virginia	1,928	2,310	— 382
Washington	2,509	3,201	— 692
West Virginia	435	447	— 12
Wisconsin	2,057	2,554	— 497
Wyoming	283	336	— 53
Puerto Rico	82	46	36
U.S Possessions	73	70	3
Subtotal U.S.	87,613	98,082	— 10,469
CANADA			
Alberta/NWT	780	844	— 64
British Columbia/Ykn	904	979	— 75
Manitoba	388	377	11
New Brunswick/ Prince Edwards Island	150	298	— 148
Nova Scotia/ New Foundland/Labrador	386	390	— 4
Ontario	2,983	2,871	112
Quebec	211	192	19
Saskatchewan	349	404	— 55
Subtotal Canada	6,151	6,355	— 204
FOREIGN	1,267	1,207	60
Grand Total*	95,031	105,644	— 10,613
LA VIÑA SUBSCRIPTIONS*			
	Jan./Feb. 2004	Jan./Feb. 2003	
	7,056	7,002	54
(*exclusive of monthly orders)			

Area Service Highlights — Panel 54 Delegates

(Only first-term delegates give Area Highlights)

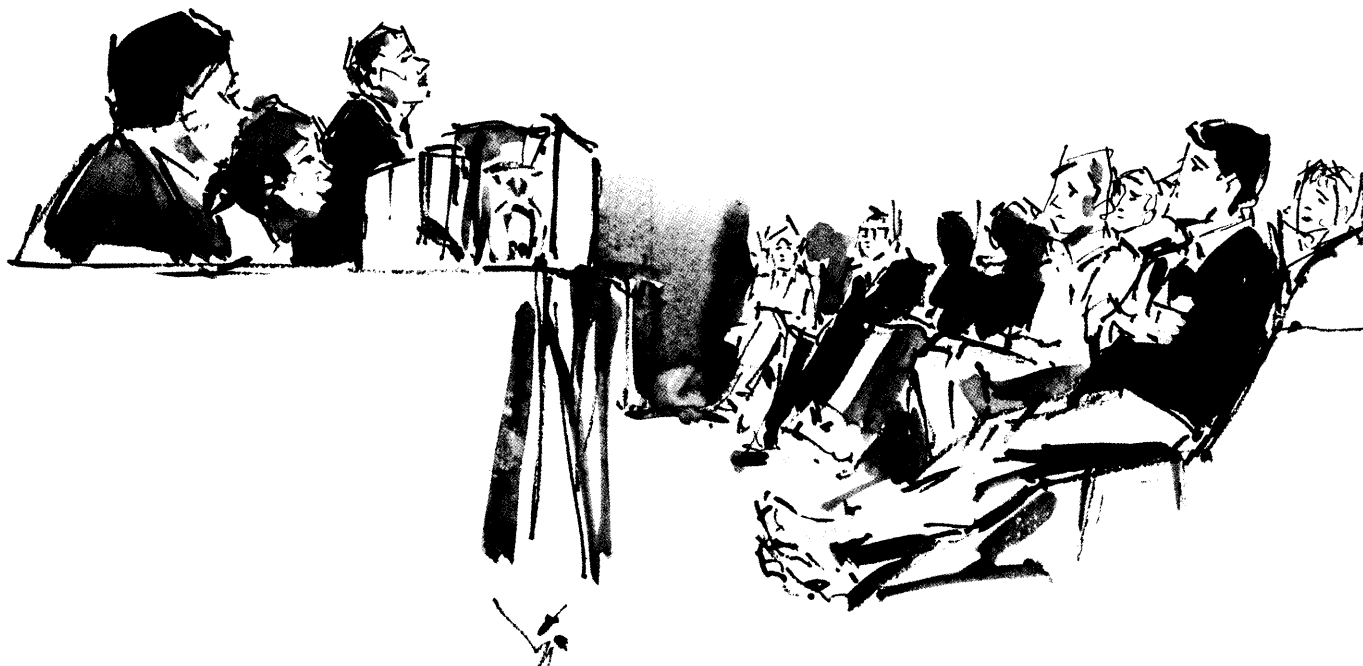
Alaska: Area 2 has approximately 190 registered groups spread over an area that would encompass 20% of the lower 48 states. We are divided into 12 districts, ten of which are active. A third of the population is inaccessible by road. Out of necessity one district meets by telephone and other districts with remote groups include them by telephone in their meetings. Area 2 members most recently supported the delegate and area chair travel to our most Northern District 12 and along with 11 other fellow A.A. members we held a service weekend in Nome. Ric D., Western Canadian regional trustee, who has a long history of work with remote communities joined us in two full days of presentations and fellowship. There is an increase in activity in our committee system, which mirrors that of the Conference. Districts bid on hosting an assembly, thus affording the opportunity to rotate throughout the state and for our Fellowship to observe first hand, "service in action." The cost of unity may be high in Alaska, yet despite geographical barriers, the high cost of travel, and at times language barriers we constantly see our groups, districts, and the Alaska Area rise to the occasion with Seventh Tradition support, and their participation to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. Efforts to be inclusive to all groups in Alaska will remain a high priority to the Alaska Area service structure. — *Dave Manson*

Alberta/Northwest Territories: Area 78 is made up of the Province of Alberta, two parts of British Columbia, and the North West Territories — extending from the U.S. border, north to the Arctic Circle. There are 526 groups in 48 districts, with 39 active district committee members. Our area assemblies are held in the same central location twice per year, because of the large distances the G.S.R.s must travel. We hold two meetings of the area committee per year as well. The purpose was to take a service function on the road, hoping to attract greater interest from the Fellowship by making them local events. The experiment has been constructive and may become a tradition in the area. There are two cities in our area of just under one million people, as well as many smaller ones, and of course, vast rural areas. All this

gives us a great cross section of districts, intergroups and central offices. We hosted a Regional Forum in February this year. The Fellowship in the area is active and our area meetings are well attended. I feel confident, therefore, that I am informed of the group conscience and that A.A. will continue to be vibrant and healthy in Area 78. — *Victor Phillips*

Arizona: Area 3 includes all of Arizona, a small part of California and one group in Nogales, Mexico, which our area formally voted to welcome into our structure last November. Our area is divided into 15 county districts, each served by a D.C.M.C., and each district is divided into 64 local districts. We have approximately 800 groups and 540 registered G.S.R.s. There are over 2,200 meetings each week throughout the area. Our service structure is patterned closely after the General Service Conference, using a system of 9 Panels of area officers. We hold four assemblies each year. The pre-Conference assembly is held to gather the area's conscience on Conference topics. Area 3 is ethnically diverse, with Hispanic and Native American groups throughout the area and much work is being done within all of these communities to better carry the message. We held our third annual Corrections Conference in February, and we are excited to be the hosts of the 2005 PRAASA in Tucson. Area 3 has a very strong, effective structure. We are very active and committed to carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. — *Regan Gawan*

California (Mid-Southern): Area 9 has over 76,000 members in more than 2,400 meetings spread over 185 cities in Orange, Riverside, San Bernardino and Southern Los Angeles counties. We serve 23 districts, five are Spanish, and a total of 70 subdistricts. With the division of the area H&I Committee this year, there are currently 14 standing committees with nine Spanish co-chairs, as well as seven English and two Spanish H&I committees. We encompass eight English and five Spanish central offices and intergroups. There are three assemblies and six area service committee meetings annually. In addition, we host a pre-



Conference workshop, Archives Open House, Founders Day, Heritage Day, Servathon and a Spanish Foro that is rotationally co-hosted by English and Spanish districts, and G.S.R. Appreciation Days. This year, Area 9 has the privilege of hosting the Pacific Region A.A. Service Assembly. The Panel 54 officers have developed a paired-team rotational liaison concept for visitation to all the districts which will result in 12 districts being visited each month. Many of our districts have also developed meeting visitation programs in an effort to increase G.S.R. representation. Our area continues to grow in spiritual grace through unity and service with our heart to our Higher Power and our hand to the alcoholic. — *Nancy Jensen*

California (Northern Interior): Area 7 has 27 districts, of which two are Spanish-speaking, and we serve about 700 A.A. groups. We have eight area committee meetings and four assemblies a year. We are fortunate to be able to fund both our elected and appointed area officers to attend the annual Pacific Region Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly. The area committee meetings are held near the center of the area in West Sacramento, with some of the D.C.M.s driving up to six hours each way to attend. Our assemblies rotate throughout the area and consist of a one-day winter, two-day pre-Conference, two-day post-Conference, and a three-day assembly in the fall. At the assemblies, especially in the fall, we have panel presentations by G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s on Conference agenda topics, and issues directly related to the area. The area is in the process of deciding how to best prepare an area Web site. I am grateful for my association with the people in this area, they are role models for doing the best job we can for A.A. The growth and maturing we have had in the area is a direct result of the people who have given their time, countless miles of driving, and a loving yet firm hand in directing the affairs of the area. I say this with gratitude, and if I serve well as Panel 54 delegate it is because of the love and service of those who have come before me. — *Paul Coonce*

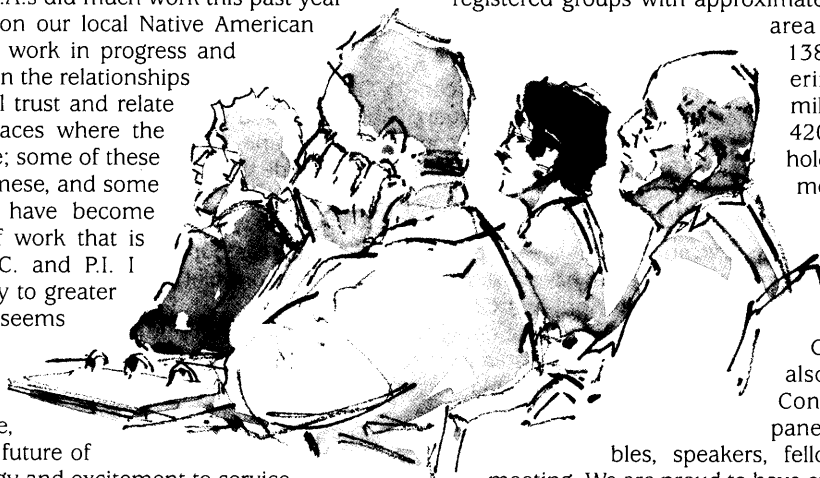
California (San Diego/Imperial): Area 8 has over 1,200 groups in 23 districts. We have 11 standing committees, including two H&I committees covering north and south county. We have two English and two Spanish-speaking central offices, also in north and south county. We have supportive relationships with our local Intergroups and H&I committees and unity has been increasing between Spanish and English-speaking districts. We have many of the same problems other areas have and there seems to be a general apathy amongst our members toward involvement in any service beyond sponsorship. Our past delegate, Jim H., and a few local A.A.s did much work this past year to reach suffering alcoholics on our local Native American Indian reservations. This is a work in progress and will take much footwork to gain the relationships these particular alcoholics will trust and relate to. There are many other places where the hand of A.A. is not really there; some of these are Special Needs, the Vietnamese, and some correctional facilities. I also have become aware of the vast amount of work that is needed in the areas of C.P.C. and P.I. I believe that sponsorship is key to greater service participation, but it seems that many sponsors haven't learned to carry the message of service. In our area I see our young people's committee, GSDYPAA, as really being the future of our program. They bring energy and excitement to service

that attracts young people, and their focus is on getting everyone involved in some A.A. service. These young newcomers, as sponsors, will be passing on the message of service involvement. I have to say that I see our future as being strong. — *Mare Jones*

Delaware: Area 12, the great state of Delaware — also known as the Small Wonder because of its geographic size — is home to more than 3,200 recovering alcoholics, 202 groups, three Intergroups and 13 districts. Many of Area 12's Panel 54 trusted servants are native to the state; however, both the area chair and I are transplants from other adjoining areas. Our focus in each district includes Cooperation With the Professional Community, Public Information and Special Needs. On the Intergroup level there is a continuing outpouring of support for hospitals, prisons and prerelease centers. Our social and spiritual get-togethers include topics such as sponsorship, service and the paradoxes of our program. We have speaker meetings attached to breakfasts and dinners, and picnics with meetings under the stars. Our annual convention at the seashore includes participation from our Al-Anon and Alateen friends. Delaware A.A.s try their best to carry the message of recovery wherever and whenever we can. We encourage you to visit us and enjoy the Fellowship that has brought us sobriety, joy and peace. — *Jonathan "Buck" Rose*

Georgia: Area 16 has grown from 16 to 17 districts this year, 48 to 50 D.C.M.s, 703 groups to 711, and 18,000 to 18,500 members, due in part to the growing Hispanic community in the area. We hold three area assemblies yearly with average attendance of 700; a Georgia Prepaid Convention; pre-Conference and D.C.M. planning meetings; seven regional forums emphasizing the Conference theme, a Spanish-speaking District Forum; seven committees including Finance, Convention, Archives, Grapevine, PICPC, Treatment, and Corrections. We have an area office with two paid employees to distribute literature, publish a directory and newsletter, provide meeting space for area events, and house our archives. This year we've moved to new offices; opened our first archives repository; created an area-wide Spanish-speaking district; appointed a parliamentarian to improve business sessions; and agreed to do our first area inventory in May. We are grateful for the opportunity to host the 2015 A.A. International convention in Atlanta. Indeed, gratitude fuels the great amount of activity in Area 16. — *Dick Anderson*

Idaho: Area 18 is currently composed of 10 districts, and we are in the process of forming another. We have approximately 205 registered groups with approximately 3,300 members. Our area covers approximately 138,600 square miles, covering distances of 330 miles north to south and 420 miles east to west. We hold three area committee meetings per year. We also hold two area assemblies, one in the spring and the other in the fall, rotating around the area. Our area assemblies also serve as our Area Conventions, providing panel discussions, roundtables, speakers, fellowship and a business meeting. We are proud to have over a 50% turnout of our



G.S.R.s. We have just formed a Web site (idahoarea18aa.org), which is currently being handled under C.P.C./P.I. I am proud and honored to represent Idaho Area 18. — *Jim McDonald*

Illinois (Northern): Area 20 reaches from the Mississippi to the Indiana border and about 45 miles south to the Wisconsin border, excluding Cook County. It is composed of 1,090 registered groups with an approximate membership of 22,000, divided into 25 districts, including one linguistic district. The area gathers in meetings assembled four times a year, as does the area committee, which sets the assembly agenda. Every year the area hosts a Spring Conference and a Fall Big Book Conference. This coming year we have had several challenges placed before us: the area will be developing its own pamphlet on "How to Handle a Twelfth Step Call"; we will be given the opportunity to carry the message into the Illinois Department of Correction's newly reopened Sheridan facility, whose population is composed of 1,100 inmates seeking drug and alcohol rehabilitation in what the state hopes will become a national model program for addressing alcohol and drug problems in inmate populations. Finally, our area will host the Illinois State Conference under the auspices of the Illinois State Policy Committee, which is composed of the delegates and chairmen of our area, Area 19-Chicago, and Area 21-Southern Illinois. This year the conference will introduce attendees to our version of a mini-forum with the aid of our East Central Regional trustee, the Grapevine editor, Class A trustee, Vince O'Keefe, and our past delegates. It is with faith in our higher power and gratitude for the sobriety given us through the A.A. program that we look forward to meeting the challenges of the coming year. — *Terry Whelan*

Indiana (Southern): Area 23 has 25 districts with 805 groups and meetings. We now have 16 Spanish-speaking meetings with membership over 100. With the addition of our Special Needs committee, we now have 11 standing committees. We select the members of our standing committees by lot from our D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s. Area assemblies are held on a rotating basis, providing service opportunities to more districts. We have five area assemblies yearly with our pre-Conference assembly in early April. We host a weekend service workshop assembly the first weekend of October, which is usually held at one of our state parks, and is always well attended. The area committee meets in November to discuss the budget for the upcoming year. We have four active intergroups and we are currently working to form a Spanish-speaking intergroup in Indianapolis. We are also excited about hosting the East Central Regional Conference/Indiana State Convention August 13-15, 2004, in Indianapolis. Area 23 will be having a spring D.C.M. conference the first of March for the purpose of discussing agenda items for the Conference. A D.C.M. workshop is held in the fall. From hosting our State convention, managing displays at health fairs, speaking at schools, bridging the gap from treatment and jails, our uppermost concern is how we can better carry our message to the alcoholic who still suffers. — *Gary Gramman*

Kansas: Area 25 has 28 districts, two are Spanish-speaking, serving 358 groups, 11 being Spanish-speaking. We have assemblies in January and July, committee meetings in April and October. Our committee meeting in April is to help prepare the delegate for the conference as to what the conscience of the area is. We have an Area 25 conference each year that rotates on a bid basis by districts. We also have a Correction Conference each year, which is rotated within the state. We have active committee chairs who do what they can to carry the message. These chairs are appointed by the area chair, then ratified by the assembly for

a two-year term. I have been able to travel about 40,000 miles in Area 25 the last two years as alternate delegate. I have seen a scary change in some of the groups that have gotten away from our singleness of purpose. Some groups are failing, trying to be too much to too many. I wrote this while spending time with my mother who has suffered a stroke. Twenty years ago she told me I was a disgrace as a son. Thanks to all of you I can give back some of what I had stolen for many years, the gift of unconditional love. — *Jimmy Jack Bailey*

Kentucky: Area 26 is composed of 34 districts with approximately 650 active groups comprising 10,000 members. Our State Convention operates on a rotating basis between six different sites. We have six intergroups scattered throughout the state, with most in the larger metropolitan areas. We have quarterly meetings throughout the year with the October meeting being an assembly where elections are held in odd numbered years. Our elections follow the Third Legacy procedure. During the past year we added a Literature Committee to our standing committees and we continue to look for ways to improve our service structure. During our last assembly we elected to provide a copy of the Grapevine magazine to each D.C.M. to be distributed to the GvRs in an effort to improve circulation in our area. We have a long and sometimes stormy history with the Conference, which we are striving to improve upon. We were selected to host the Southeast Forum this year and preparations are under way to make this an enjoyable event for all participants. We look forward to seeing you in Louisville. Area 26 is the home of Alcoholic No. 3, and we now boast of being the home of Class A trustee Allen Ault. — *O'Dell Holloway*

Maine: Area 28 has over 400 registered groups (24 in Canada) in 23 districts, making us an international area. The area stretches from New Hampshire in the south to the Canadian border, making us larger than the rest of the New England states combined. We also hold the unique distinction of being the only state in the lower 48 to border only one other state. We have our own Service Guidelines Workbook and continue to publish our area newsletter, *The Boomerang* — the only one mentioned in the Big Book. We hold spring and fall assemblies, five area committee meetings, a pre-Conference Forum and a post-Conference Forum. Our standing committees are active and all district chairs serve on a standing committee. Our Love and Service Committee conducts four workshops a year, rotating throughout the area, and our corrections committee holds an annual workshop that is highly regarded throughout the Northeast Region. We also have a Guidelines Committee, a Central Service Office Liaison and an Al-Anon Liaison. A Central Office in Portland houses our Archives, prints a statewide meeting list, provides hot line services for most of the area and maintains a Web site. In July we hold our annual round-up at Sugarloaf in the mountains of western Maine. This year's theme is "Our Singleness of Purpose," to coincide with that of the Conference. No matter where we serve in A.A., we all have the same primary purpose — helping the alcoholic who still suffers. It is the spiritual tie that binds us and guarantees our existence for generations to come. For this we are responsible! — *Mark Thomas*

Manitoba: Area 80 has 146 groups with approximately 3,800 members in 14 districts. While over half of our population resides within the city of Winnipeg, the balance is spread throughout the rural and northern areas of our 251,000 square mile province. One of the ongoing challenges in Manitoba is to involve these more remote areas in our service assemblies. For two years our theme is "Twinning: District to District/Group to

Group. . . A.A.s helping A.A.s.” Many of our active districts have voluntarily ‘twinned’ with less active and remote districts. They are making contact with groups in those districts to gather registrar and meeting information, share assembly news and report back to assemblies on how these groups, who are not able to attend, are doing. Of the four assemblies we hold each year we are planning to host at least half of them in communities where we have never, or at least not recently, held an assembly. Our annual “Northern Trip” is always a spiritual adventure for the area committee members who participate. The goal is to visit a number of northern groups and share information. This past year we rounded out our message with a representative from Manitoba Central Office/Intergroup as we covered over 2,200 kilometers. Each year we host Gratitude Day in early March in Winnipeg for approximately 800 members and friends, where we focus on newcomers, service and recovery. Serving as a member of Manitoba General Service for many years has enhanced my sobriety, but also it has opened my eyes to the beauty and diversity of my province and given me life-long friends in our Fellowship. — *Robin Fewings*

Maryland: Area 29 covers over 11,118 square miles—is the state of Maryland minus Prince Georges and Montgomery counties, which are part of the Washington D.C. Area. We have 10 intergroups and 47 districts, over 920 registered groups and a reported 14,784 members. We hold five assemblies, four committees and one mini-Conference annually. The mini-Conference is a two-day event used to prepare our delegate for the Conference. Our assemblies and committees rotate throughout the state. Our committees mirror those of the General Service Conference. We also have several ad-hoc committees, which provide additional services to the area and include: Audio, Fall Conference, Host, Intergroup Liaison mini-Conference, State Convention, and *Margenser*, which is our quarterly newsletter. Participation by D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s fluctuates, similar to membership in my home group. Over the years I have seen attendance and enthusiasm booming, while other times the attendance seems lacking and labored. Much has been discussed and attempted in our area to increase participation at all levels. We have held multiple workshops regarding the service structure and the importance of the G.S.R. and D.C.M. as well as creating ad-hoc committees to reach out to the “dark” districts. The continued challenge in our area is in keeping G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s involved, active, and informed. At times it seems like as soon as a spark lights in one district, the flame flickers in another, the hope at the area level remains constant. To that end we continue to do our best to carry the message of recovery, unity and service from our eastern shore neighborhoods along the Atlantic Ocean, to our hillside side communities in the Appalachian Mountains. — *Nancy Kunkel*

Massachusetts (Western): Area 31 has six districts, with 243 active groups, 82 inactive groups, and a total membership of 3,899. We are served by two intergroups; our western Massachusetts office has just gone on-line with a new Web site, aawmass.org. We also staff a 24-hour answering service. There are six standing committees that serve our area as well as three invited members. These are our two intergroups and the institutions committee. A bridging the gap liaison works with the institutions committee. Each year there is a spring mini-Conference; we also hold a spring and fall assembly, and in June we have our annual round up. Area 31 currently has an ad hoc committee looking into the need of a linguistic district. Our P.I. committee has embarked on an “adopt a library project,” which has met with enthusiasm. We have heard from one woman who showed up at an A.A. meeting after finding out about A.A. at her local

library. The hand of A.A. is reaching out to all parts of western Massachusetts — not only on a committee level, but also through the dedication and love of individual members who have become responsible. If you are traveling within Area 31, please come join us as we trudge this happy road. — *John Ferriter*

Michigan (Western): Area 34 has 15 districts, 13 being active at this time, and around 470 groups. Its geographic boundaries cover the Indiana State Line along the eastern shore of Lake Michigan, to the Upper Peninsula of Michigan. It was an unusual and challenging year — our State Convention didn’t break even, area officers resigned and a host of other things. We have had lively discussions on a service piece from the G.S.O. Guidelines on Clubs and have sent a letter to the appropriate committee for review with suggestions. We even cancelled an area assembly and moved one to another date. Talk about some unusual discussions. Money became another topic discussed at lengths — from raising the area’s prudent reserve to approximately one quarter’s expenses, to funding the needs of our corrections committee and incorrect contributions. In the last few years we have sent a number of people to the East Central Regional Forum — eight total with two alternate. We had another unprecedented discussion on hosting the 2006 Michigan State Convention and agreed to accept the request of Area 33 to host 2006 and for Area 34 to host 2007. Another challenge will be getting the rotation of the State Convention back on track. I think I will be grateful to have rotated by then and can add comments from the back of the room, as is the unwritten tendencies of our area’s “has beens.” — *Mike Young*

Minnesota (Northern): Area 35 encompasses the northern half of Minnesota. We have 17 districts, 552 groups and an estimated 8,900 membership. We meet as an area seven times a year, with one area service workshop, two assemblies and four area committee meetings. We have nine Action Committees, with a newly created position of Webmaster with full voting and reimbursement privileges. Our Action Committee chairs are appointed by the incoming area chairperson, with recommendations coming from the present Action Committee chairs and area officers. This policy ensures continuity in opportunities provided to the still-suffering alcoholic, while ensuring that the area has experienced trusted servants. Our area has been divided into four geographic zones, with our assemblies and area workshop rotating from zone to zone to give even the most remote G.S.R.s the opportunity to experience an assembly or workshop without having to travel a vast distance. This also provides our area with informed members, willing to serve from all reaches of our area. Our G.S.R.s elected to create what we call “Zonal Forums,” which are patterned after G.S.O.’s Regional Forums. Twice a year our five elected area officers travel to a different zone, put on a short presentation, answer questions and concerns from the Fellowship, then close with the video “Your A.A., General Service Office, the Grapevine and the General Service Structure.” Our area’s enthusiasm is contagious! I am proud to be a small part of a great whole. — *Charlie Craven*

Mississippi: Area 37 has 24 districts and 221 groups. We now have a Web site to list meetings and convention information; there are currently 170 groups participating on the Web site. We have four assemblies a year, which are held in Jackson, Mississippi, for one day only. There is a G.S.R. sharing session at each assembly in which some type of service workshop is held and the G.S.R.s have an opportunity to interact with each other. We constantly strive to have as much group and district participation as possible and have seen an increase in G.S.R. and

D.C.M. attendance and participation at assemblies. We currently have 11 standing committees that are doing a lot of service work. Our Archives committee has completed several life histories of oldtimers to help us preserve A.A. history in our state. The committee continues to work on how best to store and make the archives accessible to the members. Our Correctional and Treatment Committees carry the message to facilities throughout the State. P.I. and C.P.C. continue to work toward making A.A. information available to the public. Our newsletter is now available in both hard copy and by e-mail. Our Grapevine and Literature Committees provide our message in print. During our yearly State Convention all committees are invited (and encouraged) to put up displays and provide information about the business of A.A. — to carry the message. — *Elizabeth Kepner*

Nebraska: Area 41's continued focus is to better serve the area with increased participation, to strengthen unity, so that we may better achieve our primary purpose. An outgrowth of our Remote Communities Committee is the formation of a new district. The Spanish-linguistic district has been formed at the request of a large contingent of A.A. members of our Spanish-speaking community. As a result of the Remote Communities Committee efforts to identify and reach out to the diverse cultures which comprise our area, we developed and generated, with G.S.O. support, the first translations of the "A.A. Fact Sheet" and "Is A.A. For You?" in Nuer, the language of many Sudanese. Many of our past delegates chair breakout sessions at our yearly Conference Agenda Items Four Corners Workshop. We hope this workshop will allow for an informed group conscience, better equipping our trusted servants. At our four annual assemblies, a G.S.R. Workshop/Mtg. offers an opportunity for interaction, insight and experiences to be shared from G.S.R.s of our 669 groups. It is a great privilege to serve as Area 41's delegate; service has kept me humble enough to seek guidance from my Higher Power and the members of A.A., to stay part of the "we." — *Connie Shockey*

New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island: Area 81, on the east coast of Canada, has 13 districts, 9 in New Brunswick and 4 in Prince Edward Island, joined by the longest bridge over ice-covered water in the world (12.9 kilometers or 8.01 miles). There are 192 registered groups, including one each in the Provinces of Nova Scotia and Quebec. The area has a total membership of approximately 3,500. Communication in our area, including on our recently established Web site, is in English and French. Groups hold 327 meetings per week, 273 English-speaking, 31 French-speaking, and 23 bilingual (English/French). Weekly meetings are also held in three Federal Corrections Institutions, one of which has the distinction of being the first such institution in Canada to open an A.A. group and continuously conduct A.A. meetings. This is achieved with a lot of support from surrounding groups who attend the meetings "behind the walls" and the local district has taken its district meetings to them also. A number of our membership have received clearance from Corrections Canada and are regularly engaged in escorting inmates from the minimum security Federal Institution to outside A.A. meetings. Area 81 holds area assemblies in May and October and area business meetings/workshops in March and August. The location for these assemblies and meetings are at various locations, giving smaller rural areas the opportunity to also host. Many districts annually host one day and weekend round-ups and workshops with our Literature and Archives often prominently displayed. Our struggle in Area 81 remains that of attempting to get more members involved in service work, thereby enabling them to more effectively carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Don Mollins*

New Hampshire: Area 43 has 15 districts, 569 groups, 692 meetings, and well over 10,000 members. We have nine active standing committees. We have quarterly area assemblies, hosted by different districts. Two of our quarterly assembly workshops are reserved for "Pre- and Post-Conference" discussion, conducted by our delegate. We have been blessed with continual financial support, affording the area to support the full budget for all area elected officers, and limited financial support for area standing committee chairs. We hosted NERD 2003, as well as NERASSA 2004. Our area webmaster has created our Web site, www.nhaa.net, which we are proud of. In this past year our first Spanish-speaking meeting started in Nashua, NH. We have our first Area Hotline, which had been established years ago as a "Consolidated Hotline" by most of our districts. Our Corrections Committee has 57 meetings a week in all our men and women state prisons, to include the State Criminally Insane Facility. Our area Grapevine/Literature chair travels to any event a group, district or the area is hosting, with a display. Our P.I./C.P.C. has a subcommittee, which is informing new law enforcement candidates, senior supervisors and chiefs of police what A.A. is and is not, at the New Hampshire Police Standards and Training facility. A.A. is very alive and well in Area 43! — *Catherine Glosser*

New Jersey (Southern): Area 45 has 542 registered groups supporting over 1,500 meetings in 28 districts. They are structured within four Sections, and serve nearly 9,000 members. We hold a combined area assembly and committee meeting that rotates quarterly to each of our four Sections. With our latest addition of G.S.R./D.C.M. Orientation, we currently have 15 active committees. Our annual convention is in March and mini-conference in early April. We conduct an Area Inventory in alternating years. Joining with our three intergroups at an Annual Day of Sharing, we work in cooperation, to carry the message. Our Web site grants access to considerable information, along with our Fourth Dimension Newsletter, which increases awareness. Our C.P.C. committee frequently joins its Northern New Jersey C.P.C. in carrying the message of recovery to statewide conferences for professionals. The spirit of cooperation continues with our Jal-Con Committee, which carries the A.A. message to the Al-Anon State Convention. Our Grapevine committee promises to expand circulation. Annually hosting an Inter-Area Conference, our C.T.F. committee explores methods to reach those who can't come to us. P.I. works diligently carrying the message to the general public, recently placing Fourth Edition Big Books and Grapevine subscriptions in libraries and doctors offices throughout Southern New Jersey. All are evidence that, "The age of miracles is still with us," the current theme for Area 45, because miracles abound all through Southern New Jersey, where I am privileged to serve. — *Laurie Emhe*

New Mexico: Our area covers the entire state of New Mexico except the extreme southern tip. We have 17 districts, the most recent being a linguistic district which is Spanish speaking. We have 346 registered groups with approximately 6,000 members. We hold three area assemblies and our annual convention in June is meant for a time of fellowship and fun. We normally do not conduct any area business at the convention. Assemblies meet all day Saturday and Sunday morning. We have twelve committees that discuss how they can better serve alcoholics in the area. Our newest committee is Bridging the Gap, created last December. We had some controversy over this committee as some just wanted to have a Bridge the Gap subcommittee that worked jointly with the Corrections and Treatment Facilities Committees while others wanted a "stand alone" committee. We went with the stand alone committee. More and more our area

committees continue to communicate between assemblies and I believe we are doing a good job carrying the message through the work of these committees, both during the assemblies and throughout the year. — *Oran Clemons*

New York (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire): With over 650 registered groups, Area 48 covers a large portion of New York State. Its area name, Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire, tells only part of the story. Up the Hudson River with the Catskill Mountains on our west and Berkshires on our east, our area stretches from Poughkeepsie, north to Albany, Plattsburgh and Lake Placid, out to our western district in the Utica/Rome area, along the historic Mohawk River Valley, where we meet one of my favorite groups, "Drunks Along The Mohawk." I have been guided by two great sponsors, my first and early A.A.er and my present sponsor, a past delegate. They have shown me the pathway to happiness and freedom; I was at my first area assembly five months sober and I've attended them ever since. Our meetings in HMB are both urban and rural and are filled with the joys and challenges that face us all in modern A.A. Our "singleness of purpose," helping the still-suffering alcoholic find a new life free from the bondage of alcohol, continues to be the greatest principle that holds us together as a Fellowship. A.A. is still growing in our area; new meetings are registering all the time. Our challenge is to welcome these new groups and encourage them to join in on the A.A. service structure. I am humbled to be here this week to learn and listen and participate. I look forward to returning home to tell everyone with great confidence that A.A. will be here another day to help the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Steve Walker*

New York (Western): Area 50 has 400 groups, four intergroups and 23 districts. The assembly meets seven times a year. We have C.P.C., D.F.C., T.F.C. and P.I.C. committees that work with the intergroups. The intergroups supply schedules and answering services within their region. We are hosting the New York State Convention and the New York Informational Workshop. We work with the other three delegates in the New York region, and also with the Women's International Convention that was held in Buffalo this year. Each spring we hold an area convention. We have a booth located at the Erie County Fair Grounds where we pass out literature and answer A.A. related questions. Buffalo has its own central office. There is an answering service provided and they provide literature for local groups. Our other three intergroups meet in churches every month. This past year we hosted a Northeast Regional Forum in Niagara Falls. I find it an honor to serve my area as delegate for the next two years. We have a strong body of service people in our assembly. — *Walter Covert*

Ohio (Northwest)/Michigan (Southwest): Area 55 has 546 meetings, with 280 registered groups. We have 17 districts, of which 13 have active D.C.M.s. We have five standing committees, the C.P.C./P.I., Archives, Grapevine, Shut-ins/Special Needs, and the Group Services which remain active. We hold eight area assemblies a year. Each March we hold an annual mini-Conference to better inform our delegate of the area's conscience to take to the Conference. There are three other areas in Ohio which also hold weekend mini-Conferences, and send our delegate and alternate delegate to attend these, getting a better feeling of our state conscious. We try to keep our past delegates active, and suggest that they chair a committee of their choice after rotating from the delegate's position. We have an Area 55 Web site to help the still-suffering alcoholic reach us, and as a tool for professionals to reach us. Every year we rotate the Ohio and Southeast Michigan State Convention with the other three areas in Ohio, always asking their assistance and input. We also

rotate the East Central Region Conference, rotating it with the other 13 areas in the East Central Region holding it in conjunction with our Ohio and Southeast Michigan State Convention when it is in one of Ohio's areas. — *Alan DoMoe*

Ohio (Southwest): Area 56 has approximately 550 registered groups and 30 districts in the 15 counties we serve. We have 6 area assemblies to take care of business matters. Five times a year we have area committee meetings which are nonvoting but informative. Last October we hosted the 47th Ohio State Convention. Immediately following, at our regular area assembly, five officers were elected to Panel 54. In December we filled all 11 standing committee chairs, with three past delegates among them. For the first time our area has a Web site up and running, www.aaarea56.org. This should provide another tool to reach out to fellow alcoholics. In January we combined our regular committee meeting with a workshop encouraging unity between intergroups, districts and the area as a whole. This year's Unity Day was a big success with a great deal of interaction and plenty of food. In March we have a mini-Conference to give the delegate an informed group conscience and to offer interested A.A.s the Conference experience. With a healthy blend of enthusiasm and experience, we will continue to carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous to the still-suffering alcoholic. I am honored and grateful to represent Southwest Ohio at the General Service Conference. — *Hank Schmitz*

Ontario (Western): Area 86 has 24 districts with 523 groups. We hold 3 committee meetings and 2 assemblies a year. We are in the process of fine-tuning some restructuring of our subcommittees. This term will see the combination of secretary/registrar implemented. We are struggling to see that all groups are registered properly with G.S.O. and that everyone is receiving proper communications. We have made major revisions to our Operating Procedures. We plan to communicate the importance of group financial responsibilities and the suggested flow of donations from the groups to their district, area and G.S.O. Our Remote Communities/Special Needs and Archives committees, formed last term, have really taken off. We are also looking into the prospect of maintaining a Web site in conjunction with the 3 other areas in Ontario. A Special Forum is scheduled in the northern part of our area in March 2005. It promises to be an informative weekend and will hopefully generate additional interest in service. A new district was formed due to the increase of new groups, making it easier for the D.C.M.s to frequent their respective groups. Three other districts have also gone through some extensive restructuring, combining their intergroup and general service duties. It is an exciting time in our area and much hard work has been and continues to be accomplished. A.A. is alive and well in Western Ontario and it is truly an honor and a privilege to be here to represent the hard working and dedicated members of Area 86. — *Jan Lembke*

Oregon: Area 58 has 34 districts. District 28 (due to geographics) chooses to be served by Idaho Area 18, but we keep the lights on for them in Oregon by keeping them on our roster. One district is an area-wide Spanish-speaking district. We have 797 active groups registered. We now have a web page up and running. Our newsletter was resuscitated and is available to download from the web page. We have formed and funded an Accessibility standing committee, which we hope will help districts to help groups address various accessibility difficulties that some alcoholics have getting to meetings. We will be hosting the Pacific Regional Forum in Portland, July 16-19, 2004, our first ever. Some of you may know about the Pacific North West Conference — the oldest

continuing conference in A.A., which was set in motion by Bill Wilson on a trip he made to the Northwest in 1948. Today it is a service-centered conference, with panels running three wide, each addressing some aspect of one of our Three Legacies. The conference came upon hard times in the late '90s, lost attendance and money, and some areas decided to let go; however, two areas are still hanging on. The Oregon Area was honored to do so last July, and Eastern Washington will host it in 2004. It was well attended, and beyond self-supporting last year. Stay tuned for the Panel 56 report. — *Bruce Landolt*

Quebec (Northwest): Area 90 has 381 groups and 24 districts; we cover a large territory from Montreal (North) to the remote district (new) of Nunavut-Nuvavit in the Iceland. Our area has gone through some bad times, and we had to let go of an entire district to our neighbor area. We also had dissensions between our officers; the districts boycotted the area by cutting the contributions. We have learned from the experience and managed to get the assembly and the officers to work together. The good thing is that everyone finished their term and nobody quit. Today we are a better area, we have new officers and the group is homogenized. I see this experience as a leap to another step of our growing up. We have six area assemblies and two general assemblies. We maintain seven service committees, four working committees, plus two supporting committees. We have, with the three others area of Quebec, an excellent collaboration; all the officers of each area gather in an interregional meeting three times a year to discuss and put projects together. Our past delegates participate in our general assemblies, and are still serving our Fellowship. We would like to acknowledge the work of Diane R., our past Web master, for the tremendous job she has done building up our Web site. We have relocated our service bureau, and it is now more practical and with more space. With love for service. — *Donald Cusson*

Québec (Southwest): I have the privilege to serve in a very dynamic and bilingual area (French-English). The 550 groups (approximately 17,000 members) are structured within 28 districts (21 French-speaking, six English-speaking and one Spanish) and 13 area committees. We hold seven area meetings and three assemblies per year. In these assemblies, we now provide a simultaneous translation service, available on a FM band received on walkmans, to which the Anglophone participants tune-in. The steering committee takes part in three annual meetings of the interarea committee, gathering together the four areas of Quebec. We are also pleased to be part of the Provincial committee for the official Web site of A.A. in Quebec. Delegates of Quebec sit on the board of directors of Les Éditions de la Vigne, which produces a bimonthly french-language magazine, *La Vigne A.A.* The theme of the Conference, "Singleness of Purpose," animates all our area and interarea activities. All efforts, concerted in each committee, enable us to be reassured of the survival of A.A. and that we carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers (and this alcoholic is not necessarily only the newcomer). My involvement in services gives me "joie de vivre" and a feeling of usefulness and achievement which seemed to me unattainable "à l'époque". — *Jean Gagner*

Puerto Rico: Area 77 has 126 groups spread over 8 districts and approximately 1,500 members. We have an area office attended by two A.A. member employers who work from Monday thru Saturday. Our area office, among other functions, provides follow up to Twelfth Step calls. Monthly we have an area meeting to share information from the districts and committee chairpersons. Every year we plan and implement several activities, a Convention, a Budget Assembly, a Spiritual Seminar, an

Organized Services Activity, and we close with a Christmas Party. Every two years we have the anniversary of the founding of A.A., and the election of new service members of the area committee. We have a monthly bulletin called *El Despertar* (The Awakening) to keep members informed about meetings, anniversaries and articles related to our program. This year we are going to carry the message to correctional facilities through an Institution and Correctional Facilities chairperson. Over the past year we have increased our Reserve Fund and presently have the equivalent of six months operating expenses. Soon Area 77 will have a Web site, now under construction. — *Eladio Montalvo*

Rhode Island: Area 61 has approximately 250 groups with just under 500 weekly meetings; there are eight districts, seven geographical and an area-wide Spanish-speaking linguistic district. Our current alternate delegate comes to us from the Spanish-speaking community. Assemblies are held four times each year, including a pre-Conference assembly. We devoted eight meetings each year, one in each district, to the "Joy of Service." An annual all day service oriented "Round-Up" is held in late summer. Our state convention, held in Newport in March, attracts A.A.s from all over the Northeast Region. The Corrections Committee sponsors about 60 meetings a month in various prison facilities. The Treatment Facilities Committee takes about 30 meetings a week into treatment centers, hospitals, etc. Both Treatment and Corrections have active "Bridging the Gap" programs. Our C.P.C./P.I./Special Needs Committee makes presentations each year at many schools, professional organizations and medical facilities. The Grapevine Committee sponsors an active "Pass the Book" program, which sends Grapevine subscriptions to schools, libraries and other institutions. Our nonrotating archivist guides an active Archives Committee with an ongoing oral history taping program of our area's long timers. We're small, but we do it all. — *David Pratt*

Saskatchewan: Area 91 has 21 districts serving about 300 groups and approximately 3,600 members. Our area is large geographically, covering approximately more than a quarter million square miles, about the same size as the state of Texas. We hold an area committee meeting (ACM) every January, a spring assembly in mid-March and a fall assembly in mid-October. ACMs and assemblies are moved throughout the area based on districts submitting bids. The area assembly pays the expenses of the D.C.M.s to attend our ACMs and our assemblies in order to encourage participation. Historically we have had all districts represented at our ACMs and 35-40% participation by G.S.R.s at our assemblies. In the past two years our area has served as host for the Western Canada Regional Forum (June 2002) and the Western Regional Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly (WRAASA, June 2003). At spring assembly we have traditionally invited a guest from G.S.O. to join us, to share about their assignment and sharing their personal story. This has allowed many members, who might not have otherwise been able, to meet a member of the G.S.O. staff and learn more about the G.S.O. I know that it was a comfort to me, when facing anxiety about the Conference, to know that I had already met many of you, either through Forums or at our assemblies, and to realize that the others attending are friends I just hadn't met yet. — *Randy Magnus*

South Carolina: Area 62 has 23 districts, 310 groups, and over 7,000 members. Our area assembly meets three times a year at a central location and districts host the weekend activities on a rotating basis. Assemblies last 1-1/2 days, and include many meetings plus a workshop where the G.S.R.s have an opportunity to meet, share their concerns and seek solutions to problems

within their individual groups. Area 62 actively encourages its D.C.M.s, G.S.R.s, and standing committee members to share their conscience on Conference Agenda Items. This takes place in lieu of a workshop on Saturday afternoon at the assembly preceding the General Service Conference. We also have three area committee meetings, in the month prior to each assembly, to discuss and approve the assembly agenda. These meetings also afford the D.C.M.s and standing committee chairpersons an opportunity to discuss problems and activities in their respective areas. D.C.M.s will be encouraged to hold Seventh Tradition workshops at their district meetings and to visit as many G.S.R.s and their groups as possible. Additionally, the area will incorporate in its activities the 54th General Service Conference Theme: "Our Singleness of Purpose—The Cornerstone of A.A." — *Ray Nault*

South Dakota: Area 63 consists of 155 registered groups within 15 districts. Our area's service committees meet four times a year. We meet twice at conferences, held at the geographically opposite sides of the area, and twice at business-only workshops, held at a central location. We are blessed to have five or six past delegates who continue to support our service structure and reassure us with their readily available experience. Our area has been going through an exciting growing period over the past two years. We decided to change our services structure to run parallel with the committee system of the General Service Conference. Our original purpose was to allow the delegate to become more familiar with the committee system and so be comfortable with how the structure works here in New York. The unforeseen benefit has been a tremendous increase in unanimity, as well as an enormous increase in productivity from our committee to present a recommendation before our area. We love the new system and wish to thank you all for your guidance, trusted experience and fabulous examples of the divine miracle of Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Perry Grosz*

Tennessee: Area 64 has three distinct geographical areas—we have Appalachian Mountains in the East, the Cumberland Plateau and Nashville Basin in the Middle, and the Gulf Coastal Plain, with rich farmland, in the West. We have 500 or so groups, 40 districts, including one Hispanic district with Spanish-speaking groups in our larger cities. We hold assemblies quarterly, and have a yearly state convention, celebrating our recovery, with guest speakers and fellowship. These events move around the state to districts willing to host them. We have time set aside at our assemblies on Friday night and Saturday morning for our six standing service committees and other assembly business committees to meet. At assemblies, you may find 300 to 350 attending, with 150 to 200 voting members. Our area service committees report on their attempts to carry the message and let us know of their needs and progress. This year, the Area 64 Archives Committee is pleased to be hosting The Ninth Annual Nationwide Archives Workshop in Murfreesboro, September 23–26. There is a link to the archives workshop Web site at our area Web site, and the national workshop will be listed in the upcoming events schedule in the Grapevine and *Box 4-5-9*. Plan to attend if you are interested in learning to protect and preserve our historical treasures and precious memories. — *Milton Casey*

Texas (Northwest): Area 66 covers approximately 96,000 square miles. Over 6,500 members in 235 registered groups are served by 12 districts, eight of which are active, two of these being linguistic. The majority of the districts are rural and the D.C.M. sometimes provides the only connection between groups and the general service structure. During the next two years one focus will be on revitalizing the service structure in these three

nonparticipating districts. Assemblies are held quarterly. The Correctional Facilities committee has served a vital role in carrying the message behind the walls. The Archives committee is focusing on obtaining group histories for participation in the 2005 Spiritual Homecoming in St. Louis, Missouri. Our Spanish Bilingual Committee is active through the use of onsite translation equipment at assemblies, translating our assembly minutes as well as other vital communications. Our Web site continues to be a work in progress. We have recently formed a standing committee for the Texas State Convention, hoping to increase our participation in that event. Our area continues to be responsible financially and has become more aware of the place in service where money and spiritually mix. We are looking forward to the next two years in the Northwest Texas Area and the unity which continues to strengthen. — *Cindy Coffelt*

Texas (Southwest): Area 68 has 34 districts, including seven that are Spanish-speaking, and approximately 458 groups. Our Spanish-speaking members are able to fully participate because of our active bilingual committee. In the past year, through special contributions, we have completely replaced and upgraded our translation equipment. The committee chairpersons conduct workshops at our summer and winter assemblies. The districts and groups are encouraged to use the area committee chairpersons and area officers to conduct local workshops. The area offsets the travel expenses of the area officers and committee chairpersons. The Correctional Facilities Committee conducts a conference every February that allows us to interface with the professionals of the Judicial System and Correctional Facilities community. The out-going Archive committee completed the task of putting our archives on compact disc. Our past delegates are called upon to conduct the "ask-it-baskets" at the assemblies and assist with the election of our officers. We make a sincere effort to be all-inclusive in carrying the A.A. message to those who suffer from alcoholism. The primary focus of Southwest Texas Area is to assist the groups and districts with their primary purpose, which is to carry the A.A. message to the suffering alcoholic. — *Brent Brown*

Vermont: Area 70 has 11 districts serving 247 groups. Our four area assemblies meet quarterly, sharing locations on a rotating basis throughout the districts. The area committee also meets seven other times a year at a central location. We have nine standing committees: Archives, Convention, Corrections, Grapevine, Literature, Meeting Lists, P.I./C.P.C. (which includes the Web site subcommittees), Service Structure and Treatment. In January, each new G.S.R. is asked to join one of our standing committees for their two-year commitment. This encourages participation at our Pre-Pre Conference in March and Pre-Conference in April, where the focus is on the Conference agenda items and the formation of Area 70's collective group conscience. Our bid for NERAASA 2006 (Northeast Regional Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly) reflects the growth in our area. We are grateful for the continuous support from our past delegates at our area events. We are proud and honored to have our first Northeast Regional trustee from Vermont in our area's A.A. history. Area 70 continues to strive to help the suffering alcoholics. I thank you, Area 70, for the privilege of serving you as your delegate and A.A. as a whole. — *Jacquelyn Perry*

Washington State East: Area 92 is an international area with 467 active groups in 22 districts. We stretch east from the Cascade Mountains of Washington to include Northern Idaho; we reach into the westernmost portion of Montana, and include southeastern B.C., Canada. Although we are young the spirit of A.A. principles is strong. We yield willingly to the guidance of the

group conscience and pass on that legacy through sponsorship. Our service people are well educated in the writings of A.A. and Bill W. We cross all boundaries and ethnic lines, and proudly look to our two linguistic districts that prosper and provide the message to our large Hispanic population. Area 92 is coming of age and Unity is our standard. We are proud to be one of two areas that host the Pacific NW Conference, started by a suggestion of Bill's in 1948, and to be a member of the Pacific Region where PRAASA is such a great service experience. We will be there when and if any hand reaches for help, and we will be there as a part of A.A. as a whole. — *Mike McMurtrie*

Wisconsin (Northern)/Upper Peninsula Michigan: Area 74 has over 600 groups divided among 24 districts in the northern half of Wisconsin and most of the Upper Peninsula of Michigan. We have two assemblies and two conferences annually, and a Unity Conference, shared with Area 75. We have a new format for our area committee to meet at least four times per year. Prior to the Conference, we have a delegate's workshop where our committees make recommendations to the assembly, who in turn make recommendations for the delegate to New York. Sharing sessions happen quite often during the year and many good ideas are brought forth. The Northern half of Wisconsin and the UP of Michigan have traveling speaker meetings monthly, which are sponsored by districts. At these events G.S.R.s have a sharing session and sometimes corrections sharing also. Fellowship, recovery, unity, and service prevail at these monthly speaker meetings. Our area archivist is diligently preserving our history. Our corrections committee is in the process of developing a better "bridging the gap" system, as is our treatment facilities committee. We are striving to carry the message of happiness, joy, and freedom to the still-suffering alcoholic. The theme for this year's Conference is "Our Singleness of Purpose—The Cornerstone of A.A." and the Spirit of the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions, and The Twelve Concepts for World Services to observe this shall guide Area 74. — *Torvin Theisen*

Wyoming: Area 76 has 108 registered groups and spans 97,914 square miles in 12 districts, with approximately 1,950 members. We hold two business assemblies each year, in March and mid-August. Assemblies are rotated to various small communities to involve as many as possible. We also hold two area conventions each year, rotating between larger cities. This March we hosted the West-Central Regional A.A. Service Conference, which comes to our area once every eight years, in Cheyenne. Our members also enjoy campouts, jamborees, and other get-togethers to celebrate sobriety. They take meetings to our prisons in Rawlins and Lusk, our honor farms and local jails on a monthly and weekly basis. We have a full-time archivist, who is preserving Wyoming A.A. history. They are currently transferring many of our audio archives to CD format. *The Tributary*, the area newsletter, is published four times per year. We currently updated our area Web site to provide meeting lists from our 12 districts. Wyoming members are as rugged as the wilderness we live in, but also have technology at our fingertips. Our members are helping other alcoholics get and stay sober through their meetings and Twelfth Step calls without so much as one complaint. We continually see growth, sometimes quickly, sometimes slowly. These members give of themselves freely, honoring our primary purpose everywhere they are asked. I am honored to be a part of such a wonderful, loving, and caring group of A.A. members. Come on out and see us some time, the coffee's always on, arms open, and in some cases during our cold and wintry nights, willing to be there just for you. We'd be quite glad to see ya! — *Don Myers*

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation Form and suggested that the trustees' Conference Committee review the rating scale to offer a broader choice of responses.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Archives Workbook and suggested including a bibliography of A.A.W.S. and Grapevine publications of historic interest.
- The committee asked the trustees to review and clarify how the "Ownership of Material" statement in the Workbook relates to material collected at the G.S.O. Archives.
- The committee reviewed the "Guidelines for Collecting Oral Histories" and expressed their appreciation to the trustees' Archives Committee for developing the document. The revised Guidelines will replace the oral history section currently included in the Archives Workbook.
- The committee expressed their appreciation For the revised editorial vision and reformatted design of *Markings, Your Archives Interchange* newsletter. The committee asked the trustees' committee to explore possibilities for wider distribution of the newsletter along with the related costs involved.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Cooperation With the Professional Community Kit and Workbook and made several suggestions:
 1. The list of C.P.C. pamphlets and videos on page 30 denote which ones are available in English, French and Spanish.
 2. The Kit and Workbook be made consistent in English, French and Spanish, noting that in order to do this it would be necessary for some materials to be translated.
 3. That the pamphlet "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated" be included in the Kit.
 4. That a section titled "Singleness of Purpose" be added to the Workbook. It would read:

"This statement of 'Singleness of Purpose' has been added to pamphlets intended to share information about A.A. with professionals:

Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend *open* A.A. meetings, but only those with a *drinking* problem may attend *closed* meetings.

This is in keeping with the long form of A.A.'s Third and Fifth Traditions:



Third Tradition—Our membership ought to include all who suffer from alcoholism. Hence we may refuse none who wish to recover. Nor ought A.A. membership ever depend upon money or conformity. Any two or three alcoholics gathered together for sobriety may call themselves an A.A. group, provided that, as a group, they have no other affiliation.

Fifth Tradition—Each Alcoholics Anonymous group ought to be a spiritual entity *having but one primary purpose* — that of carrying its message to the alcoholic who still suffers.”

5. That the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities gather sharing for possible inclusion in the Workbook on ways that C.P.C. committees approach professionals, such as contacting professional associations, to add to the existing sharing regarding sending letters.

- The committee discussed ways C.P.C. committees can help when it comes to individuals referred to A.A. who focus on problems other than alcohol at A.A. meetings, and agreed that the following are useful suggestions:

1. Spending time one-on-one with professionals.
2. Making use of available A.A. literature.
3. Asking local professional friends of A.A. and utilizing A.A.s employed in professional fields to participate in C.P.C. work.
4. Informing professionals about the difference between open and closed A.A. meetings and encouraging them to refer people to open meetings.
5. Working with professionals to coordinate orientation meetings for people referred to A.A.
6. Sharing information about twelve step groups that focus on problems other than alcoholism.
7. Making sure that all A.A. members, not only those doing C.P.C. work, are familiar with all A.A.'s Traditions.

- The committee shared local experience and emphasized the benefits of Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, Public Information, and Treatment Facilities committees cooperating and working together to carry the message.

- The committee discussed ways of reaching a wider variety of professionals, including lawyers, police officers, counselors and

others involved in the social welfare system, educators, mental health professionals, as well as professionals who interact with young people. They encouraged local committee sharing about literature that may be useful in informing legal professionals about A.A.

- The committee also noted the importance of contacting professionals who serve those who speak other languages.

- The committee requested that the trustees' committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities review the inclusion of the name of a Class A trustee in the service piece "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous."

- The committee requested that the Cooperation With the Professional Community Kit and Workbook be made available in a three-ring binder format similar to the Correctional Facilities and Treatment Facilities Kits.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee supports the proposed name change from "trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities" to "trustees' Committee on Corrections."

- The committee accepted with appreciation the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities' progress report on the revision of *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* and looks forward to receiving a draft manuscript at the 2005 General Service Conference.

- The committee selected and reformatted generic prerelease brochures from the samples forwarded by the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities and requested that they be included in both the Correctional Facilities Workbook and under a new tab in the Correctional Facilities Kit.

- The committee strongly suggested that the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities present a report to the 2005 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities on the feasibility and cost of producing and distributing a video featuring someone highly credible in the corrections field introducing A.A. to correctional personnel.

- The committee unanimously requested that the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities continue to gather and review additional sharing from area delegates and Correctional Committee, Cooperation With the Professional Community, and Bridging the Gap area chairs on the topic of introducing A.A. into training programs for correctional personnel, and that they use this information to write guidelines to present to the 2005 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for the development of workshops and training sessions on introducing A.A. to correctional personnel.

FINANCE

- The committee spent considerable time discussing sponsorship and the spiritual aspects of voluntary contributions. We agreed that membership and support of a home group is the fundamental cornerstone of A.A. Participation centered at the home group will support our primary purpose to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers.

- The committee requests that the trustees' Finance Committee review the level of delegate area participation (delegate fees and area contributions) to the General Service Conference forwarding this information to the 2005 Conference Finance Committee.



GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the draft of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook and suggested certain editorial changes be made prior to publication.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS'

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums and suggested:

1. That information regarding Regional and Special Forums emphasize that Forums can benefit *all* A.A. members and not just those members involved in general service.
2. That a small souvenir might be provided as memento of the Forum for all attendees.
3. That information regarding Regional and Special Forums be mailed earlier.
4. That areas with web sites consider linking to the General Service Office Web site in order to provide members in the area with easier access to information about Regional and Special Forums.

LITERATURE

- After lengthy discussion, the committee requested that the Publications Department rewrite the draft introduction to be added to the front matter of the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, as recommended by the 2003 General Service Conference, taking into consideration suggestions from the committee, and present it to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee following review by the trustees' Literature Committee.
- The committee considered the suggestion that the trustees' Literature Committee develop comic books for the new and younger members in the Fellowship, and took no action.

- The committee considered the request to develop a booklet for teenagers, similar to the booklets *Living Sober, Came to Believe*, and *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*, and took no action.

- The committee considered the request to restore punctuation in "Dr. Bob's Nightmare" in the Fourth Edition as it appears in the Third Edition of the Big Book and after lengthy discussion and with unified consensus, agreed to take no action.

- The committee reviewed the draft manuscript of a new comic book format pamphlet to replace the pamphlet "It Happened to Alice!" and requested that the Publications Department present a storyboard draft to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee for consideration following review by the trustees' Literature Committee. The committee made some suggestions for changes to the sample manuscript.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the trustees' Literature Committee progress report on the comprehensive review of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet recommended by the 2003 General Service Conference. The committee noted that the deadline for suggestions to changes in the pamphlet was January 2004. A draft manuscript of the revised pamphlet will be presented to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee for review.

- The committee considered the request to develop a separate and specific intergroup/central office pamphlet and took no action. The committee suggested that "The A.A. Group" pamphlet include a definition of intergroup/central offices in the section "The A.A. group's relations with others in the community" on page 33 to be taken from the "A.A. Guidelines on Central or Intergroup Offices."

- The committee considered the requested revisions to the pamphlet "Your A.A. General Service Office" pertaining to the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña and requested that the trustees' Literature Committee, in consultation with the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, review the section titled "The A.A. Grapevine" for revisions to reflect current practices and accuracy, and present a revised draft of the section to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference consider changing the reference to "personal digital assistants" to "*personal digital assistants (PDAs) with a keyboard requiring power*" in Section Definitions I. of the "Guidelines for PC Users at the General Service Conference."

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference consider forwarding a recommendation to the 2005 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions regarding the broader use of self-powered personal digital assistants (PDAs) and/or similar electronic devices with no attachments for note taking at the General Service Conference.

- The committee concurred with the A.A.W.S. Board's report indicating that the use of a CD format is the most practical method of electronically distributing Conference background material. The committee requested that the current statement of confidentiality be prominently displayed in the proposed CD format. If the CD format becomes available, the committee requested that Conference members be offered the option of receiving the General Service Conference Final Agendas and all corresponding background materials in either CD format and/or paper format.

- In response to a request from the A.A.W.S. Board, the committee encourages full Conference input on the ramifications

of electronic distribution of Conference agendas and background material.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee viewed the proposed television Public Service Announcement (P.S.A.) — “Living in Chaos” — developed by the trustees’ Public Information Committee, expressed deep appreciation for the concept and the diversity portrayed, and asked that the first segment be re-filmed and the amended version of “Living in Chaos” be forwarded to the 2005 Conference P. I. Committee.
- The committee considered centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the proposed television P.S.A. — “Living in Chaos” — at a cost not to exceed \$30,000, in addition to the work of local P.I. committees and, as there will be no new P.S.A. this year, the committee took no action.
- The committee reviewed with appreciation the information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the “We Know What It’s Like” Public Service Announcement.
- The committee requested that all Conference Areas review whether and how Alcoholics Anonymous is listed in the white pages of local phone books.
- The committee requested that the trustees’ Public Information Committee submit a report to the 2005 Conference Committee on Public Information which includes feasibility, costs and timelines for updating/replacing the two videos “A.A. — Rap With Us” and “Young People in A.A.”
- The committee requested that the trustees’ Public Information Committee review the radio Public Service Announcement, “Teenager,” spot number 6 on item #R-10, and report back to the 2005 Conference Committee on Public Information regarding the sentence “I started drinking and taking pills” in relation to the spirit of our singleness of purpose.
- The committee reviewed contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee reviewed proposed editorial changes to *The A.A. Service Manual* with appreciation, and forwarded suggestions to the Publications Department for their consideration. The committee also requested that the Publications Department consider reviewing the format and quality of the current *Service Manual*.
- The committee discussed a suggestion that the *Conference Final Report* be mailed in English, French and Spanish at the same time and took no action.
- The committee discussed the purpose and usefulness of the Eastern and Western United States, Canada and International A.A. Directories, and agreed with the 2003 Report and Charter Conference Committee that the directories continue to be useful and serve the Fellowship.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee expressed appreciation for the new three-ring binder Treatment Facilities Kit format.
- The committee reviewed the Treatment Facilities Workbook and Kit and requested that the Singleness of Purpose Statement

currently used in six Cooperation With the Professional Community pamphlets be included in the Treatment Facilities Workbook, and that the Fall/Winter 2002 and Fall 2003 issues of *About A.A.* be included in the Treatment Facilities Kit.

- The committee requested that the A.A.W.S. Board review the price of the Treatment Facilities Kit.
- The committee discussed Treatment Facilities area and district committee service work at homeless shelters, halfway houses, outpatient treatment programs, and nursing homes. Committee sharing indicated that in some areas Special Needs or Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees contact nursing home personnel; in other areas, Treatment Facilities Committees perform this valuable service work.
- The committee discussed Bridging the Gap activities, which also reflected a wide range of experience. The committee discovered that in some areas the Treatment Facilities Committee and Correctional Facilities Committee do their own Bridging the Gap work and in other areas a separate Bridging the Gap committee has this responsibility.
- The committee requested that the Treatment Facilities staff person request further shared experience on the scope of Treatment Facilities Committee activities from areas, districts, and intergroups/central offices in the U.S. and Canada.
- The committee discussed ways of carrying A.A.’s message of singleness of purpose, which includes mailing letters and making visits to treatment facilities professionals, and conducting workshops for A.A. members and professionals on what A.A. is and is not.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed its Composition, Scope and Procedure and changed the wording of item #2 under the “Scope” section to read as follows:

“The committee reviews the resumes of all newly-nominated Class A and Class B trustees of The General Service Board and nontrustee directors of the corporate boards (A.A.W.S. and The A.A. Grapevine). The committee reviews the slates of members and officers of The General Service Board and the slates of corporate board directors, before the Conference meeting, and expresses disapproval, if any.”

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for West Central and Western Canada regional trustees.

FLOOR ACTIONS WHICH DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

- That the trustees’ Committee on Correctional Facilities continue to gather and review additional sharing from area delegates and Correctional Committee, Cooperation With the Professional Community and Bridging the Gap Area chairs on the topic of introducing A.A. into *educational* programs for correctional personnel, and that they use this information to write guidelines to present to the 2005 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for the development of workshops and *education* sessions on introducing A.A. to correctional personnel.
- That the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board produce a collection of stories for young people, drawn from previous issues of the A.A. Grapevine magazine, similar to “Spiritual Awakenings.”

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION
 December 31, 2003 (with comparative totals for 2002)

	General Service Board of A.A.				A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Consolidated 2003	Consolidated 2002
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Convention Fund				
ASSETS								
Cash	\$ 824,299	\$ 833,736			\$ 370,806	\$ 288,715	\$ 2,317,556	\$2,829,685
Accounts and interest receivable		112,170			244,335	71,479	427,984	480,796
Intercompany balances	(793,215)	(1,329,685)		\$(377,531)	833,216	1,667,215	-	-
Inventories								
Books, pamphlets, etc.					1,856,479	127,582	1,984,061	2,045,763
Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.					379,478	16,892	396,370	285,501
Investments - at fair value								
U.S. Treasury Notes and Bills due 2004/2012 (Cost: 2003 - \$9,708,689, 2002 - \$10,219,376)		10,114,710					10,114,710	10,856,724
Property and Equipment								
Leasehold improvements, computer hardware and software, (net of accumulated depreciation - 2003 - \$2,917,866; 2002 - \$3,058,249)			\$717,227				717,227	410,990
Deferred charges and deposits	30,425				66,307	59,273	156,005	354,224
Prepaid conventions - 2005/2010/2015				377,531			377,531	205,469
Total Assets	61,509	9,730,931	717,227	-	3,750,621	2,231,156	16,491,444	17,469,152
LIABILITIES								
Accounts payable	\$ 4,496				\$ 795,814	\$ 220,288	\$ 1,020,598	\$ 1,135,995
Accrued royalties					33,344		33,344	34,587
Deferred income								
Orders and subscriptions					46,889	1,586,317	1,633,206	1,615,555
Accrued postretirement health benefits		\$ 3,853,682					3,853,682	3,698,152
Accrued pension benefits		\$ 1,031,575					1,031,575	1,267,255
Total Liabilities	4,496	4,885,257	\$ -	\$ -	876,047	1,806,605	7,572,405	7,751,544
Net Assets (Exhibit B)	57,013	4,845,674	717,227	-	2,874,574	424,551	8,919,039	9,717,608
Total Liabilities and Net Assets	61,509	9,730,931	717,227	-	3,750,621	2,231,156	16,491,444	17,469,152

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF ACTIVITY

Year Ended December 31, 2003 (with comparative totals for 2002)

	General Service Board of A.A.			A.A. Grapevine, Inc.				
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	A.A. World Services, Inc.	English	Spanish Magazine	Consolidated 2003	Consolidated 2002
INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE								
Gross Sales				\$ 10,769,046	\$ 2,339,998	\$ 72,552	\$ 13,181,596	\$ 13,173,981
Less: Discounts				308,578	44,200	-	352,778	329,661
Net Sales				10,460,468	2,295,798	72,552	12,828,818	12,844,320
Cost of Literature Distributed								
Printing				(4,230,102)	(448,664)	(40,531)	(4,719,297)	(4,487,936)
Royalties on books				(139,765)	-	-	(139,765)	(156,770)
Direct shipping and warehousing				(1,384,345)	(272,470)	(23,099)	(1,679,914)	(1,842,460)
Gross Profit from Literature				4,706,256	1,574,664	8,922	6,289,842	6,357,154
CONTRIBUTIONS - A.A. Groups and Members	\$ 5,100,338						5,100,338	5,097,810
INVESTMENT INCOME	991	\$ 123,933		2,194	56,850	-	183,968	768,013
Total Income	5,101,329	123,933		4,708,450	1,631,514	8,922	11,574,148	12,222,977
FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES (Exhibit C)								
Program	4,459,145			1,864,570	1,056,970	120,560	7,501,245	7,262,686
Supporting services	2,628,910	(80,150)	\$ 131,288	1,502,314	689,110	-	4,871,472	8,281,614
Total Expenses	7,088,055	(80,150)	131,288	3,366,884	1,746,080	120,560	12,372,717	15,544,300
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	(1,986,726)	204,083	(131,288)	1,341,566	(114,566)	(111,638)	(798,569)	(3,321,323)
INTERCOMPANY AND INTERFUND TRANSFERS								
GSB La Viña support	(111,638)			-	-	111,638	-	-
Other Transfer	2,098,364	(719,932)	437,525	(1,935,889)	119,932	-	-	-
CHANGE IN NET ASSETS FOR YEAR	-	(515,849)	306,237	(594,323)	5,366	-	(798,569)	(3,321,323)
NET ASSETS								
Beginning of year	57,013	5,361,523	410,990	3,468,897	419,185	-	9,717,608	13,038,931
NET ASSETS								
End of year (Exhibit A)	57,013	4,845,674	717,227	2,874,574	424,551	-	8,919,039	9,717,608

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES

Year Ended December 31, 2003 (with comparative totals for 2002)

	Group Services	Fellowship Services	General Service Conference	World Service Meeting	International Convention	Regional Forums	Publishing	Grapevine	Spanish Grapevine	Supporting Services	2003 Total	2002 Total
OPERATING EXPENSES												
Salaries	\$ 569,320	\$ 769,408	\$ 127,905		\$21,515	\$ 135,650	\$ 1,152,647	\$ 425,561	\$ 32,311	\$2,155,114	\$ 5,389,431	\$ 5,029,634
Payroll taxes	43,422	56,107	8,432		1,436	9,604	74,374	36,157	3,018	160,779	393,329	370,492
Health and group insurance	118,573	126,138	15,291		2,043	15,297	137,698	74,596	6,370	482,781	978,787	957,006
Retirement expense - funding	48,408	59,158	8,901		1,970	10,060	79,089	1,580		139,292	348,458	237,060
Other program printing	344,164	77,848	60,534			2,834	8,488			5,851	499,719	432,457
Mailing labor	88,269	2,261				14,873	-		7,712	-	113,115	161,847
Postage and express	260,351	69,222	47,842			48,494	25,395	12,887	800	48,510	513,501	485,607
Writers fees	890	51,811	7,015			4,290	46,559			-	110,565	139,087
Foreign literature assistance		159,544									159,544	207,261
Selling expenses							134,772	81,533	3,515	-	219,820	298,623
Professional fees									413	262,608	263,021	288,748
Contracted services	18,367	207,313	13,797		189	11,208	35,082	126,284	61,790	101,617	575,647	470,215
Occupancy	70,405	101,487	7,825		1,568	8,552	121,274	77,273		311,942	700,326	655,423
Telephone	15,222	12,198	2,609			1,670	15,786	13,998		60,381	121,864	111,280
Equipment maintenance	652	485					485			77,364	78,986	81,880
Furniture and equipment		8,098	773			2,030	829		1,797	48,388	61,915	90,950
Stationery and office supplies	67,550	7,404	3,415			786	5,100	43,584	580	93,803	222,222	235,933
Office service and expense	9,921	13,449	18,856		63	3,325	11,147	43,585	1,007	285,503	386,856	432,250
Travel, meals and accommodations	7,094	49,230	460,067		159	71,333	15,845		1,039	446,706	1,051,473	1,097,440
Bad debts										30,024	30,232	24,201
Delegate fees			(126,835)								(126,835)	(227,416)
Total Operating Expenses	<u>1,662,608</u>	<u>1,771,161</u>	<u>656,427</u>	<u>\$ -</u>	<u>28,943</u>	<u>340,006</u>	<u>1,864,570</u>	<u>937,038</u>	<u>120,560</u>	<u>4,710,663</u>	<u>12,091,976</u>	<u>11,579,978</u>
Postretirement health benefits										155,530	155,530	805,196
Retirement expense adjustment										(235,680)	(235,680)	2,863,362
Severance benefits										109,671	109,671	186,351
Digital Preservation Project								119,932			119,932	-
Depreciation										131,288	131,288	109,413
Total Expenses	<u>1,662,608</u>	<u>1,771,161</u>	<u>656,427</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>28,943</u>	<u>340,006</u>	<u>1,864,570</u>	<u>1,056,970</u>	<u>120,560</u>	<u>4,871,472</u>	<u>12,372,717</u>	<u>15,544,300</u>
Allocation of supporting services to activities	<u>999,266</u>	<u>1,064,508</u>	<u>394,528</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>17,395</u>	<u>204,351</u>	<u>1,502,314</u>	<u>689,110</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>(4,871,472)</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>
Total Allocated Expenses	<u>2,661,874</u>	<u>2,835,669</u>	<u>1,050,955</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>46,338</u>	<u>544,357</u>	<u>3,366,884</u>	<u>1,746,080</u>	<u>120,560</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>12,372,717</u>	<u>15,544,300</u>
Services	\$2,661,874	\$2,835,669	\$1,050,955	\$ -	\$46,338	\$544,357					\$7,139,193	\$10,959,685
Publishing	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$ 3,366,884				3,366,884	2,983,429
Grapevine	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$1,746,080	\$120,560		1,866,640	1,601,186
COMPARATIVE TOTALS - 2002	<u>\$4,103,533</u>	<u>\$4,378,465</u>	<u>\$ 1,485,745</u>	<u>\$170,962</u>	<u>\$ -</u>	<u>\$820,980</u>	<u>\$2,983,429</u>	<u>\$1,486,533</u>	<u>\$114,653</u>		<u>\$15,544,300</u>	

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
 Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows
 Year Ended December 31, 2003
 (with comparative totals for 2002)**

CASH FLOWS PROVIDED (USED)

	2003	2002
FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:		
Change in net assets for year (Exhibit B)	\$ (798,569)	\$ (3,321,323)
Realized and change in unrealized gains on investments	228,827	(240,290)
Amortization of bond premiums	5,390	10,002
Depreciation	131,288	109,413
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
Accounts receivable	52,812	76,941
Inventories	(49,167)	(371,124)
Deferred charges and other assets	26,157	(232,421)
Accounts and accruals payable	(116,640)	(549,269)
Deferred income	17,651	11,442
Accrued pension benefits	(235,680)	2,863,362
Postretirement health benefits obligation	155,530	805,196
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used)</u>		
<u>By Operating Activities</u>	<u>(582,401)</u>	<u>(838,071)</u>
FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:		
Purchases of property and equipment	(437,525)	-
Proceeds from sales of investments	9,475,130	4,241,020
Purchases of investments	(8,967,333)	(3,969,639)
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided</u>		
<u>By Investing Activities</u>	<u>70,272</u>	<u>271,381</u>
Net Increase (Decrease) in Cash	(512,129)	(566,690)
Cash, beginning of year	<u>2,829,685</u>	<u>3,396,375</u>
Cash, end of year	<u><u>2,317,556</u></u>	<u><u>2,829,685</u></u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Report of the Independent Auditor

AUDITORS' OPINION

March 1, 2004

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10015

Members of the Board:

We have audited the accompanying consolidated statement of financial position of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC., ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC., and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. as of December 31, 2003 and the related consolidated statements of activities, functional expenses and cash flows for the year then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the Organizations' management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit.

We conducted our audit in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audit provides a reasonable basis for our opinion. The prior year summarized comparative information has been derived from the Organization's December 31, 2002 consolidated financial statements, and in our report dated February 27, 2003, we expressed an unqualified opinion on those financial statements.

In our opinion, the consolidated financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the three Corporations named above as of December 31, 2003 and the changes in their net assets and their cash flows for the year then ended in conformity with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America.

Respectfully submitted,

Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants
New York, N.Y.

**THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.
NOTES TO CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
DECEMBER 31, 2003**

Note 1 Organization: The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. are not-for-profit corporations organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. Groups and coordinating the

A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world, and publishing books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to that purpose.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in four separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND — This fund was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was re-defined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That

advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held for unfulfilled subscriptions reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees upon recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

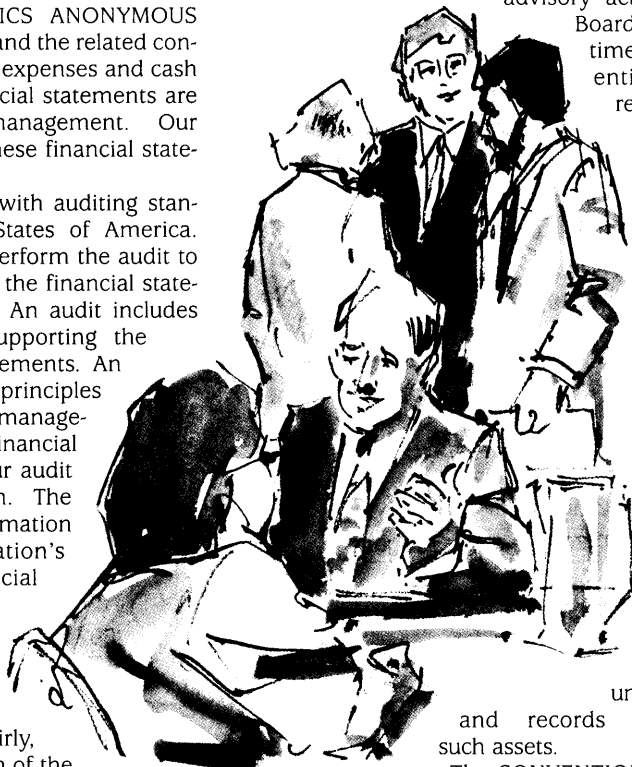
The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND — This fund accounts for the cost of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects, and records annual depreciation on such assets.

The CONVENTION FUND — A separate fund established to record the direct income and expenses of international A.A. conventions held every five years. These events are separate from the regular operations of the General Service Office, but the General Fund receives any excess of income, or pays any excess of expense, resulting from the activity.

Amounts shown as prepaid expenses in the Convention Fund on the consolidated statement of financial position represent funds paid in advance for future conventions. These costs include site selection expenses, deposits on facilities and professional convention management expenses.

From a historical perspective, the net direct result of all conventions held to date is approximately an excess of income of \$755,000, and presently resides with all other income not required for working capital in the Reserve Fund.

The GENERAL FUND — This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the Corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.



All net assets of the Corporations are free of donor restrictions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies: The Corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. The Organizations do not receive or solicit pledges, so contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Contributions received from A.A. groups and members are for the general activities of the General Service Office, and are recorded as unrestricted. Donations received from foreign A.A. entities for the international literature fund are also treated as unrestricted, as A.A.'s ongoing foreign literature assistance program satisfies the donor's condition on a current basis.

Intercompany balances and transfers have been eliminated in the consolidated totals in the accompanying financial statements. Amounts reported by A.A. World Services include Services Mondiaux Des Alcooliques Anonymes, Inc., "S.M.A.A.", a controlled non-profit Canadian corporation.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World Services. Expenses related to service activities are charged to the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been allocated based on its proportionate square footage; substantially all other expenses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

Cash: For purposes of the consolidated statement of cash flows, cash is defined as cash on hand, checking and money market accounts and short term cash investments.

Cash in excess of federally insured limits are potentially exposed to concentrations of credit risk. However, the Organization only maintains accounts with quality financial institutions with high credit standings, so as a consequence, such risks are limited.

Inventories: Inventories held are recorded at lower of cost or market under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Property and Equipment: The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated on a straight line basis over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are considered to be immaterial and are charged to expense in the year of purchase.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 2003 and the accumulated depreciation at that date:

	Life	Cost	Current Year	Accumulated Depreciation
Leasehold improvements	Terms of			
475 Riverside Drive	Leases	\$2,105,871	\$ 48,041	\$1,865,664
Furniture	8 Years	689,598		689,598
Computer - hardware	5 Years	402,099	61,371	340,728
- software	5 Years	437,525	21,876	21,876
		<u>3,635,093</u>	<u>131,288</u>	<u>2,917,866</u>

Investments: As described above, all of the investing activity of the operating entities is consolidated in the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. In accordance with established policy, the Fund invests in short or medium term U.S. Treasury Notes or Bills normally held to maturity. The investments are recorded at fair value. Gains and losses on sales or redemptions are recorded by comparison of proceeds to amortized cost on a specific identification basis.

Investment income for 2003 and 2002 is comprised of the following:

	2003	2002
Interest	\$417,378	\$532,789
Realized gains on redemptions	2,500	3,226
Change in unrealized appreciation	(231,327)	237,064
Investment expenses	(4,583)	(5,066)
	<u>183,968</u>	<u>768,013</u>

Functional Expenses: The consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C) provides detail as to program costs by major activity and supporting services. In addition to the program costs reflected on that Exhibit, amounts shown on the consolidated statement of activities (Exhibit B) as cost of literature distributed also relate to the publishing and magazine programs.

Two of the major program activities described on Exhibit C are for "Group Services" and "Fellowship Services". Group Services includes those activities most closely associated with serving A.A. groups, including the group services staff assignment, the Box 459 newsletter, directories, group records and files, the contributions department and services to French speaking groups in North America. Fellowship Services include activities outside of the group, such as public information, co-operation with the professional community, treatment and correctional facilities, archives and loners and overseas services.

Supporting services include costs of the General Service Office which can not be attributed to any specific program activity. These include administrative management, data processing and information systems, editorial and clerical support, trustee and director activities, copy center, accounting, human resources and miscellaneous administrative functions.

The allocation of supporting services to program activities on Exhibit C is done on a pro rata basis to program expenses by entity, and is provided for informational purposes only.

Fundraising costs are immaterial.

Operating Expenses: For purposes of the Statement of Functional Expenses, operating expenses are defined as recurring items requiring the current outlay of cash.

Management Estimates: The management of the Corporations uses estimates and assumptions in preparing financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America. These estimates and assumptions affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses. Actual results could vary from the estimates that management uses.

As described in Note 5 of this report, management made certain significant estimates in the calculation of liabilities for postretirement health benefits. These estimates include employee retention, health care cost trends and the actuarial lives of present and projected retirees eligible for benefits. It is reasonably possible that a change in these estimates will occur in the near term. The effect of changes in these estimates can not be determined.

Note 3 Retirement Plan: The Organizations adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible U.S. employees who have completed one year of service.

The plan provides an annual benefit equal to 2% of final average compensation multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 35 years), less 0.65% of average social security earnings multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 30 years). The social security offset can not reduce the gross benefit by more than 50%.

Pension expense is recorded in accordance with SFAS 87, in which costs are accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon factors which are not necessarily the same as those used to calculate the annual funding requirements. In addition, SFAS 87 requires, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the Organization's balance sheet depending upon a comparison of the Plan's assets to its benefit obligations.

The contributions made to fund pension benefits are recorded by the operating companies as an expense. The difference between the amounts actually paid and the net periodic pension cost under SFAS 87 is recorded by the Reserve Fund as an adjustment to retirement expense since it is a non-cash item that does not affect current operations.

The following tables set forth the Plan's funded status, assumptions, benefit cost and payments and employer contributions for 2003:

Fair value of plan assets (at December 31)	\$ 11,462,310
Benefit obligation (at December 31)	<u>15,008,630</u>
Funded status	<u>(3,546,320)</u>
Accrued pension cost recognized in consolidated statement of financial position	<u>\$ 1,031,575</u>

The difference between the Plan's funded status and recognized pension benefit liability is attributable to deferral and amortization of Plan assets and obligations as prescribed under SFAS 87, as well as unrecognized actuarial losses.

Weighted-average assumptions (at December 31)	
Discount rate	6.75%
Expected return on plan assets	9.0%
Rate of compensation increase	5.0%
Benefit cost	\$67,746
Employers' contributions	\$ 303,426
Benefits paid	\$ 954,302

The benefit cost for 2002 included \$1,156,159 for the one-time pension cost of the early retirement program (described below), and \$1,267,255 to recognize the excess of the accumulated benefit obligation over the plan assets.

Classification of benefit costs:	
Operating expense (cash funding)	\$ 303,426
Non-operating expense (non-cash adjustment to pension cost)	<u>(235,680)</u>
	<u>67,746</u>

Plan assets at December 31, 2003 were composed as follows:

Short term cash and receivables	\$ 240,151
Common stocks	6,025,741
Government bonds	2,868,881
Corporate and other bonds	<u>2,327,537</u>
	<u>11,462,310</u>

Employees of S.M.A.A. in Canada participate in a separate retirement plan under which 5% of their annual salaries are contributed by that Organization.

Effective September 4, 2001 the General Service Board approved an early retirement "window" for A.A.W.S. and General Service Board employees. Employees age 55 or older with combined age and service of 70 or more are eligible. Participating employees receive a higher pension benefit by adding five years of age up to age 65, and a temporary Social Security supplement up to age 62. Severance pay was also provided based on years of service, and was borne by the General Service Board.

The program was voluntary. The expiration date of the window was March 29, 2002.

Severance benefits under this program of \$186,351 were incurred in 2002. Severance costs of \$109,761 incurred in 2003 related to the termination of two employees during that year, and were unrelated to the early retirement program.

Note 4 Lease Commitments: At December 31, 2003, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$471,128 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008.

\$97,915 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January

1, 1999 through December 31, 2008.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 2003 is \$2,845,000.

Note 5 Postretirement Health Benefits: The Corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they attain retirement age while working at the General Service Office. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the Corporations, 25% of the cost of which is borne by the retirees.

The plan is unfunded. The assumed health care cost trend rate used to measure the expected cost of benefits covered by the plan is 5%. A discount rate of 6.75% has been used to measure the accrued postretirement health benefit obligation shown on Exhibit B. The following table sets forth the information regarding the Plan for 2003:

Benefit obligation (at December 31)	\$3,853,682
Benefit cost	<u>\$ 344,173</u>
Benefits paid	<u>\$ 188,643</u>

The excess of cost of benefits over the payments for benefits of \$155,530 has been reported on Exhibit C as a non-operating expense since it does not affect the current outlay of cash.

Note 6 Tax Status: The Organizations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c) (3) of the Internal Revenue Code, and are classified as public charities. They are also exempt from New York State franchise and sales taxes.

The Budget Highlights

2004 G.S.O. Budget

This budget describes the "OPERATIONS" of the General Service Office. It includes expenses of A.A. World Services (the Publishing operation) and the General Fund (Service activities). It excludes any activities reported separately in the Reserve Fund, Convention Fund, or the Capital Projects Fund. The Grapevine operations are described below in a separate report.

Income: The 2004 budget projects net sales of \$10,666,700, an increase of approximately \$200,000 (2%) over 2003, and includes the restoration of the price of the Big Book to \$6.00, effective 7/1/04. After accounting for leveling in unit sales of the 4th edition and the anthology, *Experience, Strength and Hope*, sales of other products are expected to be flat. It should be remembered that the price of the 4th edition was set at \$5.00 vs. \$6.00, thus specifically reducing the expected Gross Profit with a goal of reducing the Reserve Fund. It was expected that, depending on contributions, the price would be restored in a few years.

Manufacturing costs are budgeted approximately \$400,000 less than 2003 for a variety of reasons. Part of the reduction allows for a mix of costs resulting from the expected leveling of 4th edition and Anthology sales. Some is attributable to estimates for better cost of product and some is due to the absence in 2004 of "write offs for slow moving and foreign language inventory items." Royalties are budgeted at \$145,000.

Shipping and warehousing costs are budgeted approximately even with 2003. While there may be expected increases in operational costs due to inflationary pressures, the expected leveling of 4th edition and Anthology sales noted previously as well as absence of comparative costs incurred when we changed warehouses in 2003, result in the expected level costs for 2004.

After subtracting manufacturing costs, royalties and shipping expense, gross profit is budgeted at \$5,378,000 (approximately \$670,000 more than 2003), 50.4% compared with \$4,706,250, or 45%, for 2003. It should also be remembered that as we continue to strive to have literature available — for our Service Conference in the Spanish and French languages as well as English, lower print runs in those languages result in higher production costs. Because we strive to have similar selling prices regardless of our manufacturing cost, lower overall gross profits are expected to result.

Prudence dictates that even though contribution revenue has seen favorable upward movement during the last several years, it is time to restore the revenue stream. Trusted servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations as well as assess the services supplied.

Contributions for 2004 have been budgeted at \$5,175,000. Contribution for the year 2003 were just slightly ahead of 2002, and was the fifth year in a row that contributions received exceeded the prior year. During 2003, contributions from groups and individuals of \$4,997,400 were \$102,600 (2%) less than budgeted but \$6,000 (less than 1%) greater than 2002. For 2003, contributions had been budgeted to increase by about 2%. During 2002, we were obliged to record funds received on behalf of the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund as Contributions to G.S.O., therefore total year 2003 contributions of \$5,100,300 are reflected on our financial statements and include approximately \$103,000 received to help carry the message around the world from those participating countries. This compares with \$107,500 received during 2002 from countries around the world.

Total Operating Revenue for the period is anticipated at \$10,556,100, approximately 8% more than the 2003 budget.

Total Operating Expenses for 2004 have been budgeted at \$11,174,300, approximately \$720,000 6.8% higher than 2003 but only \$488,000 or 4.5% more than the 2003 budget. This years larger than usual increase includes increased expenditures to help carry the message worldwide as well as at home

For 2004 G.S.O. has budgeted excess of expenses over revenue of \$618,200; this compares with an actual loss for 2003 of \$645,160, and the \$950,850 loss budgeted.

The G.S.O. operating losses as well as other withdrawals from the Reserve Fund (La Viña, Computer projects, GV losses etc) all have worked to reduce the Reserve Fund balance.

2004 Grapevine Budget

The 2004 Grapevine Budget calls for an average circulation of 112,667, approximately 2,300 copies less than the 2003 budget and just about even with the 2003 paid circulation number of 112,614. Circulation for 2002 was 115,753, 2001 was 115,034, 115,734 in 2000, 116,000 in 1999 and 117,300 in 1998.

Income: Magazine income of \$1,701,500 is expected, about \$10,000 more than 2003. Other Publishing Income from books, cassette tapes, and miscellaneous items is budgeted at \$759,000, approximately \$155,000 higher than 2003. The increase in the "other items" category anticipates sales of new products.

Total Gross Profit: Combining the magazine and other publishing items, the gross profit of \$1,746,100 is budgeted compared to \$1,574,700 achieved for 2003 and the 2003 budget of \$1,566,000.

Total Operating Expenses: Total Operating Expenses for 2004 are budgeted at \$1,693,000, approximately \$67,000 more than the 2003 actual of \$1,626,148.

Net Income: For 2004 the Grapevine anticipates a profit of \$105,100. This compares with a 2003 budgeted profit of \$4,358 and an actual profit from operations of \$5,366.

2004 Spanish Grapevine Budget

Following the 1995 General Service Conference Advisory Action #7, the publication of the Grapevine magazine in Spanish, La Viña, was approved by the Grapevine Board of Directors and the trustees' Finance Committee of the General Service Board. Recognizing this publication as a new venture, both boards will review the financial impact on the Fellowship and the progress of circulation and continue to monitor the viability of this venture. In 2001 The Board recommended and the 2001 Conference approved that the Spanish magazine continue to be published by the Grapevine but funded by the General Fund instead of continuing to draw funds from the Reserve Fund.

For 2004 La Viña expects a gross profit of \$13,418, compared with a \$8,922 gross profit for 2003. Circulation for 2004 is estimated at 9,500, slightly higher than the 2003 average of 9,222. Total costs and expenses are estimated at \$132,113 for 2004, compared with \$120,560 for 2003, \$114,655 in 2002, \$127,578 in 2001, and \$62,137 in 2000. The 2004 budget projects a net loss of \$118,695 compared with a loss of \$111,638 for 2003, \$103,815 in 2002, a \$119,385 loss for 2001 and a 2001 budgeted loss of \$63,116.

To date the La Viña project has incurred start-up costs/operating losses of \$779,744 as follows: \$29,500 in 1995, \$138,290 in 1996, \$102,140 in 1997, \$66,182 in 1998, \$59,224 in 1999, \$49,570 in 2000, \$119,385 in 2001, \$103,815 in 2002, and \$111,638 in 2003.

The General Service Office 2004 OPERATING BUDGET

INCOME	2003 Budget	2003 Actual	2004 Budget
GROSS SALES	\$10,443,300	\$10,769,046	\$10,975,700
Discounts allowed	282,600	308,578	309,000
<u>Net Sales</u>	10,160,700	10,460,468	10,666,700
Cost of Literature Distributed			
Manufacturing	4,242,200	4,230,102	3,800,000
Royalties	160,000	139,765	145,000
<u>Gross Margin</u>	5,758,500	6,090,601	6,721,700
DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING	1,152,060	1,384,349	1,343,600
<u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>	4,606,440	4,706,252	5,378,100
Contributions Received	5,125,000	5,100,338	5,175,000
Interest Income	4,500	3,187	3,000
<u>Total Revenue</u>	9,735,940	9,809,777	10,556,100
OPERATING EXPENSES			
Salaries	4,698,000	4,677,077	4,882,500
Payroll taxes	324,000	331,425	332,500
Insurance	888,000	838,815	898,500
Retirement expense	239,800	345,286	321,000
Other program printing	418,900	499,719	504,200
Mailing, labor, etc.	163,700	125,176	134,300
Postage & express	478,600	480,040	496,750
Writers' fees	169,500	110,565	109,500
Other literature assist	306,060	160,214	267,500
Selling expenses	107,500	134,102	125,700
Professional fees	225,000	195,857	179,000
Contracted services	361,600	387,573	388,100
Occupancy	564,600	586,437	606,966
Telephone	109,200	102,702	114,000
Equipment maintenance	102,750	78,986	182,300
Furniture & equipment	56,500	35,848	53,000
Stationery & office expense	218,600	178,059	179,850
Office service & expense	384,275	322,782	393,575
Travel, meals, & accommodations	860,200	856,581	995,100
Bad debts	10,000	7,693	10,000
TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES	10,686,785	10,454,937	11,174,341
INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD	(950,845)	(645,160)	(618,241)

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

2004 BUDGET

	ENGLISH			SPANISH		
	2003 Budget	2003 Actual	2004 Budget	2003 Budget	2003 Actual	2004 Budget
PAID CIRCULATION —						
AVERAGE # OF COPIES	<u>115,000</u>	<u>112,614</u>	<u>112,667</u>	<u>9,500</u>	<u>9,222</u>	<u>9,500</u>
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE						
Subscription income	\$1,706,160	\$1,642,678	\$1,652,543	\$69,169	\$67,152	\$67,500
Single copies and back issues	<u>51,600</u>	<u>48,789</u>	<u>49,000</u>	<u>9,000</u>	<u>5,400</u>	<u>15,520</u>
<u>Total magazine income</u>	<u>1,757,760</u>	<u>1,691,467</u>	<u>1,701,543</u>	<u>78,169</u>	<u>72,552</u>	<u>83,020</u>
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>578,200</u>	<u>535,315</u>	<u>465,334</u>	<u>67,476</u>	<u>63,630</u>	<u>69,602</u>
Gross Profit on Magazine	<u>1,179,560</u>	<u>1,156,152</u>	<u>1,236,209</u>	<u>10,693</u>	<u>8,922</u>	<u>13,418</u>
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	617,979	604,331	758,999			
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>231,546</u>	<u>185,819</u>	<u>249,138</u>			
Gross Profit on Special Items	<u>386,433</u>	<u>418,512</u>	<u>509,861</u>			
Total Gross Profit	<u>1,565,993</u>	<u>1,574,664</u>	<u>1,746,070</u>			
COSTS AND EXPENSES						
EDITORIAL COSTS						
Salaries, including temporary help	279,000	284,316	336,267	68,000	61,789	67,683
Payroll taxes and benefits	67,444	66,069	86,130			
Occupancy costs	68,052	68,075	71,122	0	0	0
Office supplies and expenses	23,500	29,981	26,454	2,000	1,160	1,200
Product development	20,000	17,206	10,000	0	0	0
<u>Total Editorial</u>	<u>457,996</u>	<u>465,647</u>	<u>529,973</u>	<u>70,000</u>	<u>62,949</u>	<u>68,883</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS						
Salaries, including temporary help	421,978	395,726	430,939	32,616	32,311	33,694
Payroll taxes and benefits	127,261	129,591	134,278	8,726	9,388	10,015
Kable fulfillment	123,000	109,078	109,000	8,100	7,712	6,962
Occupancy costs	67,752	64,974	68,090	0	0	0
Office supplies and expenses	43,180	57,188	52,455	0	0	0
Subscriber services	2,000	0	0	0	0	0
Selling expense-regular	125,000	60,491	49,700	13,000	3,515	7,815
-GvR program	50,000	21,042	105,150	0	0	0
Postage	9,000	12,887	12,818	0	800	1,200
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>	<u>969,171</u>	<u>850,977</u>	<u>962,430</u>	<u>62,442</u>	<u>53,726</u>	<u>59,686</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE						
One-time charges	0	109,671	0	0	0	0
Insurance	4,920	4,111	4,891	360	428	470
Professional fees	59,508	66,751	71,103	600	413	413
Meetings and conferences	65,000	67,019	54,242	0	1,039	2,500
Furniture and equipment	40,000	24,270	43,725	2,500	1,797	0
Canadian exchange and other	10,000	3,712	5,440	0	0	0
Bank service charges	3,600	11,660	7,500	0	0	0
Bad debts	20,000	22,330	13,712	600	208	161
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>	<u>203,028</u>	<u>309,524</u>	<u>200,613</u>	<u>4,060</u>	<u>3,885</u>	<u>3,544</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>1,630,195</u>	<u>1,626,148</u>	<u>1,693,016</u>	<u>136,502</u>	<u>120,560</u>	<u>132,113</u>
Interest earned	<u>68,560</u>	<u>56,850</u>	<u>52,050</u>			
NET INCOME (Loss) FOR PERIOD	<u>4,358</u>	<u>5,366</u>	<u>105,104</u>	<u>(125,809)</u>	<u>(111,638)</u>	<u>(118,695)</u>

2003 Contributions From Groups, Individuals, Specials, Special Meetings

by Delegate Area (in U.S. Dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTIONS PER CAPITA	INDIVIDUAL MEMBERS	MEMORIAL	SPECIALS	SPECIAL MEETINGS	TOTAL AREA CONTRIBUTIONS	PER CAPITA
01.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	413	214	51.8 %	37,522	8,384	\$4.47	501		1,147	133	\$39,302.20	\$4.69
02.	Alaska	184	83	45.1	15,588	3,284	4.75	204		470		\$16,262.17	\$4.95
03.	Arizona	866	369	42.5	85,158	20,262	4.20	5,162	150	2,019	346	\$92,833.82	\$4.58
04.	Arkansas	242	135	55.7	16,322	4,478	3.63	491		1,436	994	\$19,243.29	\$4.30
	California												
05.	Southern	1,131	420	37.0	97,525	39,500	2.46	10,254	125	1,058	1,231	\$110,192.41	\$2.79
06.	N. Coastal	1,792	1,085	60.4	237,206	54,723	4.33	13,470	6,010	8,658	994	\$266,338.79	\$4.87
07.	N. Interior	764	373	48.7	73,608	20,321	3.62	574	40	3,523	102	\$77,847.41	\$3.83
08.	San Diego/Imp.	797	335	41.9	69,763	24,363	2.86	6,569	275	804	231	\$77,641.98	\$3.19
09.	Mid-South.	1,834	759	41.4	157,903	58,414	2.70	7,995		2,338	737	\$168,972.90	\$2.89
10.	Colorado	644	353	54.8	76,089	15,060	5.04	5,041	300	17,434	123	\$98,987.61	\$6.57
11.	Connecticut	1,423	576	40.4	83,954	35,131	2.39	6,843	2,187	18,440	155	\$111,578.83	\$3.18
12.	Delaware	204	127	62.2	31,297	3,307	9.46	131		147		\$31,575.63	\$9.55
13.	D.C.	459	210	45.7	42,640	15,008	2.84	249				\$42,888.42	\$2.86
	Florida												
14.	North	739	390	52.7	76,435	16,119	4.73	2,458	335	10,693	3	\$89,924.40	\$5.58
15.	South/	1,612	814	50.5	192,745	36,515	5.28	7,202	85	21,394	1,219	\$222,645.68	\$6.10
16.	Georgia	703	439	62.4	81,093	15,873	5.11	4,720	2,883	306		\$89,001.59	\$5.61
17.	Hawaii	265	154	58.0	29,548	5,004	5.89	636	100	2,076		\$32,359.95	\$6.47
18.	Idaho	205	112	54.6	17,182	3,669	4.67	174		531	70	\$17,957.12	\$4.89
	Illinois												
19.	Chicago	1,200	311	25.9	68,970	29,585	2.32	2,605	100	2,771	560	\$75,004.82	\$2.54
20.	North	1,108	422	38.1	54,615	22,667	2.40	2,252	285	40,594	100	\$97,845.58	\$4.32
21.	South	441	166	37.5	26,881	7,550	3.55	274	820	3,428		\$31,403.05	\$4.16
	Indiana												
22.	North	653	268	41.0	35,785	9,449	3.79	758		2,084	50	\$38,676.80	\$4.09
23.	South	579	266	45.9	36,503	10,221	3.57	812		10	30	\$37,354.45	\$3.65
24.	Iowa	635	286	45.0	41,158	13,462	3.05	362		350	25	\$41,894.35	\$3.11
25.	Kansas	368	187	50.8	26,562	9,342	2.83	1,048	300	3,350		\$31,260.67	\$3.35
26.	Kentucky	679	301	44.2	63,413	11,001	5.76	2,747	2,000	7,421	420	\$76,001.04	\$6.91
27.	Louisiana	547	182	33.2	31,072	11,375	2.72	349		594		\$32,014.65	\$2.81
28.	Maine	451	160	35.4	15,993	7,731	2.06	958		1,537	87	\$18,575.33	\$2.40
29.	Maryland	945	392	41.4	72,220	15,421	4.67	3,935	100	1,178	30	\$77,463.07	\$5.02
	Massachusetts												
30.	East	1,449	537	37.0	110,408	49,253	2.23	3,589	25	1,472	25	\$115,520.00	\$2.35
31.	West	248	140	56.4	18,472	4,673	3.94	644				\$19,116.74	\$4.09
	Michigan												
32.	Central	563	254	45.0	43,206	13,483	3.20	1,443	5	1,394		\$46,048.19	\$3.42
33.	Southeast	774	307	39.6	66,167	18,883	3.50	1,941		700	256	\$69,063.47	\$3.66
34.	West	506	217	42.8	44,225	10,907	4.04	1,162	150	2,306		\$47,843.15	\$4.39
	Minnesota												
35.	North	534	224	41.9	22,230	8,305	2.67	1,333	50	2,420	39	\$26,071.79	\$3.14
36.	South	976	436	44.7	67,826	23,306	2.91	1,326	1,112	1,590	30	\$71,884.38	\$3.08
37.	Mississippi	228	92	40.4	12,698	4,453	2.85	204	25	820		\$13,746.12	\$3.09
	Missouri												
38.	East	520	269	51.6	49,514	8,873	5.58	5,426		880		\$55,820.40	\$6.29
39.	West	207	106	51.1	16,765	6,226	2.69	284		90	150	\$17,289.25	\$2.78
40.	Montana	285	117	41.0	18,103	4,522	4.00	175		902		\$19,179.63	\$4.24
41.	Nebraska	671	335	49.8	49,145	14,964	3.27	454	20	6,000		\$55,618.88	\$3.72
42.	Nevada	478	188	39.3	27,460	11,239	2.43	666	2,000	1,028	90	\$31,243.85	\$2.78
43.	New Hampshire	560	234	41.8	31,297	10,465	2.99	653	25	3,062	59	\$35,095.60	\$3.35
	New Jersey												
44.	North	1,282	487	38.0	86,529	31,847	2.71	6,065	500	1,813	50	\$94,956.60	\$2.98
45.	South	511	245	47.9	57,423	8,693	6.61	2,305	2,181	200	75	\$62,183.82	\$7.15
46.	New Mexico	320	179	55.8	28,318	5,986	4.72	306	15	3,972	80	\$32,690.28	\$5.46
	New York												
47.	Central	706	244	34.5	39,915	11,400	3.49	1,933	388	250	28	\$42,514.36	\$3.73
48.	H./M./B.	704	289	41.1	34,445	10,986	3.14	654	2,500	4,977	40	\$42,616.20	\$3.88
49.	Southeast	1,747	699	39.9	203,450	57,256	3.55	8,348	10,046	4,909	505	\$227,258.39	\$3.97
50.	West	330	92	27.8	12,172	6,108	1.98	328	657	135		\$13,291.06	\$2.18
51.	N. Carolina	909	445	48.9	87,618	14,857	5.89	2,574	2,300	2,100		\$94,592.26	\$6.37
52.	North Dakota	153	73	47.6	11,424	3,067	3.71			1,140		\$12,563.85	\$4.10
	Ohio												
53.	Cent. & S.E.	642	210	32.7	28,034	9,567	2.93	501	25	220		\$28,780.55	\$3.01
54.	Northeast	1,421	343	24.1	40,766	22,589	1.79	318		5,072		\$46,155.11	\$2.04
55.	N.W. Ohio/ S.E. Mich.	282	91	32.2	11,535	4,159	2.76	197		834		\$12,565.14	\$3.02
56.	S.W. Ohio	518	233	44.9	38,423	10,662	3.59	900		77		\$39,400.40	\$3.70
57.	Oklahoma	380	193	50.7	30,403	6,671	4.55	1,194	50	582	10	\$32,239.81	\$4.83
58.	Oregon	855	388	45.4	59,615	17,214	3.45	3,499	108	1,677	52	\$64,951.24	\$3.77

Pennsylvania													
59.	East	1,417	693	48.9	140,528	31,742	4.42	279	4,081	4,137	1,037	\$150,062.49	\$4.73
60.	West	802	379	47.3	45,076	11,329	3.97	3,938	75	2,550		\$51,638.92	\$4.56
61.	Rhode Island	251	120	47.7	19,680	5,383	3.65	303		1,836		\$21,819.35	\$4.05
62.	South Carolina	321	183	56.9	42,149	6,895	6.10	1,096	262	3,286		\$46,793.37	\$6.79
63.	South Dakota	162	59	36.4	6,918	3,744	1.84	137	700	367		\$8,122.20	\$2.17
64.	Tennessee	478	226	47.2	44,255	10,895	4.06	227	20	230		\$44,732.22	\$4.11
Texas													
65.	Northeast	469	198	42.1	55,745	19,869	2.81	930		1,021		\$57,696.09	\$2.90
66.	Northwest	221	72	32.5	16,623	5,252	3.16	614		2,112		\$19,348.98	\$3.68
67.	Southeast	537	254	47.3	53,132	15,819	3.35	2,574		3,173	36	\$58,915.78	\$3.72
68.	Southwest	485	220	45.3	39,631	11,497	3.44	1,258	30	656		\$41,574.90	\$3.62
69.	Utah	250	166	66.3	28,776	5,288	5.44	1,697		4		\$30,478.03	\$5.76
70.	Vermont	248	112	45.1	15,351	4,625	3.32	3,808	30	150		\$19,339.23	\$4.18
71.	Virginia	1,171	612	52.2	109,135	22,235	4.90	4,496	475	2,014	335	\$116,454.62	\$5.24
72.	Western Washington	1,126	532	47.2	100,894	24,888	4.04	3,069	170	26,085	35	\$130,253.15	\$5.23
73.	West Virginia	290	133	45.9	13,528	3,263	4.15	116	25	1,150		\$14,818.42	\$4.54
Wisconsin													
74.	N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.	663	273	41.2	26,560	10,791	2.45	2,782	60			\$29,401.38	\$2.72
75.	South	941	398	42.3	43,837	17,759	2.47	762	177	1,086	25	\$45,886.77	\$2.58
76.	Wyoming	106	58	54.7	8,967	1,872	4.78	5		706		\$9,677.85	\$5.17
77.	Puerto Rico	128	68	53.1	6,186	1,481	4.18					\$6,186.00	\$4.18
78.	Alberta/N.W.T.	500	217	43.4	34,226	8,335	4.11	40		1,755	4	\$36,024.20	\$4.32
79.	B.C./Yukon	722	370	51.2	60,195	14,101	4.26	987		1,066	37	\$62,285.24	\$4.42
80.	Manitoba	148	52	35.1	5,801	3,871	1.50	18		145		\$5,964.19	\$1.54
81.	N.B./P.E.I.	190	79	41.5	7,624	3,439	2.22	66		413		\$8,103.12	\$2.36
82.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	246	105	42.7	7,684	3,259	2.36	33		1,428		\$9,144.61	\$2.81
Ontario													
83.	East	564	244	43.2	42,119	14,455	2.90	49		6,715	432	\$49,315.65	\$3.41
84.	Northeast	166	69	41.5	10,472	2,155	4.86	22	19	1,469		\$11,982.36	\$5.56
85.	Northwest	74	16	21.6	2,153	1,230	1.74	21		298		\$2,471.22	\$2.01
86.	West	532	193	36.3	32,700	10,040	3.26	1,834		3,786	378	\$38,698.47	\$3.85
Quebec (1)													
87.	Southwest	553	376	67.9	11,288	15,613	0.71	643		13,608		\$25,540.17	\$1.64
88.	Southeast	189	138	73.0	1,465	2,982	0.48	15		20,412		\$21,891.82	\$7.34
89.	Northeast	341	291	85.2	3,620	6,729	0.53	145		17,997		\$21,761.19	\$3.23
90.	Northwest	362	318	87.7	2,018	6,661	0.29	442		26,530		\$28,990.59	\$4.35
91.	Saskatchewan	297	99	33.3	10,917	3,576	3.05	212		2,759	112	\$14,000.22	\$3.92
92.	Washington East	470	167	35.5	16,056	6,403	2.50	189	25	1,320	48	\$17,637.73	\$2.75
93.	Central Calif	842	383	45.5	73,863	22,317	3.30	3,586		1,287	310	\$79,047.00	\$3.54
	Total U.S./Canada	56,904	25,429	44.7	\$4,381,508.48	1,277,626	3.43	\$173,589.30	\$44,425.43	\$357,961.52	\$11,921.33	\$4,969,406.06	\$3.89
Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings					229,936.06								
Specials					357,961.52								
Total for U.S. & Canada					4,969,406.06								
FOREIGN AND OTHER													
On Line Meetings					421.32								\$421.32
Correctional & Hospital facility groups					419.57								\$419.57
Foreign					123,536.70								\$123,536.70
Internationalists					20.00								\$20.00
Loners					339.32								\$339.32
Birds of a Feather					1,165.00								\$1,165.00
International Doctors in A.A.					5,000.00								\$5,000.00
Grand Total					\$5,100,307.97								\$5,100,307.97

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON - 2003-2002(in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS.% REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTIONS PER CAPITA	TOTAL PER CAPITA INCLUDING SPECIALS ETC		
U.S. & Canada 2003	56,904	25,429	44.7%	\$4,381,508.48	1,277,626	\$3.43	\$3.89		
U.S. & Canada 2002	56,629	25,761	45.5%	\$4,280,619.92	1,265,090	\$3.38	\$3.93		
Increase (Decrease)	275	(332)	-0.8%	\$100,888.56	12,536	\$0.05	(\$0.04)	NEW FOR 2002 EST. COST OF SERVICES PER CAPITA	2003 \$5.55 2002 \$5.68

¹ Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed through their Conference Areas (per info from areas)

2004 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Jimmy Jack Bailey
²Clarke Brown
 Donald Cusson
 Laurie Emhe
¹Earl Fink
 Corliss Gibbons
 Jim Irwin
 Mike Young

Secretary: Bill Archer

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Walter Covert
²Irving Doucet
 Claude Lieutenent
 Mike McMurtrie
¹Paul C. Mijares
 Jeanine Rios
 Connie Shockey
 Terry Whelan

Secretary: Rick Walker

Correctional Facilities

Eric Bothun
 Milton Casey
 Paul Coonce
 Skip Do Moe
²Terry Flynn
 Jo A. McLaughlin
 Jacki Perry
¹Joe Pineda
 Mary Alice Sanderson

Secretary: Mary Clare Lynch

Finance

Mike Foster
²Teresa Frohock
¹Dick Grunloh
 Eddie Harris
 Don Mollins
 Ray Nault
 Gale Plancon
 Dave Pratt

Secretary: Donald Meurer

Grapevine

Dick Anderson
 Clay Cutten
 Robin Fewings
 Regan Gawan
¹Mike Lewis
 Jutta Matthews
²Jim Parili
 Andy Talbert
 Steve Walker

Secretary: Robin Bromley

Literature

Brent Brown
²Doug Grude
 Jan Lembke
¹Brenda Lindgren
 Dan Mix
 Lalo Montalvo
 Victor Philips
 Buck Rose
 John Warren

Secretary: Eva Sanchez

Policy/Admissions

Marc Jones
 Nancy Kunkel
²Réal Laforest
 Randy Magnus
 Don Myers
 Enna Rodas
 Hank Schmitz
¹Kathy Smith
 Dennis Soto

Secretary: Valerie O'Neill

Public Information

Don Bennitt
 Oran Clemons
 O'Dell Holloway
 Nancy Jensen
¹Maureen Maguire
 Torv Theisen
 Mark Thomas
²Paul Walker

Secretary: Gayle Solheim Riese

Report and Charter

²Barbara Bridges
 Charlie Craven
 Jean Gagner
 Catherine Glosser
 Mark Greider
 Jim McDonald
 Jerry Moore
¹Jack Ottinger
 Dan Stasinski

Secretary: Julio Espailat

Treatment Facilities

Beth Davidson
¹Jodi Ericson
 Gary Gramman
 Perry Grosz
²Nancy Keohane
 Elizabeth Kepner
 Bruce Landolt
 Roy Robertson

Secretary: Irene Kontje

Trustees

Don Anderson
²Ruth Barth
¹Chuck Berry
 Cindy Coffelt
 John Ferriter
 Wanda Halverson
 Marie Hamilton
 Dave Manson

Secretary: Warren Stafford

³International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

¹Don Bennitt
 Cindy Coffelt
 Jodi Ericson
²Wanda Halverson
 Randy Magnus
 Don Myers
 Ray Nault
 Jim Parili

Co-Secretaries:
 Doug Richardson
 Warren Stafford

³Archives

Chuck Berry
²Beth Davidson
 Regan Gawan
 Gary Gramman
 Brenda Lindgren
 Don Mollins
 Roy Robertson
²Paul Walker

Secretary: Judit Santon

2005 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS⁴

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Agenda	Laurie Emhe, So. New Jersey	Mike Young, W. Michigan
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Mike McMurtie, Washington East	Connie Shockey, Nebraska
Correctional Facilities	Jacki Perry, Vermont	Milton Casey, Tennessee
Finance	Ray Nault, South Carolina	Dave Pratt, Rhode Island
Grapevine	Steven Walker, NY, Hudson, Mohawk/Berkshire	Regan Gawan, Arizona
Literature	Victor Phillips, Alberta/NWT	Buck Rose, Delaware
Policy/Admissions	Marc Jones, California, San Diego/Imperial	Nancy Kunkel, Maryland
Public Information	Oran Clemons, New Mexico	Torv Theisen, No. Wisconsin/Upper Peninsula Michigan
Report and Charter	Jean Gagner, SW Quebec	Charlie Craven, No. Minnesota
Treatment Facilities	Elizabeth Kepner, Mississippi	Bruce Landolt, Oregon
Trustees	Cindy Coffelt, NW Texas	Dave Manson, Alaska
³ International Conv./Regional Forums	Randy Magnus, Saskatchewan	Don Myers, Wyoming
³ Archives	Regan Gawan, Arizona	Gary Gramman, So. Indiana

¹Chairperson

²Alternate Chairperson

³Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

⁴The 2004 committee chairs rotated at the end of the 54th General Service Conference.

2004 Trustees' Committees**

Archives

Ric Downey, *chairperson*
Leonard Blumenthal
Paul Cleary
Gary Kluksdahl
Arnold Ross
John Skilton
Ted Stoa
Judit Santon, *secretary*

Conference

Ron Gauthier, *chairperson*
Allen Ault
Susan Campbell
Paul Cleary
David Every
Herbert Goodman
John Koster
Arnold Ross
John Skilton
Bill Archer, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities

Alan Ault, *chairperson*
Phyllis Halliday
Gary Kluksdahl
John Koster
*Irene Meisel
Bob Pelot
George Vaillant
Rick Walker, *secretary* —C.P.C.
Irene Kontje, *secretary*
—Treatment Facilities

Correctional Facilities

Leonard Blumenthal, *chairperson*
Alan Ault
Charlie Bartell
Paul Cleary
*William Herold
*Jane Starke Lobdell
Don Miller
Mike Perry
Ted Stoa
Mary Clare Lynch, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Vince Keefe, *chairperson*
Susan Campbell
Dick Gallagher
Ron Gauthier
Herbert Goodman
Dorothy May
Don Miller
Arnold Ross
Ted Stoa
Kevin Sunkel
consultant/independent auditor
Donald Meurer, *secretary*

International

Charles Bartell, *chairperson*
Susan Campbell
David Every
Ron Gauthier
Murray McIntosh
Raymond Massey
Dorothy May
Bob Pelot
George E. Vaillant
Adrienne Brown, *secretary*

International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums

Phyllis Halliday, *chairperson*
Leonard Blumenthal
Ric Downey
Vince Keefe
Murray McIntosh
Ray Massey
Don Miller
Mike Perry
Jane Sheppard
Doug Richardson, *secretary*
— International Convention
Warren Stafford, *secretary*
—Regional Forums

Literature

David Every, *chairperson*
Charles Bartell
Dick Gallagher
Murray McIntosh
Ray Massey
Mike Perry
*Ray Reese
Jane Sheppard
Christopher Cavanaugh, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
Eva Sanchez, *secretary*

Nominating

Ted Stoa, *chairperson*
Allen Ault
Ric Downey
Phyllis Halliday
Vince Keefe
John Koster
George Vaillant
Warrent Stafford, *secretary*

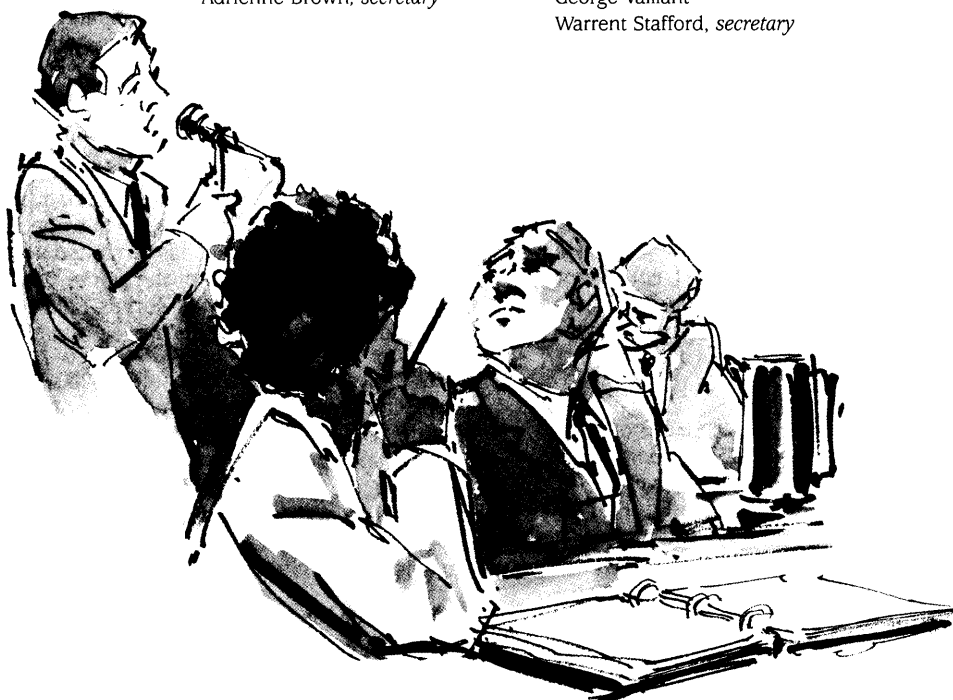
Public Information

Bob Pelot, *chairperson*,
*Martin Clancy
Gary Kluksdahl
Herbert Goodman
John Koster
*Don McGouirk
Jane Sheppard
John Skilton
Gayle Solheim Riese, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

George Vaillant, *chairperson*
Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*

All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."



Officers of the General Service Board

Chair
Elaine McDowell
First vice-chairperson
George Vaillant
Second vice-chairperson
Leonard Blumenthal
Secretary
Ted Stoa
Treasurer
Vincent Keefe
Assistant secretary
Valerie O'Neill
Assistant treasurer
Donald Meurer

The new slate of officers is given on page 41

*Denotes appointed committee members

** Elaine McDowell and Greg Muth are ex officio members of all committees.

2004 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Elaine McDowell, Ph.D. (6631 Hunters Wood Circle, Baltimore, MD 21228) was elected chair of the board in April 2001. She has served as a member of the board since 1992. Elaine has a distinguished background in the fields of alcoholism and substance abuse. She has lectured widely, been a consultant to national and international government and professional organizations and published many articles in professional journals. She is a former professor of social work at Morgan State University. For eight years she served as the director of the Center for Substance Abuse Prevention, and was the former acting administrator of the Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration under the U.S. Dept. of Health and Human Services.

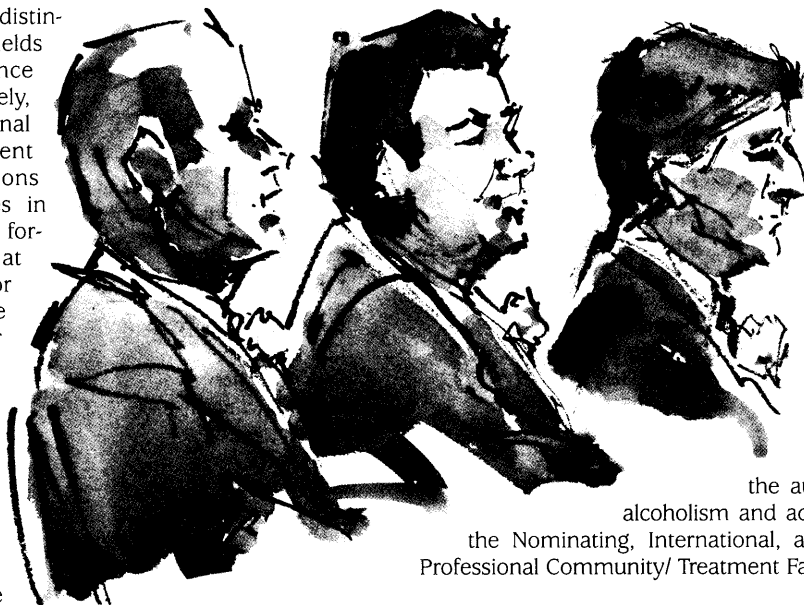
Allen L. Ault, Ed.D. (College of Justice and Safety, 354 Stratton Bldg., 521 Lancaster Ave., Richmond, KY 40475-3102) was elected a Class A trustee in 2001. Allen is dean of the College of Justice and Safety, University of Eastern Kentucky, Richmond, KY. Prior to this position he served as chief for the National Institute of Corrections in Washington, D.C. During his career, Allen has been a director of corrections for five governors in three states, warden of a maximum security prison, a Rehabilitation Counselor, director of State Programs for the Mentally Retarded, and president of a national criminal justice consulting firm. Allen chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee and serves on the Audit Correctional Facilities, Nominating, and Conference Committees.

Leonard M. Blumenthal, L.L.D. (Rolly View, Alberta T0C 2K0, Canada) was elected a Class A trustee in 2000. In 1998 Len retired as chief executive officer of the Alberta Alcohol and Drug Abuse Commission, where he had worked for 30 years. He remains active in the alcoholism field as speaker, consultant and a resource person. Leonard chairs the Correctional Facilities Committee and serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums and Archives Committees. He is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Herbert I. Goodman (5710 Tecumseh Circle, Houston, TX 77057) was elected a Class A trustee in 2003. Herbert holds degrees in chemistry and business from the University of Pittsburgh, Harvard, and the University of Besancon in France. Herbert is CEO of an international corporation involved with petroleum products and energy conservation. He serves on the Conference, Public Information and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

Vincent E. Keefe (9889 West 145 St., Orland Park, IL 60462) was elected to the board in April 2002. Vince is a CPA and holds an MBA from the University of Chicago. Now retired, he has

been the CEO of a large packaging corporation and currently serves as a director on the boards of seven companies. Vince chairs the Finance and Budgetary Committee and also serves on the Audit, International Conventions/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees.



George E. Vaillant, M.D. (355 Garey Rd., East Thetford, VT 05043) was elected to the board in 1998. He is a graduate of Harvard Medical School and the Boston Psychoanalytic Institute. George is professor, Dept. of Psychiatry, Harvard Medical School; senior physician, Brigham and Women's Hospital; and director, The Study of Adult Development. He has lectured widely and is

the author of many articles on alcoholism and addiction. George serves on the Nominating, International, and Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities Committees.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Charles Bartell (3935 Lennox Boulevard, New Orleans, LA 70131) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 2001. A Panel 45 delegate, he continues to participate in treatment and correctional service in his area. Charles, whose background is in psychology, is a retired university professor. He chairs the International Committee and serves on the Literature and Correctional Facilities Committees.

R.J.M. (Ric) Downey (PH4-9541 Erickson Dr., Burnaby, BC V3J 7N8, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in May 2000. A Panel 47 delegate, where he chaired the Policy Admissions Committee, Ric has remained active in his area. He retired after 35 years with the same firm. Ric chairs the Archives Committee and serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees.

David V. Every (150 Hauoli Street, #203, Wailuku, HI 96793) was elected general service trustee in April 2001. A Panel 41 delegate, David served four years as a nontrustee director on the Grapevine Corporate Board. He is the publisher of four local magazines and a partner in an activity and travel booking business. David chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the Conference, and International Committees and on the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Richard Gallagher (410 Spring Valley Lane, Altamonte Springs, FL 32714) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 2001. A Panel 47 delegate, Dick remains active in his home group and in area activities. A.C.P.A. in private practice, he is also involved with various professional organizations. Dick serves on the

Audit, Literature, and Finance & Budgetary Committees and chairs the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Ronald Gauthier (81 Lake Drive, South Hamilton, MA 01982) was elected general service trustee in April 2002. A Panel 41 delegate from Eastern Massachusetts, he has served as an A.A.W.S. director for the past six years. His background is in banking and finance; for the past 20 years he has worked as a commercial lender at various banks in the Boston area. Ron chairs the Conference Committee and serves on the International, and Finance & Budgetary Committees. He is also a director on the A.A.W.S. Board.

Phyllis Halliday (P.O. Box 8277, Lacey, WA 98509) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 2002. As a Panel 47 delegate, Phyllis chaired the Conference Committee on Trustees. Her professional background is in human resource management and she is an agency Human Resource director for the state of Washington. Phyllis chairs the International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities and Nominating Committees. She is also a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Gary Klusdahl (11187 Tamarron Place, Parker, CO 80138) was elected Southwest regional trustee in May 2003. A former Panel 43 delegate, Gary is active in local, area and regional A.A. He has been in the oil and gas exploration and production industry for 30 years. Gary serves on the Archives, Public Information and Cooperation With the Professional Communities/Treatment Facilities Committees.

John Koster (19 East 65th Street, New York, NY 10021-6587) was elected general service trustee in April 2001. John has been an A.A.W.S. director since 1997. He is an attorney in New York specializing in maritime and international commercial law. John serves as an editor or contributing author to a number of professional publications. John serves on the Audit, Nominating, Conference, Public Information, and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committees and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Murray McIntosh (426 Cuyler Street, Thunder Bay, Ontario P7A 1B2, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in May 2003. A Panel 49 delegate from Northwest Ontario, Murray is active in group and area activities. Now retired, he was a professor in human services at a local college. Murray serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums, Literature, and International Committees.

Dorothy May (9046 Pine Cone Way, Indianapolis, IN 46268) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 2001. Dorothy was a Panel 40 delegate. Her professional background is in education, as teacher, administrator and writer. Dorothy serves on the International and Finance & Budgetary Committees, and chairs the A.A.W.S. Board.

Robert Pelot (1020, Louis Ritchie, St-Jérôme, Québec, Canada J5L-1X6) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 2002. Bob, a former Panel 46 delegate, is active in his area with remote communities and in correctional service. Now retired, Robert worked for 25 years for a large corporation in various supervisory positions. Bob chairs the Public Information Committee and serves on the International and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committees. He is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Michael D. Perry (11 Mechanic Street, Fair Haven, VT 05743) was elected Northeast regional trustee in May 2003. A Panel 50 delegate, Mike has continued to serve his area as the convention chair on the area committee. He has taught high school biology for over 30 years. Mike serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums, Correctional Facilities and Literature Committees.

Arnold L. Ross (227-M East Northern Parkway, Baltimore, MD 21212) became a general service trustee in May 2003, after having served three years as a director on the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board. A former Panel 46 delegate, Arnold is chief of financial administration for a nonprofit organization. Arnold serves on the Conference, Archives, and Finance & Budgetary Committees and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

Ted Stoa (39953 340th Ave., Climax, MN 56523) was elected West Central regional trustee in May 2000. Ted was a Panel 42 delegate. His background is in restaurant management and he has owned and operated several restaurants, as well as the family farm. Ted chairs the Nominating Committee and serves on the Audit, Finance & Budgetary, Archives and Correctional Facilities Committees.

Trustees elected by the General Service Board following 2004 Conference

Charles Barta (1320 43rd St. SE, Cedar Rapids, IA 52403) was elected West Central regional trustee in April 2004. A former Panel 51 delegate, Chuck is active in his region and area and in district correctional and treatment facilities meetings. He currently works in the construction industry as an electrician.

William D. Clark, M.D. (143 Temple Road, Woolwich, ME 04579) was elected to the board in 2004. He is a graduate of Harvard University and Harvard Medical School. Bill is medical director of an Addiction Resource Center and is attending physician at Mid Coast Hospital in Bath, Maine. He has taught at various medical schools and hospitals as well as presenting seminars and programs on alcoholism.

Ward B Ewing, D.D. (The General Theological Seminary, 175 Ninth Avenue, New York, NY 10011) was elected to the board in 2004. Ward is a graduate of the General Theological Seminary, where he is now dean and president. For over 30 years he served as pastor of Episcopal congregations in his native Tennessee, and in Florida, Kentucky and Buffalo, New York. He is involved in community ministries and is the author of several books and articles.

Tom Kraemer (Box 121, Vibank, Saskatchewan S0G 4Y0) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in April 2004. A Panel 48 delegate, Tom is actively involved with Regina Intergroup and has served on a number of A.A. service committees. He has been with the Canada Post Corp. for over 30 years.

Trustee Ron Gauthier brought his wife, Laurie, and sons, Andrew (9) and Jonathan (6) to New York. When Andrew noticed his father's badge Class B trustee, he wanted to meet a Class A trustee, who could drink. Class A Vince Keefe graciously obliged the request.

A.A. World Services Directors

Dorothy May, *chairperson, regional trustee*
 Paul Cleary, *director*
 Ron Gauthier, *general service trustee*
 John Koster, *general service trustee*

Don Miller, *director*
 Greg Muth, *G.S.O. general manager*
 Robert Pelot, *regional trustee*
 Jane Sheppard, *director*
 Valerie O'Neill, *G.S.O. staff member*

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Dick Gallagher, *chairperson, general trustee*
 Robin Bromley, *executive editor*
 Susan Campbell, *director*
 David Every, *general service trustee*

Phyllis Halliday, *regional trustee*
 Raymond Massey, *director*
 Leonard Blumenthal, *Class A trustee*
 Arnold Ross, *general service trustee*
 John Skilton, *director*

General Service Office Staff

Greg Muth, *general manager*
 Tom Jasper, *senior adviser to general manager*
 Bill Archer
 Adrienne Brown
 Julio Espaillat
 Irene Kontje

Mary Clare Lynch
 Valerie O'Neill
 Doug Richardson
 Gayle Solheim Riese
 Eva Sanchez
 Warren Stafford
 Rick Walker

Grapevine Staff

Robin Bromley, *executive editor*

Charles McGovern, *managing editor*

Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Daniel Brown, *designer/typesetter*
 Janet Bryan, *GV office mgr./admin. asst.*
 Shawn Bunkley, *general office clerk*
 Angel Calvillo, *Spanish translator*
 Christopher Cavanaugh, *publications director*
 Sheila Copin-Thomas, *staff assistant*
 Daniel DeFilippis, *asst. controller/business admin.*
 Joseph Dennen, *staff assistant*
 John DeStefano, *Spanish-language editor*
 John Hackett, *associate editor*
 Elisa Henrickson, *support services*
 Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*
 Rafael Hidalgo, *staff assistant*
 Maggie Keogh, *GV website manager/special projects*
 John Kirwin Jr., *A.A. events consultant*
 Fern Leclerc, *French translator*
 Marsha Levine, *GV assoc. editor*
 Pamela Lewis, *staff assistant*
 Donald Meurer, *controller, A.A.W.S.*
 Lillianna Murphy, *information services manager*
 Eugene O'Brien, *GV controller*
 Lise Payette, *French-language editor*
 Ivelisse Rivera, *asst. to Regional Forums coordinator*
 Sofia Rodas, *support services*
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
 Judit Santon, *archivist*
 Sharisse Seabury, *staff assistant*
 Frank Segui, *financial secretary*
 Robert Slotterback, *accounting department manager*
 Elaine Soroka, *special projects manager*
 Kevin Sunkel, *independent auditor*
 Yee Tully, *staff assistant*
 Gerald Walker, *technology implementer*
 Andre Washington, *purchasing agent*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*
 Nannie Williams, *staff assistant*

Trustees emeritus

Michael Alexander
 W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.
 Gary Glynn

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 54rd Conference includes Panel 53 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 54 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	53	Jutta (Utah) Matthews 1906 Helmsdale Circle SE Huntsville, AL 35803-1766
Alaska	2	54	David (Dave) Manson Box 3122 Homer, AK 99603
Arizona	3	54	Regan Gawan 6738 E. Boise St. Mesa, AZ 85205
Arkansas	4	53	Clay Cutten 1606 W. Gum St. Rogers, AR 72758
California Southern	5	53	Jim Irwin 13904 Fiji Way, #231 Marina Del Ray, CA 90292
Central	93	53	Jeanine Rios 403 1/2 North M St., #74 Lompoc, CA 93436
Northern Coastal	6	53	Douglas (Doug) Grude 1309 Pedro St. San Jose, CA 95126-3841
Northern Interior	7	54	Paul Coonce 549 Adams Dr. Chowchilla, CA 93610
San Diego/Imperial	8	54	Marc Jones 6161 El Cajon Blvd., #513 San Diego, CA 92115
Mid-Southern	9	54	Nancy Jensen 832D Ronda Mendoza Laguna Woods, CA 92653
Colorado	10	53	Mark Greider 6013 S. Cherrywood Circle Centennial, CO 80121
Connecticut	11	53	Gale Plancon Box 1090 Branford, CT 06405
Delaware	12	54	Jonathan (Buck) Rose Box 318 Lewes, DE 19958
District of Columbia	13	53	Enna Rodas 11332 Melclare Dr. Beltsville, MD 20705
Florida North	14	53	Corliss Gibbons 927 SW 51st Way Gainesville, FL 32607
S. Florida/ Bahamas/V.I./ Antigua	15	53	Beth Davidson 11240 N.W. 41 Court Coral Springs, FL 33065
Georgia	16	54	Dick Anderson 4380 Veteran's Memorial Hwy. Lithia Springs, GA 30122-1707
Hawaii	17	53	Donald (Don) Anderson 6370 Hawaii Kai Dr., #27 Honolulu, HI 96825
Idaho	18	54	Jim McDonald #20 Fourth of July Creek Rd. Northfork, ID 83466

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Illinois				Montana	40	53	Earl Fink Box 852 Ennis, MT 59729
<i>Chicago</i>	19	53	Don Bennitt 7509 Hickory Creek Dr. Frankfort, IL 60423	Nebraska	41	54	Connie Shockey 616 W. 8th St. York, NE 68467
<i>Northern</i>	20	54	Terrence (Terry) Whelan 1111 Avenue of the Cities, #3C East Moline, IL 61244	Nevada	42	53	Cherie (Kathy) Smith 716 Emden St. Henderson, NV 89015
<i>Southern</i>	21	53	Richard (Dick) Grunloh 810 Park Hills Dr. Effingham, IL 62401-3124	New Hampshire	43	54	Catherine Glosser 90 Bow Lake Rd. Northwood, NH 03261
Indiana				New Jersey			
<i>Northern</i>	22	53	Jack Ottinger 1620 Oakhill Rd. Kokomo, IN 46902	<i>Northern</i>	44	53	Barbara Bridges 73 Elm St., #1 Montclair, NJ 07042
<i>Southern</i>	23	54	Gary Gramman 813 N. Emerson Ave. Indianapolis, IN 46219-4335	<i>Southern</i>	45	54	Laurie Emhe 26 Crest Rd. Cape May Courthouse, NJ 08210
Iowa	24	53	Mike Lewis 1902 South 17th Omaha, NE 68108	New Mexico	46	54	Oran Clemons Box 1981 Mesilla Park, NM 88047
Kansas	25	54	Jimmy Jack Bailey 60456 E. Highway 54 Pratt, KS 67124	New York			
Kentucky	26	54	O'Dell Holloway 2009 Crums Lane, #21 Louisville, KY 40216	<i>Central</i>	47	53	Paul Walker 49 Troup St., #36 Rochester, NY 14608
Louisiana	27	53	Irving Doucet Box 271 Rosedale, LA 70772	<i>Hudson/Mohawk/ Berkshire</i>	48	54	Steven (Steve) Walker 47 Elm St. Cooperstown, NY 13326
Maine	28	54	Mark Thomas 43 Michael's Rd. Wells, ME 04090	<i>Southeast</i>	49	53	Terrance (Terry) Flynn 86 E. 4th St., #9 New York, NY 10003
Maryland	29	54	Nancy Kunkel 7919 Butterfield Dr. Elkridge, MD 21075	<i>Western</i>	50	54	Walter (Walt) Covert, Jr. 101 Goshen Rd. Panama, NY 14767
Massachusetts				North Carolina	51	53	Teresa Frohock Box 777 Reidsville, NC 27323
<i>Eastern</i>	30	53	Jim Parilli Box 4111 Brockton, MA 02303-4111	North Dakota	52	53	Eric Bothun Box 155 109 2nd St., NW Beulah, ND 58523
<i>Western</i>	31	54	John Ferriter 72 Congress Ave. Holyoke, MA 01040	Ohio			
Michigan				<i>Central Southeast</i>	53	53	Andrew (Andy) Talbert, Jr. 220 Fox Hall Dr. Pataskala, OH 43062
<i>Central</i>	32	53	Dennis Soto 935 S. Knight Rd. Bay City, MI 48708-9659	<i>Northeast</i>	54	53	Dan Mix Box 173 Chardon, OH 44024
<i>Southeast</i>	33	53	Dan Stasinski 15258 Elderwood Roseville, MI 48066	<i>NW Ohio/SE Mich.</i>	55	54	Alan (Skip) DoMoe 9116 Geiser Rd. Holland, OH 43528
<i>Western</i>	34	54	Michael (Mike) E. Young 504 W. Jefferson St., C-6 Augusta, MI 49012	<i>Southwest</i>	56	54	Henry (Hank) Schmitz 702 Pine Needles Dr. Dayton, OH 45458
Minnesota				Oklahoma	57	53	Charles (Chuck) Berry 7341 E. 75th St. Tulsa, OK 74133
<i>Northern</i>	35	54	Charles (Charlie) Craven Box 227 Gilbert, MN 55741	Oregon	58	54	Bruce Landolt 3126 NE Angela Ave. Bend, OR 97701
<i>Southern</i>	36	53	Brenda Lindgren 3020 Casco Point Rd. Wayzata, MN 55391	Pennsylvania			
Mississippi	37	54	Elizabeth Kepner 105 Club Pl. Madison, MS 39110-8803	<i>Eastern</i>	59	53	Nancy Keohane 114 William Penn Dr. Norristown, PA 19403
Missouri				<i>Western</i>	60	53	John Warren 369 Bost Dr. W. Mifflin, PA 15122-2512
<i>Eastern</i>	38	53	Michael (Mike) Foster 17358 IL-RT 185 Coffeen, IL 62017				
<i>Western</i>	39	53	Clarke Brown 2704 E. Cragmont Springfield, MO 65804				

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Rhode Island	61	54	David (Dave) Pratt 34 Sheila Dr. Charlestown, RI 02813
South Carolina	62	54	Raymond (Ray) Nault 588 Crowe Mountain Rd. Walhalla, SC 29691
South Dakota	63	54	Perry Grosz 1111 Nowlin St., #A Rapid City, SD 57701
Tennessee	64	54	Milton (Casey) Casey 241 Eastland Ave. Ripley, TN 38063
Texas <i>Northeast</i>	65	53	Joe Pineda 14049 Janwood Lane Dallas, TX 75234
<i>Northwest</i>	66	54	Cynthia (Cindy) Coffelt 2109 Bowie Amarillo, TX 79109
<i>Southeast</i>	67	53	Paul Mijares 14030 Rawlings Humble, TX 77396
<i>Southwest</i>	68	54	Brent Brown 708 Minturn Ln. Austin, TX 78478-6567
Utah	69	53	JoAnne (Jodi) Ericson 184 West 400 South Tooele, UT 84074
Vermont	70	54	Jacquelyn (Jacki) Perry 11 Mechanic St. Fair Haven, VT 05743
Virginia	71	53	Ruth Barth 3383 Whipple Court Annandale, VA 22003
Washington <i>State East</i>	92	54	Michael (Mike) McMurtrie 4428 Sunny Creek Dr. Spokane, WA 99224
<i>Western</i>	72	53	Edward (Eddie) Harris 1204 Queen Ave. NE Renton, WA 98056-3343
West Virginia	73	53	Gerald (Jerry) Moore R.R.1, Box 187 Shepherdstown, WV 25443
Wisconsin <i>No. WI/ Up. Pen. MI</i>	74	54	Torvin (Torv) Theisen 805 Houghton St. Ontonagon, MI 49953
<i>Southern</i>	75	53	Jo A. McLaughlin 1802 Sheridan Rd. Kenosha, WI 53140-1345
Wyoming	76	54	Don Myers 5009 Newland Cheyenne, WY 82009
Puerto Rico	77	54	Eladio (Lalo) Montalvo Box 1600, Suite 1009 Cidra, PR 00739

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta/N.W.T.	78	54	Victor (Vic) Phillips Box 4164 Olds, AB T4H 1P7
B.C./Yukon	79	53	Maureen Maguire 6139 Everest Way Duncan, BC V9L 5N5
Manitoba	80	54	Robin Fewings 162 Parkville Dr. Winnipeg, MB R2M 2J1
New Brunswick/P.E.I.	81	54	Don Mollins 111 Route 133 Shediac Cape, NB E4P3C8
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labr.	82	53	Wanda Halverson 381 Truro Rd., R.R. #3 Westville, NS BOK 2A0
Ontario <i>Eastern</i>	83	53	Roy Robertson 1211 Kentlow Court Mississauga, ON L5E 3C4
<i>Northeast</i>	84	53	Mary Alice Sanderson 507-4 East St. Sault Ste. Marie, ON P6A 6W9
<i>Northwest</i>	85	53	Marie Hamilton 106-630 Sherrington Dr. Thunder Bay, ON P7B 6A3
<i>Western</i>	86	54	Jan Lembke 7951 Cairns Blvd. Invercairn Beach, R.R. #5 Forest, ON NON 1J0
Quebec <i>Southwest</i>	87	54	Jean Gagner 327, rue Moquin Longueuil, PQ J4L 4V9
<i>Southeast</i>	88	53	Claude Lieutenant 100, chemin du Bassin Compton, PQ J0B 1L0
<i>Northeast</i>	89	53	Réal Laforest 20, rue Plourde Métabetchouan-Lac-A- La Croix, PQ G8G 1C6
<i>Northwest</i>	90	54	Donald Cusson 520, Grande Allee Terrebonne, PQ J6W 4S9
Saskatchewan	91	54	Randall (Randy) Magnus 411 6th St. East Saskatoon, SK S7H 1B7

